

Philebus

ΦΙΛΗΒΟΣ

Plato

translated by David Horan

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11a

S: Well, Protarchus, be clear now as to what argument you are about to accept from Philebus, and what argument of mine you are to oppose if it does not accord with your thinking. Would you like us to summarise both?

ΣΩ. ὄρα δὴ, Πρώταρχε, τίνα λόγον μέλλεις παρὰ Φιλήβου δέχεσθαι νυνὶ καὶ πρὸς τίνα τὸν παρ' ἡμῖν ἀμφισβητεῖν,

11b

PR: Yes, certainly.

11b

S: So Philebus, for his part, says that what is good for every creature is enjoyment, pleasure and delight, and anything else that belongs to this class. Whereas I contend that not these, but understanding, reasoning, memory and their kindred, right opinion and true thinking, are better and more desirable than pleasure for all of those who are able to acquire them, and that they are supremely beneficial to anyone who can attain them now or in the future. Isn't that the sort of thing we both said, Philebus?

ἐὰν μὴ σοι κατὰ νοῦν ἦ λεγόμενος. βούλει συγκεφαλαιωσώμεθα ἑκάτερον; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. Φίληβος μὲν τοίνυν ἀγαθὸν εἶναί φησι τὸ χαίρειν πᾶσι ζώοις καὶ τὴν ἡδονὴν καὶ τέρψιν, καὶ ὅσα τοῦ γένους ἐστὶ τούτου σύμφωνα· τὸ δὲ παρ' ἡμῶν ἀμφισβήτημά ἐστι μὴ ταῦτα, ἀλλὰ τὸ φρονεῖν καὶ τὸ νοεῖν καὶ μεμνησθαι καὶ τὰ τούτων αὖ συγγενῇ, δόξαν τε ὀρθὴν καὶ ἀληθεῖς λογισμούς, τῆς γε ἡδονῆς ἀμείνω καὶ ἰσχυρὸν γίνεσθαι σύμπασιν ὅσαπερ

11c

PL: Yes, entirely so, Socrates.

11c

S: Well, Protarchus, do you accept the argument that has just been assigned to you?

11c

PR: I must accept it, since the fair Philebus has withdrawn.

11c

S: In that case, should we somehow ascertain the truth about this by all possible means?

11c

PR: Yes, we should.

αὐτῶν δυνατὰ μεταλαβεῖν· δυνατοῖς δὲ μετασχεῖν ὠφελιμώτατον ἀπάντων εἶναι πᾶσι τοῖς οὐσί τε καὶ ἔσομένοις. μὴ οὐχ οὕτω πως λέγομεν, ὦ Φίληβε, ἐκότεροι; ΦΙ. πάντων μὲν οὖν μάλιστα, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. δέχῃ δὴ τοῦτον τὸν νῦν διδόμενον, ὦ Πρωταρχε, λόγον; ΠΡΩ. ἀνάγκη δέχεσθαι· Φίληβος γὰρ ἡμῖν ὁ καλὸς ἀπείρηκεν. ΣΩ. δεῖ δὴ περὶ αὐτῶν τρόπῳ παντὶ τάληθές πῃ περανθῆναι;

11d

S: Well then, let us agree on something else besides this.

11d

PR: On what?

11d

S: That each of us will now be attempting to indicate some state or disposition of the soul, capable of providing a happy life to all people. Is this not so?

11d

PR: This is so.

11d

S: Will you say that the state is one of enjoyment, while I in turn say that it is one of understanding?

11d

PR: That's it.

11d

S: And what if some other state turns out to be better than these? In that case, if it proves to be more akin to pleasure, then both our suggestions would be inferior to the life based firmly upon that condition, while the life of pleasure would be superior to that of understanding. Is this so?

ΠΡΩ. δεῖ γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ, πρὸς τούτοις διομολογησώμεθα καὶ τόδε. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὡς νῦν ἡμῶν ἐκάτερος ἔξιν ψυχῆς καὶ διάθεσιν ἀποφαίνειν τινὰ ἐπιχειρήσει τὴν δυναμένην ἀνθρώποις πᾶσι τὸν βίον εὐδαίμονα παρέχειν. ἄρ' οὐχ οὕτως; ΠΡΩ. οὕτω μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὑμεῖς μὲν τὴν τοῦ χαίρειν, ἡμεῖς δ' αὖ τὴν τοῦ φρονεῖν; ΠΡΩ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. τί δ' ἂν ἄλλη τις κρείττων τούτων φανῇ; μὴ οὐκ, ἂν μὲν ἡδονῇ μᾶλλον φαίνεται συγγενής, ἡττώμεθα μὲν ἀμφοτέροι τοῦ ταῦτα ἔχοντος βεβαίως βίου, κρατεῖ δὲ ὁ τῆς

12a

PR: Yes.

12a

S: But if it is more akin to understanding, would understanding be victorious over pleasure, and would pleasure be inferior? Do you say that this is now agreed? Or what do you say?

12a

PR: Well, I think so anyway.

12a

S: And what about Philebus? What do you say?

12a

PL: It seems to me that pleasure is and will be completely victorious, but you will recognise this yourself, Protarchus.

12a

PR: Having handed the argument over to me, Philebus, you may no longer control my agreements with Socrates, or the disagreements either.

ἡδονῆς τὸν τῆς φρονήσεως; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἂν δέ γε φρονήσῃ, νικᾷ μὲν φρόνησις τὴν ἡδονήν, ἡ δὲ ἡττᾶται; ταῦθ' οὕτως ὁμολογούμενά φατε, ἢ πῶς; ΠΡΩ. ἐμοὶ γοῦν δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. τί δὲ Φιλήβω; τί φῆς; ΦΙ. ἐμοὶ μὲν πάντως νικᾷ ἡδονὴ δοκεῖ καὶ δόξει· σὺ δέ, Πρώταρχε, αὐτὸς γνώσῃ. ΠΡΩ. παραδούς, ὦ Φίληβε, ἡμῖν τὸν λόγον οὐκ ἂν ἔτι κύριος εἴης τῆς πρὸς Σωκράτη ὁμολογίας ἢ καὶ τούναντίον.

12b

PL: What you say is true. In fact, I now renounce it, and call the goddess herself as witness.

12b

PR: And we shall act as your supporting witnesses to the fact that you have said this. Anyway, Socrates, we should try to proceed to the next stages of our discussion, regardless of the willingness of Philebus or his wishes.

ΦΙ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις· ἀλλὰ γὰρ ἀφοσιοῦμαι καὶ μαρτύρομαι νῦν αὐτὴν τὴν θεόν. ΠΡΩ. καὶ ἡμεῖς σοι τούτων γε αὐτῶν συμμάρτυρες ἂν εἶμεν, ὡς ταῦτα ἔλεγες ἃ λέγεις. ἀλλὰ δὴ τὰ μετὰ ταῦτα ἐξῆς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅμως καὶ μετὰ Φιλίβου ἐκόντος ἢ ὅπως ἂν ἐθέλῃ πειρώμεθα περαίνειν. ΣΩ. πειρατέον, ἀπ' αὐτῆς δὴ τῆς θεοῦ, ἣν ὅδε Ἀφροδίτην μὲν λέγεσθαί φησι, τὸ δ' ἀληθέστατον αὐτῆς ὄνομα ἡδονὴν εἶναι. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα.

12c

S: We should try, beginning with the actual goddess herself, who Philebus here says is called Aphrodite, even though her truest name is Pleasure.

12c

PR: Absolutely correct.

12c

S: Protarchus, my constant awe in relation to the names of the gods is not quite human. No, it is beyond the greatest fear. So, I shall now address Aphrodite in whichever manner is dear to that goddess. However, I know that pleasure is complex, and, as I said, it is necessary to begin with that, and reflect on and consider the sort of nature it possesses. In fact, it sounds as if it is only one thing, yet it has assumed multiple forms, and these are in some way unlike one another. Yes, think about it. We say that an unrestrained person has pleasure, while someone sound-minded is also pleased by that very sound-mindedness. What is more, someone devoid of intelligence and full of stupid opinions and hopes is pleased, and yet the men of understanding take pleasure in that very understanding. Now, how could anyone say that

each of these pleasures is like one another and not be regarded, quite rightly, as stupid?

ΣΩ. τὸ δ' ἐμὸν δέος, ὦ Πρώταρχε, αἰὲ πρὸς τὰ τῶν θεῶν ὀνόματα οὐκ ἔστι κατ' ἄνθρωπον, ἀλλὰ πέρα τοῦ μεγίστου φόβου. καὶ νῦν τὴν μὲν Ἀφροδίτην, ὅπῃ ἐκείνη φίλον, ταύτῃ προσαγορεύω· τὴν δὲ ἡδονὴν οἶδα ὡς ἔστι ποικίλον, καὶ ὅπερ εἶπον, ἀπ' ἐκείνης ἡμᾶς ἀρχομένους ἐνθυμεῖσθαι δεῖ καὶ σκοπεῖν ἥντινα φύσιν ἔχει. ἔστι γάρ, ἀκούειν μὲν οὕτως ἀπλῶς, ἔν τι, μορφὰς δὲ δήπου παντοίας εἴληφε καὶ τινα τρόπον ἀνομοίους ἀλλήλαις. ἰδὲ γάρ· ἥδεσθαι μὲν φαμεν

12d

PR: Well, Socrates, although they arrive from opposite things, the pleasures themselves are not opposite to one another. Indeed, how could pleasure not be completely like pleasure, and how could this, of all things, not be like itself?

τὸν ἀκολασταίνοντα ἄνθρωπον, ἥδεσθαι δὲ καὶ τὸν σωφρονοῦντα αὐτῷ τῷ σωφρονεῖν ἥδεσθαι δ' αὖ καὶ τὸν ἀνοηταίνοντα καὶ ἀνοήτων δοξῶν καὶ ἐλπίδων μεστόν, ἥδεσθαι δ' αὖ τὸν φρονοῦντα αὐτῷ τῷ φρονεῖν· καὶ τούτων τῶν ἡδονῶν ἐκατέρας πῶς ἂν τις ὁμοίας ἀλλήλαις εἶναι λέγων οὐκ ἀνόητος φαίνοιτο ἐνδίκως; ΠΡΩ. εἰσὶ μὲν γάρ ἀπ' ἐναντίων, ὦ Σώκρατες, αὗται πραγμάτων, οὐ μὴν αὐταὶ γε ἀλλήλαις ἐναντίαί. πῶς γὰρ

12e

S: And, indeed, colour, my friend, is like colour. In this respect at any rate, as all being colour, it will not differ. And yet we all realise that black and white are different and happen to be completely opposite. And, of course, shape is like shape on the same basis, and as a class it is all one. However, some of its parts are completely opposite to one another, others have lots of differences, and we shall find numerous other instances of such distinctions. So, do not trust this argument which makes one out of all the complete opposites. No, I am afraid we shall find that some pleasures are the opposite of other pleasures.

ἡδονῇ γε ἡδονὴ μὴ οὐχ ὁμοιότατον ἂν εἴη, τοῦτο αὐτὸ ἑαυτῷ, πάντων χρημάτων; ΣΩ. καὶ γὰρ χρῶμα, ὧ δαιμόνιε, χρώματι· κατὰ γε αὐτὸ τοῦτο οὐδὲν διοίσει τὸ χρῶμα εἶναι πᾶν, τό γε μὴν μέλαν τῷ λευκῷ πάντες γινώσκομεν ὡς πρὸς τῷ διάφορον εἶναι καὶ ἐναντιώτατον ὃν τυγχάνει. καὶ δὴ καὶ σχῆμα σχήματι κατὰ ταῦτόν· γένει μὲν ἐστι πᾶν ἓν, τὰ δὲ μέρη τοῖς μέρεσιν

13a

PR: Perhaps, but why does that harm my argument?

13a

S: Because I shall maintain that, although they are unlike, you are referring to them by a different name, for you assert that all pleasures are good. Now, no one will put forward the argument that pleasures are not pleasant, but I do say that many are bad while some are good. However, you refer to them all as good, though you agree that they are not alike, if someone compels you to do so in discussion. Well then, what is the same in good and bad pleasures alike, which makes you call all pleasures good?

αὐτοῦ τὰ μὲν ἐναντιώτατα ἀλλήλοις, τὰ δὲ διαφορότητ' ἔχοντα μυρίαν που τυγχάνει, καὶ πολλὰ ἕτερα οὕτως ἔχονθ' εὐρήσομεν. ὥστε τούτῳ γε τῷ λόγῳ μὴ πίστευε, τῷ πάντα τὰ ἐναντιώτατα ἓν ποιοῦντι. φοβοῦμαι δὲ μή τις ἡδονὰς ἡδοναῖς εὐρήσομεν ἐναντίας. ΠΡΩ. ἴσως· ἀλλὰ τί τοῦθ' ἡμῶν βλάβει τὸν λόγον; ΣΩ. ὅτι προσαγορεύεις αὐτὰ ἀνόμοια ὄντα ἑτέρῳ, φήσομεν, ὀνόματι· λέγεις γὰρ ἀγαθὰ πάντ' εἶναι τὰ ἡδέα. τὸ μὲν οὖν μὴ οὐχὶ ἡδέα εἶναι τὰ ἡδέα λόγος οὐδεὶς ἀμφισβητεῖ·

13b

PR: What are you saying, Socrates? Do you really think that anyone who proposes that the good is pleasure will agree with this, and then tolerate your suggestion that there are some good pleasures but others that are bad?

κακὰ δ' ὄντα αὐτῶν τὰ πολλὰ καὶ ἀγαθὰ δέ, ὡς ἡμεῖς φαμέν, ὅμως πάντα σὺ προσαγορεύεις ἀγαθὰ αὐτά, ὁμολογῶν ἀνόμοια εἶναι, τῷ λόγῳ εἴ τις σε προσαναγκάζοι. τί οὖν δὴ ταῦτόν ἐν ταῖς κακαῖς ὁμοίως

καὶ ἐν ἀγαθαῖς ἐνὸν πάσας ἡδονὰς ἀγαθὸν εἶναι προσαγορεύεις; ΠΡΩ. πῶς λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες; οἶμι γάρ τινα συγχωρήσεσθαι, θέμενον ἡδονὴν εἶναι τἀγαθόν, εἴτα ἀνέξεσθαί σου

13c

S: And yet you will state that they are not like one another, and that some are opposites.

13c

PR: But not insofar as they are pleasures.

13c

S: We are carried back again to the same argument, Protarchus, and so we shall say that pleasure is not different from pleasure, and that all pleasures are alike. The examples we gave just now make no impression upon us, and we go on behaving and talking like the most inept beginners in the conduct of discourse.

λέγοντος τὰς μὲν εἶναι τινὰς ἀγαθὰς ἡδονὰς, τὰς δὲ τινὰς ἐτέρας αὐτῶν κακάς; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὖν ἀνομοίους γε φήσεις αὐτὰς ἀλλήλαις εἶναι καὶ τινὰς ἐναντίας. ΠΡΩ. οὔτι καθ' ὅσον γε ἡδοναί. ΣΩ. πάλιν εἰς τὸν αὐτὸν φερόμεθα λόγον, ὦ Πρώταρχε, οὐδ' ἄρα ἡδονὴν ἡδονῆς διάφορον, ἀλλὰ πάσας ὁμοίας εἶναι φήσομεν, καὶ τὰ παραδείγματα ἡμᾶς τὰ νυνδὴ λεχθέντα οὐδὲν τιτρώσκει, πεισόμεθα δὲ καὶ ἐροῦμεν ἅπερ οἱ πάντων

13d

PR: What do you mean?

13d

S: That if I copy you, and dare to defend myself by saying that the most unlike is most completely like the most unlike, I shall be forced to say the same thing as you. We shall prove worse than beginners, and our discussion will collapse and come to nought. So, let us work backwards, and perhaps we may be able to come to some agreement with one another by reverting to our original propositions.

13d

PR: How? Tell me.

φανλότητοί τε καὶ περὶ λόγους ἅμα νέοι. ΠΡΩ. τὰ ποῖα δὴ λέγεις; ΣΩ. ὅτι σε μιμούμενος ἐγὼ καὶ ἀμυνόμενος ἐὰν τολμῶ λέγειν ὡς τὸ ἀνομοιότατόν ἐστι τῷ ἀνομοιοτάτῳ πάντων ὁμοιότατον, ἔξω τὰ αὐτὰ σοὶ λέγειν, καὶ φανούμεθά γε νεώτεροι τοῦ δέοντος, καὶ ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν ἐκπεσὼν οἰχίσηται. πάλιν οὖν αὐτὸν ἀνακρουώμεθα, καὶ τάχ' ἂν ἰόντες εἰς τὰς ὁμοίας ἴσως ἂν πως ἀλλήλοις συγχωρήσαιμεν.

13e

S: Assume, Protarchus, that I in turn am being questioned by you.

13e

PR: In what way?

13e

S: Take understanding, knowledge, reason, and anything else I proposed at the outset and declared to be good when I asked what good is. Now, does this argument not run into the same problem as yours?

13e

PR: How?

13e

S: All the branches of knowledge taken together will seem numerous, and some of them will seem to be unlike one another. And, indeed, if some turn out somehow to be opposites, would I be a worthy dialectician now if I were to say that knowledge does not become unlike knowledge because I was afraid of that statement about opposites? Wouldn't our discussion then be reduced to nothing, like some, and would we then be saved by something irrational?

ΠΡΩ. λέγε πῶς; ΣΩ. ἐμὲ θές ὑπὸ σοῦ πάλιν ἐρωτώμενον, ὦ Πρώταρχε. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ; ΣΩ. φρόνησίς τε καὶ ἐπιστήμη καὶ νοῦς καὶ πάνθ' ὁπόσα δὴ κατ' ἀρχὰς ἐγὼ θέμενος εἶπον ἀγαθὰ, διερωτώμενος ὅτι ποτ' ἐστὶν ἀγαθόν, ἄρ' οὐ ταυτὸν πείσονται τοῦτο ὅπερ ὁ σὸς λόγος; ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. πολλάι τε αἱ συνάπασαι ἐπιστήμαι δόξουσιν εἶναι καὶ ἀνόμοιοί τινες αὐτῶν ἀλλήλαις· εἰ δὲ καὶ ἐναντίαι πη

14a

PR: No, that simply must not happen, except what you said about being saved. Anyway, the equal treatment of your argument and mine is quite acceptable. Assume there are many pleasures, and let them be unlike; and assume there are many kinds of knowledge, and let them be different.

γίνονται τινες, ἄρα ἄξιος ἂν εἶην τοῦ διαλέγεσθαι νῦν, εἰ φοβηθεῖς τοῦτο αὐτὸ μηδεμίαν ἀνόμοιον φαῖν ἐπιστήμην ἐπιστήμη γίνεσθαι, κάπειθ' ἡμῖν οὕτως ὁ λόγος ὥσπερ μῦθος ἀπολόμενος οἷχοιτο, αὐτοὶ δὲ σωζοίμεθα ἐπὶ τινος ἀλογίας; ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' οὐ μὴν δεῖ τοῦτο γενέσθαι, πλὴν τοῦ σωθῆναι. τό γε μὴν μοι ἴσον τοῦ σοῦ τε καὶ ἐμοῦ λόγου ἀρέσκει· πολλὰ μὲν ἡδοναὶ καὶ ἀνόμοιοι γιγνέσθων, πολλὰ δὲ ἐπιστήμαι καὶ διάφοροι.

14b

S: Well, let us not conceal the difference between your concept of the good and mine. We should set them before us for all to see, and be confident that when tested in some way, they may reveal whether we should say that pleasure or understanding, or some third option, is the good. For surely we are not in competition as to whether my views will prevail over yours, or yours over mine. No, somehow we must both strive together for the supreme truth.

14b

PR: Yes, we must.

ΣΩ. τὴν τοίνυν διαφορότητα, ὦ Πρώταρχε, τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ τοῦ τ' ἐμοῦ καὶ τοῦ σοῦ μὴ ἀποκρυπτόμενοι, κατατιθέντες δὲ εἰς τὸ μέσον, τολμῶμεν, ἂν πῃ ἐλεγχόμενοι μηνύσωσι πότερον ἡδονὴν τάγαθόν δεῖ λέγειν ἢ φρόνησιν ἢ τι τρίτον ἄλλο εἶναι. νῦν γὰρ οὐ δήπου πρὸς γε αὐτὸ τοῦτο φιλονικοῦμεν, ὅπως ἀγὼ τίθεται, ταῦτ' ἔσται τὰ νικῶντα, ἢ ταῦθ' ἂ σύ, τῷ δ' ἀληθεστάτῳ δεῖ που συμμαχεῖν ἡμᾶς ἄμφω. ΠΡΩ. δεῖ γὰρ οὖν.

14c

S: Well, let us make the issue more definite by means of consensus.

14c

PR: What issue do you mean?

14c

S: One which presents a difficulty for everybody, though some meet it willingly, others on occasion unwillingly.

14c

PR: Speak more plainly.

14c

S: I am referring to a natural wonder which has emerged from this discussion. Yes, saying that many things are one, and one is many, is a wonder, and it is easy to argue against anyone who proposes either argument.

ΣΩ. τοῦτον τοῖνυν τὸν λόγον ἔτι μᾶλλον δι' ὁμολογίας βεβαιωσώμεθα. ΠΡΩ. τὸν ποῖον δῆ; ΣΩ. τὸν πᾶσι παρέχοντα ἀνθρώποις πράγματα ἐκοῦσί τε καὶ ἄκουσιν ἐνίοις καὶ ἐνίοτε. ΠΡΩ. λέγε σαφέστερον. ΣΩ. τὸν νυνδὴ παραπεσόντα λέγω, φύσει πως πεφυκότα θαυμαστόν. Ἐν γὰρ δὴ τὰ πολλὰ εἶναι καὶ τὸ ἓν πολλὰ θαυμαστόν λεχθέν, καὶ ῥᾷδιον ἀμφισβητῆσαι τῷ τούτων ὅποτερονοῦν τιθεμένῳ. ΠΡΩ. ἄρ' οὖν λέγεις ὅταν τις ἐμὲ φῇ Πρώταρχον ἓνα

14d

PR: Do you mean when someone says that I, Protarchus, am one by nature, and again that there are many of me which are opposite to one another, proposing that the same person is large and small, light and heavy, and so on, endlessly?

14d

S: Protarchus, you have described the more commonplace wonders of the one and the many. But I think most people agree by now not to bother with such instances, appreciating that they are childish, facile and a considerable impediment to the arguments. Nor are we concerned with anyone who uses an argument separating the limbs and the parts of a thing, having secured agreement that they all constitute a single entity, and then argues contemptuously that he has forced us into the monstrous conclusions that the one is many and limitless, and that the many is only one.

γεγονότα φύσει πολλοὺς εἶναι πάλιν τοὺς ἐμὲ καὶ ἐναντίους ἀλλήλοις, μέγαν καὶ σμικρὸν τιθέμενος καὶ βαρὺν καὶ κοῦφον τὸν αὐτὸν καὶ ἄλλα μυρία; ΣΩ. σὺ μὲν, ὦ Πρώταρχε, εἴρηκας τὰ δεδημευμένα τῶν θαυμαστῶν περὶ τὸ ἓν καὶ πολλά, συγκεχωρημένα δὲ ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν ὑπὸ πάντων ἤδη μὴ δεῖν τῶν τοιούτων ἅπτεσθαι, παιδαριώδη καὶ ῥάδια καὶ σφόδρα τοῖς λόγοις ἐμπόδια ὑπολαμβάνόντων γίνεσθαι, ἐπεὶ μηδὲ τὰ τοιάδε, ὅταν τις

14e

PR: Yes, Socrates, but what sort of other wonders are you referring to on this particular issue which are not commonplace and regarded as of no interest?

ἐκάστου τὰ μέλη τε καὶ ἅμα μέρη διελὼν τῷ λόγῳ, πάντα ταῦτα τὸ ἓν ἐκεῖνο εἶναι διομολογησάμενος, ἐλέγχῃ καταγελῶν ὅτι τέρατα διηνάγκασται φάναι, τό τε ἓν ὡς πολλά ἐστὶ καὶ ἄπειρα, καὶ τὰ πολλά ὡς ἓν μόνον. ΠΡΩ. σὺ δὲ δὴ ποῖα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔτερα λέγεις, ἃ μήπω συγκεχωρημένα δεδήμευται περὶ τὸν αὐτὸν τοῦτον λόγον;

15a

S: It arises, my boy, when someone proposes a one that is not in the realm of becoming and perishing, as were the examples we were giving just now. Indeed, this sort of one, as we were saying, is agreed to require no scrutiny. On the other hand, if someone attempts to posit man or ox or the beautiful or the good as a one, in the case of these unities and their like, the controversy associated with their division becomes extremely intense.

15a

PR: How?

ΣΩ. ὁπότεν, ὦ παῖ, τὸ ἓν μὴ τῶν γιγνομένων τε καὶ ἀπολλυμένων τις τιθῆται, καθάπερ ἀρτίως ἡμεῖς εἵπομεν. ἐνταυθοῖ μὲν γὰρ καὶ τὸ τοιοῦτον ἓν, ὅπερ εἵπομεν νυνδὴ, συγκεχώρηται τὸ μὴ δεῖν ἐλέγχειν· ὅταν δέ τις ἓνα ἄνθρωπον ἐπιχειρῇ τίθεσθαι καὶ βούν ἓνα καὶ τὸ καλὸν ἓν καὶ τὸ ἀγαθὸν ἓν, περὶ τούτων τῶν ἐνάδων καὶ τῶν τοιούτων ἡ πολλὴ σπουδὴ μετὰ διαιρέσεως ἀμφισβήτησις γίνεται. ΠΡΩ. πῶς;

15b

S: Firstly, over whether we should accept that there are, in truth, units such as these. Then whether we should also accept, somehow, that each of these units – being one, always the same, with no involvement in generation or destruction – is still undeniably this single unit. In which case it is either dispersed among the things which come into being, and which are in turn limitless, or else, though this seems completely impossible, it arises whole, separate from itself, the same and one, simultaneously present in each and every thing. It is not those other contentions, Protarchus, but contentions about this sort of one and many which are responsible for utter perplexity if not properly resolved, and are responsible for excellent progress if they are.

ΣΩ. πρῶτον μὲν εἴ τινας δεῖ τοιαύτας εἶναι μονάδας ὑπολαμβάνειν ἀληθῶς οὕσας· εἶτα πῶς αὖ ταύτας, μίαν ἐκάστην οὕσαν ἀεὶ τὴν αὐτὴν καὶ μήτε γένεσιν μήτε ὄλεθρον προσδεχομένην, ὅμως εἶναι βεβαιότατα μίαν ταύτην; μετὰ δὲ τοῦτ' ἐν τοῖς γιγνομένοις αὖ καὶ ἀπείροις εἴτε διεσπασμένην καὶ πολλὰ γεγονυῖαν θετέον, εἴθ' ὅλην αὐτὴν αὐτῆς χωρὶς, ὃ δὴ πάντων ἀδυνατώτατον φαίνεται ἄν, ταῦτόν καὶ ἐν ἅμα ἐν ἐνὶ τε καὶ πολλοῖς γίγνεσθαι. ταῦτ' ἔστι τὰ

15c

PR: So, is this the first issue we should tackle now?

15c

S: Well, that is how it seems to me anyway.

15c

PR: Then take it that we shall all go along with you on this. Though perhaps it is best not to ask Philebus right now, and let the sleeping dog lie.

περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα ἐν καὶ πολλά, ἀλλ' οὐκ ἐκεῖνα, ᾧ Πρώταρχε, ἀπάσης ἀπορίας αἷτια μὴ καλῶς ὁμολογηθέντα καὶ εὐπορίας ἂν αὖ καλῶς. ΠΡΩ. οὐκοῦν χρὴ τοῦθ' ἡμᾶς, ᾧ Σώκρατες, ἐν τῷ νῦν πρῶτον διαπονήσασθαι; ΣΩ. ὥς γοῦν ἐγὼ φαίην ἄν. ΠΡΩ. καὶ πάντας τοίνυν ἡμᾶς ὑπόλαβε

συγχωρεῖν σοι τούσδε τὰ τοιαῦτα· Φίληβον δ' ἴσως κράτιστον ἐν τῷ νῦν ἐπερωτῶντα μὴ κινεῖν εὖ κείμενον.

15d

S: Very well, then. Where shall we begin this great and complex dispute about these contentious issues? Ah! What about here?

15d

PR: Where?

15d

S: I think we can say that arguments about the many becoming one and the same are in circulation, in various guises, in everything that is ever said from antiquity to the present day. And this did not begin recently, nor will it ever cease. Rather, it seems to me that this sort of thing is an undying and ageless¹ characteristic of our own discourses. And when any young person first gets a taste of it, he is delighted, as though he had found some treasury of wisdom. He is inspired by pleasure, and loves to set every argument in motion, first rolling it out into its distinctions, and then kneading it into one. Then he rolls it out again and takes it apart, casting himself, first and foremost, into perplexity, followed by any of his usual associates, be they younger, older or the same age, sparing neither father nor mother, nor any other potential listener. And, indeed, he would almost involve the other animals, not only humans, since he would show no mercy even to foreigners, if only an interpreter were to be found.

ΣΩ. εἶεν· πόθεν οὖν τις ταύτης ἄρξεται πολλῆς οὔσης καὶ παντοίας περὶ τὰ ἀμφισβητούμενα μάχης; ἄρ' ἐνθένδε; ΠΡΩ. πόθεν; ΣΩ. φαμέν που ταῦτόν ἐν καὶ πολλὰ ὑπὸ λόγων γιγνόμενα περιτρέχειν πάντη καθ' ἕκαστον τῶν λεγομένων αἰεὶ, καὶ πάλαι καὶ νῦν. καὶ τοῦτο οὔτε μὴ παύσηταί ποτε οὔτε ἥρξατο νῦν, ἀλλ' ἔστι τὸ τοιοῦτον, ὥς ἐμοὶ φαίνεται, τῶν λόγων αὐτῶν ἀθάνατόν τι καὶ ἀγήρων πάθος ἐν ἡμῖν· ὁ δὲ πρῶτον αὐτοῦ γευσάμενος ἐκάστοτε τῶν νέων, ἥσθεις ὥς τινα σοφίας ἡύρηκώς θησαυρόν, ὑφ' ἡδονῆς ἐνθουσιᾷ τε καὶ πάντα κινεῖ λόγον ἄσμενος, τοτὲ μὲν ἐπὶ θάτερα κυκλῶν καὶ συμφύρων εἰς ἓν, τοτὲ δὲ πάλιν ἀνειλίττων καὶ διαμερίζων, εἰς ἀπορίαν αὐτὸν μὲν πρῶτον καὶ

μάλιστα καταβάλλων, δεύτερον δ' αἰεὶ τὸν ἐχόμενον, ἅντε νεώτερος ἅντε πρεσβύτερος ἅντε ἥλιξ ὧν τυγχάνῃ, φειδόμενος οὔτε πατρὸς οὔτε μητρὸς

16a

PR: Now, Socrates, do you not see how many of us there are, and that we are all young? Are you not afraid in case we join forces with Philebus, and attack you for slandering us? Anyway, we do know what you mean, and if there is any means or contrivance to free our discussion gently from such confusion, and discover some better method than this to approach the argument, please apply yourself to it, Socrates, and we shall follow as best we can. For it is no trivial issue which lies before us.

οὔτε ἄλλου τῶν ἀκουόντων οὐδενός, ὀλίγου δὲ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ζώων, οὐ μόνον τῶν ἀνθρώπων, ἐπεὶ βαρβάρων γε οὐδενός ἂν φείσαιο, εἴπερ μόνον ἐρμηνέα ποθὲν ἔχοι. ΠΡΩ. ἄρ', ὦ Σώκρατες, οὐχ ὁρᾷς ἡμῶν τὸ πλῆθος, ὅτι νέοι πάντες ἐσμέν, καὶ οὐ φοβῆ μή σοι μετὰ Φιλῆβου συνεπιθώμεθα, ἐὰν ἡμᾶς λοιδορῇς; ὅμως δὲ μανθάνομεν γὰρ ὃ λέγεις, εἴ τις τρόπος ἔστι καὶ μηχανὴ τὴν μὲν τοιαύτην ταραχὴν ἡμῖν ἔξω τοῦ λόγου εὐμενῶς πως ἀπελθεῖν, ὁδὸν δέ

16b

S: No, it is not, my boys, as Philebus calls you. Well, there is not, nor could there be, a better method than the method whose constant lover I am, though it has often deserted me and left me alone and perplexed.

16b

PR: What is it? Just tell us.

τινα καλλίω ταύτης ἐπὶ τὸν λόγον ἀνευρεῖν, σύ τε προθυμοῦ τοῦτο καὶ ἡμεῖς συνακολουθήσομεν εἰς δύναμιν· οὐ γὰρ σμικρὸς ὁ παρὼν λόγος, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν, ὦ παῖδες, ὥς φησιν ὑμᾶς προσαγορεύων Φίληβος. οὐ μὴν ἔστι καλλίων ὁδὸς οὐδ' ἂν γένοιτο ἥς ἐγὼ ἐραστής μὲν εἰμι αἰεὶ, πολλάκις δέ με ἤδη διαφυγοῦσα ἔρημον καὶ ἄπορον κατέστησεν. ΠΡΩ. τίς αὕτη; λεγέσθω μόνον.

16c

S: It is not a difficult method to describe, but it is extremely difficult to employ. Indeed, anything which has ever been discovered by means of any skill has been made evident through this method. Look, I will describe it.

16c

PR: Yes, describe it.

16c

S: To me, it is evidently a gift to humanity from the gods, hurled from the realm of the gods, along with the brightest fire, by some Prometheus. And the men of old, being superior to us and dwelling closer to the gods, passed on constantly the statement that all of the things which are generally said to be are from one and many, with limit and limitlessness enshrined within them. Now, since this is how they are arranged, we should always assume that there is a single form associated with everything in each case, and we should search for that, and we shall find that it is there. Then, if we can apprehend it, we should consider two after one, if there is any second, and if not, we should consider three or some other number. And each one of those again in the same manner until we can see that the initial one is not only one, many and limitless, but also how many it is. But we should not apply the form of the limitless to the multiplicity until we can discern its entire number lying between the limitless and the one, and at that stage we may then quite readily allow each one of them to proceed towards the limitless. Now, the gods, as I said, have passed on to us this manner of enquiry, understanding, and teaching one another. But the wise men of today make one and many too quickly or too slowly in a random manner, and after one they go immediately to unlimited, and whatever is in between escapes them. And therein lies the distinction between the dialectical and disputatious approach to our discussions.

ΣΩ. ἤν δηλῶσαι μὲν οὐ πάνν χαλεπόν, χρῆσθαι δὲ παγχάλεπον· πάντα γὰρ ὅσα τέχνης ἐχόμενα ἀνηυρέθη πώποτε διὰ ταύτης φανερά γέγονε. σκόπει δὲ ἤν λέγω. ΠΡΩ. λέγε μόνον. ΣΩ. θεῶν μὲν εἰς ἀνθρώπους

δόσις, ὥς γε καταφαίνεται ἐμοί, ποθὲν ἐκ θεῶν ἐρρίφη διὰ τινος Προμηθέως ἅμα φανοτάτῳ τινὶ πυρί· καὶ οἱ μὲν παλαιοί, κρείττονες ἡμῶν καὶ ἐγγυτέρω θεῶν οἰκοῦντες, ταύτην φήμην παρέδοσαν, ὥς ἐξ ἑνὸς μὲν καὶ πολλῶν ὄντων τῶν αἰε λεγομένων εἶναι, πέρας δὲ καὶ ἀπειρίαν ἐν αὐτοῖς σύμφυτον ἐχόντων. δεῖν οὖν ἡμᾶς τούτων οὕτω διακεκοσμημένων αἰε μίαν ιδέαν περὶ παντὸς ἐκάστοτε θεμένους ζητεῖν—εὐρήσειν γὰρ ἐνοῦσαν— ἐὰν οὖν μεταλάβωμεν, μετὰ μίαν δύο, εἴ πως εἰσὶ, σκοπεῖν, εἰ δὲ μή, τρεῖς ἢ τινα ἄλλον ἀριθμόν, καὶ τῶν ἐν ἐκείνων ἕκαστον πάλιν ὡσαύτως, μέχριπερ ἂν τὸ κατ' ἀρχὰς ἐν μὴ ὅτι ἐν καὶ πολλὰ καὶ ἄπειρά ἐστι μόνον ἴδη τις, ἀλλὰ καὶ ὅποσα τὴν δὲ τοῦ ἀπείρου ιδέαν πρὸς τὸ πλῆθος μὴ προσφέρειν πρὶν ἂν τις τὸν ἀριθμὸν αὐτοῦ πάντα κατίδῃ τὸν μεταξὺ τοῦ ἀπείρου τε καὶ τοῦ ἐνός, τότε δ' ἤδη τὸ ἐν ἕκαστον τῶν πάντων εἰς τὸ ἄπειρον μεθέντα χαίρειν ἔαν. ΣΩ. οἱ μὲν οὖν θεοί, ὅπερ εἶπον, οὕτως ἡμῖν παρέδοσαν σκοπεῖν καὶ μαρθάνειν καὶ διδάσκειν ἀλλήλους· οἱ δὲ νῦν τῶν ἀνθρώπων

17a

PR: I think I understand much of what you are saying, Socrates, but I would still like to hear a clearer explanation of some of it.

17a

S: Well, my meaning is evident, Protarchus, in the case of letters. So, understand it based upon your education in these.

σοφοὶ ἐν μὲν, ὅπως ἂν τύχωσι, καὶ πολλὰ θᾶττον καὶ βραδύτερον ποιοῦσι τοῦ δέοντος, μετὰ δὲ τὸ ἐν ἄπειρα εὐθύς, τὰ δὲ μέσα αὐτοὺς ἐκφεύγει—οἷς διακεχώρισται τό τε διαλεκτικῶς πάλιν καὶ τὸ ἐριστικῶς ἡμᾶς ποιῆσθαι πρὸς ἀλλήλους τοὺς λόγους. ΠΡΩ. τὰ μὲν πως, ὦ Σώκρατες, δοκῶ σου μαρθάνειν, τὰ δὲ ἔτι σαφέστερον δέομαι ἃ λέγεις ἀκοῦσαι. ΣΩ. σαφὲς μὲν, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἐστὶν ἐν τοῖς γράμμασιν ὃ λέγω, καὶ λάμβαν' αὐτὸ ἐν τούτοις οἷσπερ καὶ

17b

PR: How?

17b

S: Sound which comes through the mouth of each and every person is presumably one. And then again it is also limitless in multiplicity.

17b

PR: Of course.

17b

S: And we are never wiser on account of one or the other of these, neither because we know the limitless aspect of it nor the single aspect. Rather, what makes each of us literate is knowing the number of sounds and their qualities.

17b

PR: Very true.

17b

S: And, indeed, it is the same thing that makes a musician.

17b

PR: How?

πεπαίδευσαι. ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. φωνή μὲν ἡμῖν ἐστὶ πού μία διὰ τοῦ στόματος ἰοῦσα, καὶ ἄπειρος αὖ πλήθει, πάντων τε καὶ ἐκάστου. ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. καὶ οὐδὲν ἑτέρῳ γε τούτων ἐσμέν πω σοφοί, οὔτε ὅτι τὸ ἄπειρον αὐτῆς ἴσμεν οὔθ' ὅτι τὸ ἔν· ἀλλ' ὅτι πόσα τ' ἐστὶ καὶ ὅποια, τοῦτό ἐστι τὸ γραμματικὸν ἕκαστον ποιοῦν ἡμῶν. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ τὸ μουσικὸν ὃ τυγχάνει ποιοῦν, τοῦτ' ἔστι ταυτόν. ΠΡΩ. πῶς;

17c

S: Well, the sound associated with this art is also presumably one in itself.

17c

PR: Yes, it must be.

17c

S: However, we would propose that there is a high and low pitch, and a third which is neither. Is this so?

17c

PR: Quite so.

17c

S: But you would never be wise with regard to music if you only knew these. Though if you did not know them, I can safely say that you would in a sense be worthless as a musician.

17c

PR: I would, indeed.

17c

S: Rather, my friend, you would have to understand the numerical extent of the intervals of high and low sound, their quality, and the distinctions between the intervals, and the extent of the combinations which arise from these, combinations which our forefathers discovered and passed on to us, their successors, under the name harmonies. And there are ----- 1 See Iliad viii.539 for this epithet for the gods. Socrates' characterisation of the problem in this way underscores its seriousness. other internal responses arising in the corresponding movements of the body, which are indeed measured numerically, and, accordingly, they say should be called rhythms and measures. And we should also appreciate that all investigation of one and many must be conducted accordingly. So, once you grasp them in this way, then you become wise, and whenever you select another 'one' belonging to anything whatsoever, and investigate it in this way, you become knowledgeable about that. But taking the limitless aspect of each of the multiplicities will make you a second-rate thinker in every case, devoid of any reputation or esteem, since you have never turned your gaze to number in anything at all.

ΣΩ. φωνὴ μὲν ποὺ καὶ τὸ κατ' ἐκείνην τὴν τέχνην ἐστὶ μία ἐν αὐτῇ.
 ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. δύο δὲ θῶμεν βαρὺ καὶ ὀξύ, καὶ τρίτον ὁμότονον. ἢ
 πῶς; ΠΡΩ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐπω σοφὸς ἂν εἴης τὴν μουσικὴν εἰδὼς
 ταῦτα μόνα, μὴ δὲ εἰδὼς ὥς γ' ἔπος εἰπεῖν εἰς ταῦτα οὐδενὸς ἄξιος ἔση.
 ΠΡΩ. οὐ γὰρ οὔν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ', ὦ φίλε, ἐπειδὴν λάβῃς τὰ διαστήματα ὅποσα
 ἐστὶ τὸν ἀριθμὸν τῆς φωνῆς ὀξύτητός τε πέρι καὶ βαρύτητος, καὶ ὅποια,
 καὶ τοὺς ὅρους τῶν διαστημάτων, καὶ τὰ ἐκ τούτων ὅσα συστήματα
 γέγονεν—ἃ κατιδόντες οἱ πρόσθεν παρέδοσαν ἡμῖν τοῖς ἐπομένοις

ἐκείνοις καλεῖν αὐτὰ ἁρμονίας, ἔν τε ταῖς κινήσεσιν αὐ τοῦ σώματος ἕτερα τοιαῦτα ἐνόντα πάθη γιγνόμενα, ἃ δὴ δι' ἀριθμῶν μετρηθέντα δεῖν αὐ φασι ῥυθμοὺς καὶ μέτρα ἐπονομάζειν, καὶ ἅμα ἐννοεῖν ὡς οὕτω δεῖ περὶ παντὸς ἐνὸς καὶ πολλῶν σκοπεῖν—ὅταν γὰρ αὐτά

17e

PR: Philebus, it seems to me anyway that what Socrates said just now is excellent.

τε λάβης οὕτω, τότε ἐγένου σοφός, ὅταν τε ἄλλο τῶν ἐν ὁτιοῦν ταύτῃ σκοπούμενος ἔλῃς, οὕτως ἔμφρων περὶ τοῦτο γέγονας· τὸ δ' ἄπειρόν σε ἐκάστων καὶ ἐν ἐκάστοις πλῆθος ἄπειρον ἐκάστοτε ποιεῖ τοῦ φρονεῖν καὶ οὐκ ἐλλόγιμον οὐδ' ἐνάριθμον, ἅτ' οὐκ εἰς ἀριθμὸν οὐδένα ἐν οὐδενὶ πώποτε ἀπιδόντα. ΠΡΩ. κάλλιστα, ὦ Φίληβε, ἔμοιγε τὰ νῦν λεγόμενα εἰρηκέναι φαίνεται Σωκράτης.

18a

PL: It seems so to me too. It is excellent in its own right, but why ever has this argument been presented to us now? And with what precise intention?

18a

S: Well, Protarchus, Philebus is right to ask us this question.

18a

PR: He is indeed, so you had better answer him.

18a

S: I shall do that, once I have explained a further detail about these particular issues. Now, if we take any 'one' whatsoever, we are saying that we must not look immediately to its limitless nature, but to some number. And similarly, in the opposite case, when we are compelled to apprehend the limitless first, we must not proceed to the one immediately, but discern a particular number possessing some multiplicity, and from many finish at one. Once more, let us understand what is now being described, based upon the letters of the alphabet.

ΦΙ. κάμοι ταῦτά γε αὐτά· ἀλλὰ τί δή ποτε πρὸς ἡμᾶς ὁ λόγος οὗτος νῦν εἴρηται καὶ τί ποτε βουλόμενος; ΣΩ. ὁρθῶς μέντοι τοῦθ' ἡμᾶς, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἠρώτηκε Φίληβος. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, καὶ ἀποκρίνου γε αὐτῷ. ΣΩ. δράσω ταῦτα διελθὼν σμικρὸν ἔτι περὶ αὐτῶν τούτων. ὥσπερ γὰρ ἔν ὅτιοῦν εἴ τις ποτε λάβοι, τοῦτον, ὥς φαμεν, οὐκ ἐπ' ἀπείρου φύσιν δεῖ βλέπειν εὐθύς ἀλλ' ἐπὶ τινα ἀριθμόν, οὕτω καὶ τὸ ἐναντίον ὅταν τις τὸ ἄπειρον

18b

PR: How?

18b

S: When some god, or even some divine person – the story from Egypt says his name was Theuth² – observed that sound was limitless, he first noticed the vowel sounds in the limitless, which are not one but multiple, and then other sounds which are not vowels, but can be sounded nevertheless, and that there are a number of these also. Thirdly, he distinguished what we now call mutes, and after that he divided the unsounded mutes until they were single entities, and did the same thing to the vowels and semi-vowels. Once he had understood their number, he gave the additional name 'letter' to each and every one of them. But observing that none of us could learn one of them just by itself without all of them, he went on to devise a bond which is one, and somehow makes them all one, and he said that there was a single skill applicable to them, and he called it grammar.

ἀναγκασθῇ πρῶτον λαμβάνειν, μὴ ἐπὶ τὸ ἔν εὐθύς, ἀλλ' ἐπ' ἀριθμόν αὖ τινα πλήθος ἕκαστον ἔχοντά τι κατανοεῖν, τελευτᾷν τε ἐκ πάντων εἰς ἓν. πάλιν δὲ ἐν τοῖς γράμμασι τὸ νῦν λεγόμενον λάβωμεν. ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ἐπειδὴ φωνὴν ἄπειρον κατενόησεν εἴτε τις θεὸς εἴτε καὶ θεῖος ἄνθρωπος—ὡς λόγος ἐν Αἰγύπτῳ Θεῦθ τινα τοῦτον γενέσθαι λέγων, ὃς πρῶτος τὰ φωνήεντα ἐν τῷ ἀπείρῳ κατενόησεν οὐχ ἓν ὄντα ἀλλὰ πλείω, καὶ πάλιν ἕτερα φωνῆς μὲν οὗ, φθόγγου δὲ μετέχοντά τινος, ἀριθμόν δὲ τινα καὶ τούτων εἶναι, τρίτον δὲ εἶδος γραμμάτων διεστήσατο τὰ νῦν λεγόμενα ἄφωνα ἡμῖν τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο διήρει τὰ τε ἄφθογγα καὶ ἄφωνα μέχρι ἑνὸς ἐκάστου, καὶ τὰ φωνήεντα καὶ τὰ μέσα

κατὰ τὸν αὐτὸν τρόπον, ἕως ἀριθμὸν αὐτῶν λαβῶν ἐνί τε ἐκάστῳ καὶ σύμπασι στοιχεῖον ἐπωνόμασε· καθορῶν δὲ ὡς οὐδείς ἡμῶν οὐδ' ἂν ἐν αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτὸ ἄνευ πάντων αὐτῶν μάθοι, τοῦτον τὸν δεσμὸν αὖ λογισάμενος ὡς

18d

PL: Protarchus, I now understand the interaction of these letters more clearly than the other issues, but to me there is the same defect in the argument as there was a moment ago.

18d

S: Philebus, is it that you don't see the point of all this?

18d

PL: Yes. Both Protarchus and I have been trying to see this for some time.

18d

S: Then you have actually been trying to see something that, according to you, has been right in front of you for some time now.

ὄντα ἓνα καὶ πάντα ταῦτα ἓν πως ποιοῦντα μίαν ἐπ' αὐτοῖς ὡς οὕσαν γραμματικὴν τέχνην ἐπεφθέγγατο προσειπών. ΦΙ. ταῦτ' ἔτι σαφέστερον ἐκείνων αὐτά γε πρὸς ἄλληλα, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἔμαθον· τὸ δ' αὐτό μοι τοῦ λόγου νῦν τε καὶ σμικρὸν ἔμπροσθεν ἐλλείπεται. ΣΩ. μὲν, ὦ Φίληβε, τὸ τί πρὸς ἕπος αὖ ταῦτ' ἐστίν; ΦΙ. ναί, τοῦτ' ἔστιν ὃ πάλαί ζητοῦμεν ἐγὼ τε καὶ Πρώταρχος. ΣΩ. ἢ μὴν ἐπ' αὐτῷ γε ἥδη γεγονότες ζητεῖτε, ὡς φήs,

18e

PL: How so?

18e

S: Wasn't our discussion from the outset about understanding and pleasure, and which of the two we should choose?

18e

PL: Yes, of course.

18e

S: And, indeed, we said that each of them is one.

18e

PL: Certainly.

18e

S: Well, this is precisely what the previous argument is asking us. How is each of them one and many? And why are they not limitless immediately, but instead, at some stage, each acquires a particular number before each of them becomes limitless?

πάλαι. ΦΙ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὐ περὶ φρονήσεως ἦν καὶ ἡδονῆς ἡμῖν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ὁ λόγος, ὅποτερον αὐτοῖν αἰρετέον; ΦΙ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἔν γε ἑκάτερον αὐτοῖν εἶναί φαμεν. ΦΙ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. τοῦτ' αὐτὸ τοίνυν ἡμᾶς ὁ πρόσθεν λόγος ἀπαιτεῖ, πῶς ἔστιν ἔν καὶ πολλὰ αὐτῶν ἑκάτερον, καὶ πῶς μὴ ἄπειρα

19a

PR: Socrates has faced us with a far from trivial question, Philebus, though I do not understand the circuitous manner in which he led us here. Anyway, please consider which of us should now respond to what is asked. Now, perhaps it is ridiculous, when I have promised faithfully to take your place in the discussion, to give it back to you again because I cannot answer this question. However, I think it would be much more ridiculous if neither of us could answer. So, please consider what we should do, for Socrates seems to me to be asking whether or not there are forms of pleasure, how many there are, and what they are like. He is also asking the same questions about understanding.

εὐθύς, ἀλλὰ τινά ποτε ἀριθμὸν ἑκάτερον ἔμπροσθεν κέκτηται τοῦ ἄπειρα αὐτῶν ἕκαστα γεγονέναι; ΠΡΩ. οὐκ εἰς φαῦλόν γε ἐρώτημα, ὦ Φίληβε, οὐκ οἶδ' ὄντινα τρόπον κύκλω πως περιαγαγὼν ἡμᾶς ἐμβέβληκε Σωκράτης. καὶ σκόπει δὴ πότερος ἡμῶν ἀποκρινεῖται τὸ νῦν ἐρωτώμενον. ἴσως δὲ γελοῖον τὸ ἐμὲ τοῦ λόγου διάδοχον παντελῶς ὑποστάντα διὰ τὸ μὴ δύνασθαι τὸ νῦν ἐρωτηθὲν ἀποκρίνασθαι σοὶ πάλιν τοῦτο προστάττειν· γελοιότερον

19b

S: What you say is very true, dear son of Callias. Yes, our previous discussion showed that if we are unable to do this in the case of

anything which is one, like or the same, or in the case of their opposites, none of us will ever be of any value in any subject.

δ' οἶμαι πολὺν τὸ μηδέτερον ἡμῶν δύνασθαι. σκόπει δὴ τί δράσομεν. εἶδῃ γάρ μοι δοκεῖ νῦν ἐρωτᾶν ἡδονῆς ἡμᾶς Σωκράτης εἴτε ἔστιν εἴτε μή, καὶ ὅποσα ἐστὶ καὶ ὅποια· τῆς τ' αὖ φρονήσεως πέρι κατὰ ταῦτα ὡσαύτως. ΣΩ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις, ὦ παῖ Καλλίου· μὴ γὰρ δυνάμενοι τοῦτο κατὰ παντὸς ἐνὸς καὶ ὁμοίου καὶ ταύτου δρᾶν καὶ τοῦ ἐναντίου, ὥς ὁ παρελθὼν λόγος ἐμήνυσεν, οὐδεὶς εἰς οὐδὲν οὐδενὸς ἂν ἡμῶν οὐδέποτε γένοιτο ἄξιος.

19c

PR: Socrates, it is quite likely that this is so. Now, while it is good for a wise man to know everything, his second-best course seems to lie in not forgetting himself. Well, why do I say this just now? I shall tell you. You granted this audience and your presence to all of us in order to determine what human acquisition is supreme. Indeed, when Philebus said that it is pleasure, enjoyment and delight, and everything of that sort, you disputed this and said that these are not the best. Rather, it is the other things which we are continually recalling, on purpose, in order to test both possibilities side by side in mind. You seem to be proposing that the good, which is really better than pleasure, is reason, knowledge, understanding, skill, and all that is related thereto. These we must acquire, and not those others. Well, when these two assertions were made and there was a dispute, we threatened, playfully, that we would not let you go home until these discussions had come to an end, and had been duly clarified. You went along with this and made yourself available to us for this purpose. Therefore we are saying now, just like children, that a gift rightly given cannot be taken back. So, please desist from this manner of opposing us in the present discussion.

ΠΡΩ. σχεδὸν ἔοικεν οὕτως, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔχειν. ἀλλὰ καλὸν μὲν τὸ σύμπαντα γινώσκειν τῷ σώφρονι, δεύτερος δ' εἶναι πλοῦς δοκεῖ μὴ λανθάνειν αὐτὸν αὐτόν. τί δὴ μοι τοῦτο εἴρηται τὰ νῦν; ἐγὼ σοι φράσω. σὺ τήνδε ἡμῖν τὴν συνουσίαν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐπέδωκας πᾶσι καὶ σεαυτὸν

πρὸς τὸ διελέσθαι τί τῶν ἀνθρωπίνων κτημάτων ἄριστον. Φιλήβου γὰρ εἰπόντος ἡδονὴν καὶ τέρψιν καὶ χαρὰν καὶ πάνθ' ὅποσα τοιαῦτ' ἐστί, σὺ πρὸς αὐτὰ ἀντεῖπες ὥς οὐ ταῦτα ἀλλ' ἐκεῖνά ἐστιν ἃ πολλάκις ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς ἀναμιμνήσκομεν ἐκόντες, ὀρθῶς δρῶντες, ἴν' ἐν μνήμῃ παρακείμενα ἐκάτερα βασανίζεται. φῆς δ', ὥς ἔοικε, σὺ τὸ προσρηθησόμενον ὀρθῶς ἄμεινον ἡδονῆς γε ἀγαθὸν εἶναι νοῦν, ἐπιστήμην, σύνεσιν, τέχνην καὶ πάντα αὐτὰ τούτων συγγενῇ, ἃ κτᾶσθαι δεῖν ἀλλ' οὐχὶ ἐκεῖνα. τούτων δὴ μετ' ἀμφισβητήσεως ἐκατέρων λεχθέντων ἡμεῖς σοι μετὰ παιδιᾶς ἠπειλήσαμεν

19e

S: What do you mean?

ὥς οὐκ ἀφήσομεν οἵκαδ' σε πρὶν ἂν τούτων τῶν λόγων πέρας ἱκανὸν γένηται τι διορισθέντων, σὺ δὲ συνεχώρησας καὶ ἔδωκας εἰς ταῦθ' ἡμῖν σαυτόν, ἡμεῖς δὲ δὴ λέγομεν, καθάπερ οἱ παῖδες, ὅτι τῶν ὀρθῶς δοθέντων ἀφαίρεσις οὐκ ἔστι· παῦσαι δὴ τὸν τρόπον ἡμῖν ἀπαντῶν τοῦτον ἐπὶ τὰ νῦν λεγόμενα. ΣΩ. τίνα λέγεις;

20a

PR: Casting us into perplexity, and asking questions to which we cannot give you a proper response right now. Indeed, let's not imagine that our aim is to make us all perplexed. Rather, if we prove unable to answer, then you must do so, as that is what you promised. So decide this for yourself. Should the forms of pleasure and of knowledge be distinguished by you, or instead left alone because you are somehow able to clarify the issues under dispute in some other way, and are willing to do so?

ΠΡΩ. εἰς ἀπορίαν ἐμβάλλων καὶ ἀνερωτῶν ὧν μὴ δυνάμεθ' ἂν ἱκανὴν ἀπόκρισιν ἐν τῷ παρόντι διδόναι σοι. μὴ γὰρ οἴωμεθα τέλος ἡμῖν εἶναι τῶν νῦν τὴν πάντων ἡμῶν ἀπορίαν, ἀλλ' εἰ δρᾶν τοῦθ' ἡμεῖς ἀδυνατοῦμεν, σοὶ δραστέον· ὑπέσχου γάρ. βουλευοῦ δὴ πρὸς ταῦτα αὐτὸς πότερον ἡδονῆς εἶδη σοι καὶ ἐπιστήμης διαιρετέον ἢ καὶ ἑατέον, εἴ πη καθ' ἕτερόν τινα τρόπον οἷός τ' εἶ καὶ βούλει δηλῶσαί πως ἄλλως τὰ νῦν ἀμφισβητούμενα παρ' ἡμῖν.

20b

S: Well, since you put it like that, I no longer expect anything dreadful, for the phrase “if you are willing” takes away all fear about anything. And besides this, I think that one of the gods has given me a reminder to help us.

20b

PR: A reminder of what?

20b

S: Of certain arguments about pleasure and understanding which I once heard a long time ago, whether in a dream or whilst awake. I now realise that they said that the good was neither of these, but a third entity, different from them and better than both of them. And, indeed, if this were now to become evident to us, then pleasure would be deprived of its victory, since the good would no longer be the same as pleasure, would it?

ΣΩ. δεινὸν μὲν τοίνυν ἔτι προσδοκᾶν οὐδὲν δεῖ τὸν ἐμέ, ἐπειδὴ τοῦθ' οὕτως εἶπες· τὸ γὰρ εἰ βούλει ῥηθὲν λύει πάντα φόβον ἐκάστων πέρι. πρὸς δὲ αὖ τοῖς μνήμην τινὰ δοκεῖ τίς μοι δεδωκέναι θεῶν ἡμῖν. ΠΡΩ. πῶς δὴ καὶ τίνων; ΣΩ. λόγων ποτέ τινων πάλαι ἀκούσας ὄναρ ἢ καὶ ἐγρηγορῶς νῦν ἐννοῶ περὶ τε ἡδονῆς καὶ φρονήσεως, ὡς οὐδέτερον αὐτοῖν ἐστὶ τάγαθόν, ἀλλὰ ἄλλο τι τρίτον, ἕτερον μὲν τούτων, ἄμεινον δὲ ἀμφοῖν. καίτοι τοῦτό γε ἂν ἐναργῶς

20c

PR: Quite so.

20c

S: And as I see it, we shall no longer need this distinction between the forms of pleasure, but that will become even clearer as we go on.

20c

PR: That is very well expressed. Keep discussing it like that.

20c

S: Well, let us agree on a few more little details first.

20c

PR: What sort of details? ----- 2 Theuth was the Egyptian god of the moon, knowledge, wisdom, writing, hieroglyphics, etc. He was often depicted with the head of an ibis.

ήμῖν φανῆ νῦν, ἀπήλλακται μὲν ἡδονὴ τοῦ νικᾶν· τὸ γὰρ ἀγαθὸν οὐκ ἂν ἔτι ταῦτόν αὐτῇ γίγνοιτο. ἢ πῶς; ΠΡΩ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. τῶν δέ γε εἰς τὴν διαίρεσιν εἰδῶν ἡδονῆς οὐδὲν ἔτι προσδεησόμεθα κατ' ἐμὴν δόξαν. προῖόν δ' ἔτι σαφέστερον δείξει. ΠΡΩ. κάλλιστ' εἰπὼν οὕτω καὶ διαπέραινε. ΣΩ. μίkr' ἄττα τοίνυν ἔμπροσθεν ἔτι διομολογησόμεθα. ΠΡΩ. τὰ ποῖα;

20d

S: Whether that which holds the rank of good is necessarily perfect or imperfect.

20d

PR: Surely, Socrates, it is the most perfect of all things?

20d

S: What about this? Is the good sufficient?

20d

PR: How could it not be? Yes, in this regard it exceeds everything else there is.

20d

S: Indeed, I believe it is imperative to state that whatever recognises the good, pursues and desires it, and wishes to capture and acquire it for itself, and thinks of nothing else except whatever also achieves good.

20d

PR: It's not possible to contradict that.

ΣΩ. τὴν τἀγαθοῦ μοῖραν πότερον ἀνάγκη τέλεον ἢ μὴ τέλεον εἶναι; ΠΡΩ. πάντων δήπου τελεώτατον, ὧ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἱκανὸν τἀγαθόν; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; καὶ πάντων γε εἰς τοῦτο διαφέρειν τῶν ὄντων. ΣΩ. τόδε γε μὴν, ὥς οἶμαι, περὶ αὐτοῦ ἀναγκαιότατον εἶναι λέγειν, ὥς πᾶν τὸ γιγνώσκον αὐτὸ θηρεύει καὶ ἐφίεται βουλόμενον

ἐλεῖν καὶ περὶ αὐτὸ κτήσασθαι, καὶ τῶν ἄλλων οὐδὲν φροντίζει πλὴν τῶν ἀποτελουμένων ἅμα ἀγαθοῖς. ΠΡΩ. οὐκ ἔστι τούτοις ἀντειπεῖν.

20e

S: Well, let us consider the life of pleasure and the life of understanding, and judge them by looking at each on its own.

20e

PR: How do you mean?

20e

S: Let there be no understanding in the life of pleasure, and no pleasure in the life of understanding. For if either of them is the good, it must not stand in further need of anything else at all. And if either of them turns out to be deficient, presumably that is not yet the true good, according to us.

ΣΩ. σκοπῶμεν δὴ καὶ κρίνωμεν τὸν τε ἡδονῆς καὶ τὸν φρονήσεως βίον ἰδόντες χωρίς. ΠΡΩ. πῶς εἶπες; ΣΩ. μήτε ἐν τῷ τῆς ἡδονῆς ἐνέστω φρόνησις μήτ' ἐν τῷ τῆς φρονήσεως ἡδονή. δεῖ γάρ, εἴπερ πότερον αὐτῶν ἔστ' ἀγαθόν, μηδὲν μηδενὸς ἔτι προσδεῖσθαι δεόμενον δ'

21a

PR: No. How could it be?

21a

S: Now, shall we try testing them out on you?

21a

PR: Yes, certainly.

21a

S: Then answer some questions.

21a

PR: Just ask.

21a

S: Protarchus, would you consent to live your entire life enjoying the greatest pleasures?

21a

PR: Yes, why not?

21a

S: And do you think you would still lack something if this life was yours entirely?

21a

PR: Not at all.

21a

S: Are you sure you wouldn't need to understand, reason, and work out what was needed, and that sort of thing?

ἂν φανῇ πότερον, οὐκ ἔστι που τοῦτ' ἔτι τὸ ὄντως ἡμῖν ἀγαθόν. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐν σοὶ πειρώμεθα βασανίζοντες ταῦτα; ΠΡΩ. πάννυ μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. ἀποκρίνου δή. ΠΡΩ. λέγε. ΣΩ. δέξαι' ἄν, Πρώταρχε, σὺ ζῆν τὸν βίον ἅπαντα ἡδόμενος ἡδονὰς τὰς μεγίστας; ΠΡΩ. τί δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὔν ἔτι τινὸς ἄν σοι προσδεῖν ἡγοῖο, εἰ τοῦτ' ἔχεις παντελῶς; ΠΡΩ. οὐδαμῶς. ΣΩ. ὅρα δή, τοῦ φρονεῖν καὶ τοῦ νοεῖν καὶ λογίζεσθαι

21b

PR: But why? Surely I would have everything once I had enjoyment.

21b

S: So, if you lived like this, would you always enjoy the utmost pleasure throughout life?

21b

PR: Why not?

21b

S: And yet, without acquiring reason, memory, knowledge and true opinion, you must firstly, I presume, be ignorant of the very fact that you are enjoying or not enjoying, since you are devoid of all understanding.

21b

PR: I must.

τὰ δέοντα καὶ ὅσα τούτων ἀδελφά, μῶν μὴ δέοι' ἄν τι; ΠΡΩ. καὶ τί; πάντα γὰρ ἔχοιμ' ἄν που τὸ χαίρειν ἔχων. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οὕτω ζῶν ἀεὶ μὲν διὰ βίου ταῖς μεγίσταις ἡδοναῖς χαίροις ἄν; ΠΡΩ. τί δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. νοῦν δέ γε καὶ μνήμην καὶ ἐπιστήμην καὶ δόξαν μὴ κεκτημένος ἀληθῆ, πρῶτον μὲν

τοῦτο αὐτό, εἰ χαίρεις ἢ μὴ χαίρεις, ἀνάγκη δήπου σε ἀγνοεῖν, κενόν γε ὄντα πάσης φρονήσεως; ΠΡΩ. ἀνάγκη.

21c

S: And, indeed, since you have not acquired memory either, you would be unable to remember what you once enjoyed, and no memory whatsoever would remain of the pleasure you experience in any moment. What's more, when there is enjoyment, you could not form the opinion that you are enjoying something since you have not acquired true opinion. And without calculation, you could not work out what you would enjoy in the future. Your life would not be the life of a man, but of some jellyfish or of sea creatures whose bodies are encased in shells. Are these the facts, or are there alternatives we can consider?

ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ὡσαύτως μνήμην μὴ κεκτημένον ἀνάγκη δήπου μὴδ' ὅτι ποτὲ ἔχαιρες μεμνήσθαι, τῆς τ' ἐν τῷ παραχρῆμα ἡδονῆς προσπιπτούσης μὴδ' ἡντινοῦν μνήμην ὑπομένειν· δόξαν δ' αὖ μὴ κεκτημένον ἀληθῆ μὴ δοξάζειν χαίρειν χαίροντα, λογισμοῦ δὲ στερόμενον μὴδ' εἰς τὸν ἔπειτα χρόνον ὡς χαίρήσεις δυνατὸν εἶναι λογίζεσθαι, ζῆν δὲ οὐκ ἀνθρώπου βίον, ἀλλὰ τινος πλεύμονος ἢ τῶν ὅσα θαλάττια μετ' ὀστρεῖνων ἔμψυχά ἐστι σωμάτων. ἔστι ταῦτα, ἢ παρὰ

21d

PR: No. How could there be?

21d

S: Well now, do we want a life like that?

21d

PR: This last argument has, for the moment, rendered me totally speechless, Socrates.

21d

S: Let us not give up just yet. We should turn to the life of reason, and consider that.

21d

PR: What sort of life do you mean?

21d

S: It arises if one of us agrees to live in possession of understanding, reason, knowledge and a complete memory of everything, but with no participation, large or small, in pleasure or pain either, but totally devoid of all such experience.

ταῦτα ἔχομεν ἄλλα διανοηθῆναι; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πῶς; ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν αἰρετὸς ἡμῖν βίος ὁ τοιοῦτος; ΠΡΩ. εἰς ἀφασίαν παντάπασί με, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὗτος ὁ λόγος ἐμβέβληκε τὰ νῦν. ΣΩ. μήπω τοίνυν μαλθακιζόμεθα, τὸν δὲ τοῦ νοῦ μεταλαμβάνοντες αὐτὸν βίον ἴδωμεν. ΠΡΩ. τὸν ποῖον δὴ λέγεις; ΣΩ. εἴ τις δέξαιτ' ἂν αὐτὸ ζῆν ἡμῶν φρόνησιν μὲν καὶ νοῦν καὶ ἐπιστήμην καὶ μνήμην πᾶσαν πάντων κεκτημένος,

21e

PR: Neither of these lives would ever be attractive to me, Socrates, nor I imagine to anyone else.

ἡδονῆς δὲ μετέχων μήτε μέγα μήτε σμικρόν, μηδ' αὐτὸ λύπης, ἀλλὰ τὸ παράπαν ἀπαθὲς πάντων τῶν τοιούτων. ΠΡΩ. οὐδέτερος ὁ βίος, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔμοιγε τούτων αἰρετός, οὐδ' ἄλλω μή ποτε, ὡς ἐγὼμαι, φανῇ.

22a

S: And what about the composite, Protarchus, a combination formed by mixing the two?

22a

PR: Do you mean a combination of the life of pleasure and the life of reason and understanding?

22a

S: Yes, that's the sort of thing I mean.

22a

PR: Surely everyone would choose that kind of life in preference to the other two. There will be no exceptions.

22a

S: Now, do we understand what the consequence is for the propositions we are discussing?

ΣΩ. τί δ' ὁ συναμφοτέρος, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἐξ ἀμφοῖν συμμειχθεὶς κοινὸς γενόμενος; ΠΡΩ. ἡδονῆς λέγεις καὶ νοῦ καὶ φρονήσεως; ΣΩ. οὕτω καὶ τῶν τοιούτων λέγω ἔγωγε. ΠΡΩ. πᾶς δήπου τοῦτόν γε αἰρήσεται πρότερον ἢ 'κείνων ὅποτερον οὖν, καὶ πρὸς τούτοις γε οὐχ ὁ μὲν, ὁ δ' οὐ. ΣΩ. μανθάνομεν οὖν ὅτι νῦν ἡμῖν ἐστὶ τὸ συμβαῖνον ἐν τοῖς παροῦσι λόγοις; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, ὅτι γε τρεῖς μὲν βίοι προυτέθησαν,

22b

PR: Yes, certainly. Three lives have been proposed, two of which are not adequate or desirable for man or any other creature.

22b

S: And isn't it obvious at this stage that neither of these two lives actually held the good? If one of them did, it would be adequate and complete and desirable to any plants or animals which were capable of living their entire lives in that way. And if any of us chose any other, his choice would be opposed to the nature of the truly desirable, and it would be made unwillingly, under ignorance or some unfortunate compulsion.

22b

PR: So it seems, anyway.

τοῖν δυοῖν δ' οὐδέτερος ἱκανὸς οὐδὲ αἰρετὸς οὔτε ἀνθρώπων οὔτε ζώων οὐδενί. ΣΩ. μὴ οὖν οὐκ ἤδη τούτων γε πέρι δῆλον ὡς οὐδέτερος αὐτοῖν εἶχε τάγαθόν; ἦν γὰρ ἂν ἱκανὸς καὶ τέλος καὶ πᾶσι φυτοῖς καὶ ζώοις αἰρετός, οἷσπερ δυνατόν ἦν οὕτως αἰεὶ διὰ βίου ζῆν· εἰ δέ τις ἄλλα ἡρεῖτο ἡμῶν, παρὰ φύσιν ἂν τὴν τοῦ ἀληθῶς αἰρετοῦ ἐλάμβανεν ἄκων ἐξ ἀγνοίας ἢ τινος ἀνάγκης οὐκ εὐδαίμονος. ΠΡΩ. ἔοικε γοῦν ταῦθ' οὕτως ἔχειν.

22c

S: Then, I think we have said enough to show that Philebus' goddess should not be regarded as the same as the good.

22c

PL: Yes, Socrates. But your reason is not the good either, since presumably the same objections apply.

22c

S: Perhaps this is so, Philebus, in the case of my reason. But I think it is somehow different for the true and divine reason. Now, I shall not yet claim first place for reason over the combined life, so we must look at second place and decide what to do about that. Indeed, one of us will probably claim that the basis of this combined life is reason, and the other that it is pleasure, and so, although neither of these two would be the good, perhaps we might appreciate that one of them is the basis of the good. Now, on this issue I would argue more intensely against Philebus, that in the case of this mixed life, the acquisition which renders this life preferable and good – an acquisition which is kindred to it and resembles it – is not pleasure but reason. And on this account, pleasure could never be said to have a true claim to first or second place. No, it is further back than third, if my reasoning is now to be trusted.

ΣΩ. ὥς μὲν τοίνυν τήν γε Φιλήβου θεὸν οὐ δεῖ διανοεῖσθαι ταῦτόν καὶ τάγαθόν, ἱκανῶς εἰρήσθαι μοι δοκεῖ. ΦΙ. οὐδὲ γὰρ ὁ σὸς νοῦς, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἔστι τάγαθόν, ἀλλ' ἔξει που ταῦτ' ἐγκλήματα. ΣΩ. τάχ' ἂν, ὃ Φίληβε, ὅ γ' ἐμός· οὐ μέντοι τόν γε ἀληθινὸν ἅμα καὶ θεῖον οἶμαι νοῦν, ἀλλ' ἄλλως πως ἔχειν. τῶν μὲν οὖν νικητηρίων πρὸς τὸν κοινὸν βίον οὐκ ἀμφισβητῶ πω ὑπὲρ νοῦ, τῶν δὲ δὴ δευτερείων ὁρᾶν καὶ σκοπεῖν χρή περὶ τί δράσομεν· τάχα γὰρ ἂν τοῦ κοινοῦ τούτου βίου αἰτιώμεθ' ἂν ἑκάτερος ὁ μὲν τὸν νοῦν αἴτιον, ὁ δ' ἡδονὴν εἶναι, καὶ οὕτω τὸ μὲν ἀγαθὸν τούτων ἀμφοτέρων οὐδέτερον ἂν εἴη, τάχα δ' ἂν αἰτιὸν τις ὑπολάβοι πότερον αὐτῶν εἶναι. τούτου δὴ περὶ καὶ μᾶλλον ἔτι πρὸς Φίληβον διαμαχοίμην ἂν ὥς ἐν τῷ μεικτῷ τούτῳ βίῳ, ὅτι ποτ' ἔστι τοῦτο ὃ λαβὼν ὁ βίος οὗτος γέγονεν αἰρετὸς ἅμα καὶ ἀγαθός, οὐχ ἡδονὴ ἀλλὰ νοῦς τούτῳ συγγενέστερον καὶ ὁμοιότερόν ἐστι, καὶ κατὰ τοῦτον

22e

PR: Well, Socrates, it seems to me that pleasure has now fallen, as if struck down by your present arguments as it battled for first place. Reason, on the other hand, seems to have acted wisely when it did not

claim primacy, for the same thing would have happened to it. But if pleasure were now deprived entirely of second place, it would suffer a disgrace in the eyes of its own lovers, for it would no longer appear quite so beautiful even to them.

τὸν λόγον οὐτ' ἂν τῶν πρωτείων οὐδ' αὖ τῶν δευτερείων ἡδονῇ μετὸν ἀληθῶς ἂν ποτε λέγοιτο πορρωτέρω δ' ἐστὶ τῶν τριτείων, εἴ τι τῷ ἐμῷ νῷ δεῖ πιστεύειν ἡμᾶς τὰ νῦν. ΠΡΩ. ἀλλὰ μήν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔμοιγε δοκεῖ νῦν μὲν ἡδονή σοι πεπτωκέναι καθαπερεὶ πληγεῖσα ὑπὸ τῶν νυνδὴ λόγων· τῶν γὰρ νικητηρίων πέρι μαχομένη κεῖται. τὸν δὲ

23a

S: In that case, is it not better to leave it alone rather than subjecting it to the pain of intense scrutiny and cross-examination?

23a

PR: You are talking nonsense, Socrates.

νοῦν, ὥς ἔοικε, λεκτέον ὥς ἐμφρόνως οὐκ ἀντεποιεῖτο τῶν νικητηρίων· τὰ γὰρ αὐτ' ἔπαθεν ἂν. τῶν δὲ δὴ δευτερείων στερηθεῖσα ἡδονὴ παντάπασιν ἂν τίνα καὶ ἀτιμίαν σχοίη πρὸς τῶν αὐτῆς ἐραστῶν· οὐδὲ γὰρ ἐκείνοις ἔτ' ἂν ὁμοίως φαίνοιτο καλή. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; οὐκ ἄμεινον αὐτὴν ἔαν ἦδη καὶ μὴ τὴν ἀκριβεστάτην αὐτῇ προσφέροντα βάσανον καὶ ἐξελέγχοντα λυπεῖν; ΠΡΩ. οὐδὲν λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες.

23b

S: Is that because I am proposing something impossible, namely that pleasure experiences pain?

23b

PR: That's not the only reason. You are also forgetting that none of us will ever let you go until you have brought the discussion of these matters to a conclusion.

23b

S: Oh, dear Protarchus, then a lengthy discussion lies ahead, while the current issue is hardly an easy one either. Indeed, it also appears that we need another means of securing second place for reason, different

weaponry from the previous arguments, though perhaps some will be the same. Is this what we must do?

23b

PR: Yes, we must.

ΣΩ. ἄρ' ὅτι τὸ ἀδύνατον εἶπον, λυπεῖν ἡδονήν; ΠΡΩ. οὐ μόνον γε ἀλλ' ὅτι καὶ ἀγνοεῖς ὡς οὐδεὶς πῶ σε ἡμῶν μεθήσει πρὶν ἂν εἰς τέλος ἐπεξέλθῃς τούτων τῷ λόγῳ. ΣΩ. βαβαῖ ἄρα, ὦ Πρώταρχε, συχνοῦ μὲν λόγου τοῦ λοιποῦ, σχεδὸν δὲ οὐδὲ ῥαδίου πάνυ τι νῦν. καὶ γὰρ δὴ φαίνεται δεῖν ἄλλης μηχανῆς, ἐπὶ τὰ δευτερεῖα ὑπὲρ νοῦ πορευόμενον οἷον βέλη ἔχειν ἕτερα τῶν ἔμπροσθεν λόγων· ἔστι δὲ ἴσως ἔνια καὶ ταῦτά. οὐκοῦν χρή; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὔ;

23c

S: But we should try to be careful about where we propose to begin.

23c

PR: What do you mean?

23c

S: Let us divide everything that is now in the universe into two, or better still, if that is alright, into three.

23c

PR: On what basis would you propose to do this?

23c

S: Let us take some elements from our present arguments.

23c

PR: Of what kind?

23c

S: I believe we said that the god revealed the limited, and also the limitless, in things that are.

23c

PR: Yes, certainly.

ΣΩ. τὴν δέ γε ἀρχὴν αὐτοῦ διευλαβεῖσθαι πειρώμεθα τιθέμενοι. ΠΡΩ. ποίαν δὴ λέγεις; ΣΩ. πάντα τὰ νῦν ὄντα ἐν τῷ παντὶ διχῇ διαλάβωμεν,

μᾶλλον δ', εἰ βούλει, τριχῇ. ΠΡΩ. καθ' ὅτι, φράζοις ἅν; ΣΩ. λάβωμεν ἅττα τῶν νυνδὴ λόγων. ΠΡΩ. ποῖα; ΣΩ. τὸν θεὸν ἐλέγομέν· που τὸ μὲν ἄπειρον δεῖξαι τῶν ὄντων, τὸ δὲ πέρας; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. τούτω δὴ τῶν εἰδῶν τὰ δύο τιθώμεθα, τὸ δὲ τρίτον

23d

S: Well, let's propose these as two of our forms, and the third combines both of them into one. But it does seem that I am a comical fellow when it comes to defining and enumerating forms.

23d

PR: My goodness, what are you saying?

23d

S: It appears to me that a fourth kind is also required.

23d

PR: Tell us what it is.

23d

S: Note the cause of the commingling of these with one another, and grant me that as the fourth in addition to the other three.

23d

PR: Would you not also need a fifth element which is able to separate them?

23d

S: Perhaps, but I do not think we actually need it right now. However, I presume you will forgive me if I do go after a fifth kind, should that prove necessary.

ἐξ ἀμφοῖν τούτοις ἔν τι συμμίσγόμενον. εἰμὶ δ', ὥς ἔοικεν, ἐγὼ γελοῖός τις ἄνθρωπος κατ' εἶδη διιστάς καὶ συναριθμούμενος. ΠΡΩ. τί φῆς, ὠγαθέ; ΣΩ. τετάρτου μοι γένους αὖ προσδεῖν φαίνεται. ΠΡΩ. λέγε τίνος. ΣΩ. τῆς συμμείξεως τούτων πρὸς ἄλληλα τὴν αἰτίαν ὅρα, καὶ τίθει μοι πρὸς τρισὶν ἐκείνοις τέταρτον τοῦτο. ΠΡΩ. μὴν οὖν σοι καὶ πέμπτου προσδεήσει διάκρισιν τίνος δυναμένου; ΣΩ. τάχ' ἂν· οὐ μὴν οἴμαι γε ἐν τῷ νῦν ἂν δέ τι δέη,

23e

PR: Of course.

23e

S: Well then, having first separated three of the four, and noted that two of these are each multiple as they are split up and dispersed, let us make each of them one again, and try to understand how each was ever both one and many.

23e

PR: If you could tell me about them a little more clearly, perhaps I might follow you.

συγγνώση πού μοι σὺ μεταδιώκοντι πέμπτον βίον. ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. πρῶτον μὲν δὴ τῶν τεττάρων τὰ τρία διελόμενοι, τὰ δύο τούτων πειρώμεθα, πολλὰ ἐκάτερον ἐσχισμένον καὶ διεσπασμένον ἰδόντες, εἰς ἓν πάλιν ἐκάτερον συναγαγόντες, νοῆσαι πῇ ποτε ἦν αὐτῶν ἓν καὶ πολλὰ ἐκάτερον. ΠΡΩ. εἴ μοι σαφέστερον ἔτι περὶ αὐτῶν εἴποις, τάχ' ἂν ἐποίμην.

24a

S: Well, I mean that the two which I am proposing are the same as the two we mentioned just now – the limitless and that which has limit – and I shall try to explain that the limitless is, in some way, many. That which has limit can wait.

24a

PR: Yes, let it wait.

24a

S: Now, think about this. Indeed, what I am asking you to consider is controversial and difficult, but consider it nevertheless. First ask whether you could ever discern any limit to hotter and colder, or whether the greater and the lesser which resides within these kinds themselves would never allow any end to come about, as long as more and less are present. Indeed, if an end were to come about, the more and less would be finished.

ΣΩ. λέγω τοίνυν τὰ δύο ἃ προτίθεμαι ταῦτ' εἶναι ἅπερ νυνδὴ, τὸ μὲν ἄπειρον, τὸ δὲ πέρας ἔχον· ὅτι δὲ τρόπον τινὰ τὸ ἄπειρον πόλλ' ἐστί,

πειράσομαι φράζειν. τὸ δὲ πέρας ἔχον ἡμᾶς περιμενέτω. ΠΡΩ. μένει. ΣΩ. σκέψαι δὴ. χαλεπὸν μὲν γὰρ καὶ ἀμφισβητήσιμον ὃ κελεύω σε σκοπεῖν, ὅμως δὲ σκόπει. θερμότερου καὶ ψυχροτέρου πέρι πρῶτον ὅρα πέρας εἴ ποτέ τι νοήσῃς ἄν, ἢ τὸ μᾶλλον τε καὶ ἥττον ἐν αὐτοῖς οἰκοῦντε τοῖς γένεσιν,

24b

PR: What you say is very true.

24b

S: However, we say that both the greater and the lesser are always present in the hotter and the colder.

24b

PR: Very much so.

24b

S: Then our argument shows that these two are always without an end. And surely, since they have no end, they are entirely limitless.

24b

PR: Yes, it shows that quite strongly, Socrates.

ἕωσπερ ἂν ἐνοικῆτον, τέλος οὐκ ἂν ἐπιτρεψαίτην γίγνεσθαι γενομένης γὰρ τελευτῆς καὶ αὐτῷ τετελευτήκατον. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἀεὶ δέ γε, φαμέν, ἔν τε τῷ θερμότερῳ καὶ ψυχροτέρῳ τὸ μᾶλλον τε καὶ ἥττον ἔνι. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. ἀεὶ τοίνυν ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν σημαίνει τούτῳ μὴ τέλος ἔχειν· ἀτελῇ δ' ὄντε δήπου παντάπασιν ἀπείρῳ γίγνεσθον. ΠΡΩ. καὶ σφόδρα γε, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εὖ γε, ὦ φίλε Πρώταρχε, ὑπέλαβες καὶ

24c

S: Now, you have answered very well, dear Protarchus, and have reminded me that the word strongly, which you have just uttered, and the word weakly, have the same force as 'more' and 'less'. Indeed, wherever they are present they do not allow a specific quantity to exist, but they always make activities stronger rather than weaker, or the other way around, and give rise to more and to less, but they eliminate specific quantity. For as we just said, if they did not eliminate

quantity, but allowed quantity and measure to arise where greater, lesser, stronger and weaker are situated, these classes themselves would disappear from the very positions they occupied. Indeed, they would no longer be hotter or colder once they had acquired quantity, for hotter is constantly advancing and does not stand still, and the same applies to colder. But quantity is fixed and has stopped advancing. So, based upon this argument, hotter, and its opposite too, turn out to be limitless.

ἀνέμνησας ὅτι καὶ τὸ σφόδρα τοῦτο, ὃ σὺ νῦν ἐφθέγγω, καὶ τό γε ἡρέμα τὴν αὐτὴν δύναμιν ἔχετον τῷ μᾶλλον τε καὶ ἥττον· ὅπου γὰρ ἂν ἐνήτον, οὐκ ἔατον εἶναι ποσὸν ἕκαστον, ἀλλ' αἰὶ σφοδρότερον ἡσυχαιτέρου καὶ τούναντίον ἐκάσταις πράξεσιν ἐμποιοῦντε τὸ πλεόν καὶ τὸ ἔλαττον ἀπεργάζεσθον, τὸ δὲ ποσὸν ἀφανίζετον. ὃ γὰρ ἐλέχθη νυνδὴ, μὴ ἀφανίσαντε τὸ ποσόν, ἀλλ' ἐάσαντε αὐτό τε καὶ τὸ μέτριον ἐν τῇ

24d

PR: So it appears anyway, Socrates. But as you say, this is not easy to follow. And perhaps going over it again and again may demonstrate that questioner and respondent are in quite close agreement.

τοῦ μᾶλλον καὶ ἥττον καὶ σφόδρα καὶ ἡρέμα ἔδρα ἐγγενέσθαι, αὐτὰ ἔρρει ταῦτα ἐκ τῆς αὐτῶν χώρας ἐν ἧ ἐνήν. οὐ γὰρ ἔτι θερμότερον οὐδὲ ψυχρότερον εἴτην ἂν λαβόντε τὸ ποσόν· προχωρεῖ γὰρ καὶ οὐ μένει τό τε θερμότερον αἰὶ καὶ τὸ ψυχρότερον ὡσαύτως, τὸ δὲ ποσὸν ἔστη καὶ προῖον ἐπαύσατο. κατὰ δὴ τοῦτον τὸν λόγον ἄπειρον γίγνοιτ' ἂν τὸ θερμότερον καὶ τούναντίον ἅμα. ΠΡΩ. φαίνεται γοῦν, ὦ Σώκρατες· ἔστι δ', ὅπερ εἶπες, οὐ ῥάδια ταῦτα συνέπεσθαι. τὸ δὲ εἰς αὐθὶς τε καὶ αὐθὶς

24e

S: Yes, that is a good suggestion, and we should try to do that. But first consider whether we shall accept a particular characteristic of the nature of the limitless, so that we do not make the discussion too lengthy and detailed.

24e

PR: What sort of characteristic do you mean?

24e

S: Whatever appears to us to become more and less, or involves strength and mildness, or excess and everything of that sort, should all be placed in the limitless as though it were a single kind. This is based on our previous argument that whatever is split up and dispersed should be brought together, and its single nature indicated, as best we can. Do you remember?

ἴσως λεχθέντα τόν τε ἐρωτῶντα καὶ τὸν ἐρωτῶμενον ἱκανῶς ἂν συμφωνοῦντας ἀποφῆναιεν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εὖ μὲν λέγεις καὶ πειρατέον οὕτω ποιεῖν. νῦν μέντοι ἄθρει τῆς τοῦ ἀπείρου φύσεως εἰ τοῦτο δεξόμεθα σημεῖον, ἵνα μὴ πάντ' ἐπεξιόντες μηκύνωμεν. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον δὴ λέγεις; ΣΩ. ὅπόσ' ἂν ἡμῖν φαίνεται μᾶλλον τε καὶ ἥττον γιγνόμενα καὶ τὸ σφόδρα καὶ ἥρέμα δεχόμενα καὶ τὸ λίαν καὶ ὅσα

25a

PR: I remember.

25a

S: Again, whatever does not involve these but involves all their opposites – first, the equal and equality, and after the equal, the double, and any relation of number to number or measure to measure – all of these should be counted among the limited. This would appear to be our best approach. What do you think?

τοιαῦτα πάντα, εἰς τὸ τοῦ ἀπείρου γένος ὡς εἰς ἓν δεῖ πάντα ταῦτα τιθέναι, κατὰ τὸν ἔμπροσθεν λόγον ὃν ἔφαμεν ὅσα διέσπασται καὶ διέσχισται συναγαγόντας χρῆναι κατὰ δύναμιν μίαν ἐπισημαίνεσθαί τινα φύσιν, εἰ μέμνησαι. ΠΡΩ. μέμνημαι. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰ μὴ δεχόμενα ταῦτα, τούτων δὲ τὰ ἐναντία πάντα δεχόμενα, πρῶτον μὲν τὸ ἴσον καὶ ἰσότητα, μετὰ δὲ τὸ ἴσον τὸ διπλάσιον καὶ πᾶν ὅτιπερ ἂν πρὸς ἀριθμὸν ἀριθμὸς

25b

PR: Yes, very properly, Socrates.

25b

S: Very well. But what about the third kind, the mixture of these two? What characteristic shall we say that this possesses?

25b

PR: I think you are also going to answer that question for me.

25b

S: A god will certainly answer, if one of the gods happens to hear my prayers.

25b

PR: Then pray, and watch.

25b

S: I am watching, Protarchus, and it seems to me that one of them has befriended us just now.

ἢ μέτρον ἢ πρὸς μέτρον, ταῦτα σύμπαντα εἰς τὸ πέρας ἀπολογιζόμενοι καλῶς ἂν δοκοῖμεν δρᾶν τοῦτο. ἢ πῶς σὺ φής; ΠΡΩ. κάλλιστά γε, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. εἶεν· τὸ δὲ τρίτον τὸ μεικτὸν ἐκ τούτων ἀμφοῖν τίνα ἰδέαν φήσομεν ἔχειν; ΠΡΩ. σὺ καὶ ἐμοὶ φράσεις, ὥς οἶμαι. ΣΩ. θεὸς μὲν οὖν, ἄνπερ γε ἐμαῖς εὐχαῖς ἐπήκοος γίγνηταί τις θεῶν. ΠΡΩ. εὖχου δὴ καὶ σκόπει. ΣΩ. σκοπῶ· καί μοι δοκεῖ τις, ὦ Πρώταρχε, αὐτῶν φίλος ἡμῖν νυνδὴ γεγονέναι.

25c

PR: What do you mean? And what evidence have you?

25c

S: I shall answer of course, but please follow my argument.

25c

PR: Just speak.

25c

S: We described something as hotter and colder just now. Is this so?

25c

PR: Yes.

25c

S: Now add drier and wetter to these, also greater and lesser, faster and slower, larger and smaller, and whatever we previously included in the

single nature which involves more and less.

ΠΡΩ. πῶς λέγεις τοῦτο καὶ τίνι τεκμηρίῳ χρῆ; ΣΩ. φράσω δῆλον ὅτι· σὺ δέ μοι συνακολουθήσον τῷ λόγῳ. ΠΡΩ. λέγε μόνον. ΣΩ. θερμότερον ἐφθεγγόμεθα νυνδὴ πού τι καὶ ψυχρότερον. ἦ γάρ; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. πρόσθε δὴ ξηρότερον καὶ ὑγρότερον αὐτοῖς καὶ πλέον καὶ ἔλαττον καὶ θᾶττον καὶ βραδύτερον καὶ μείζον καὶ σμικρότερον καὶ ὅποσα ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν τῆς τὸ μᾶλλον τε καὶ ἥττον δεχομένης ἐτίθεμεν εἰς ἓν φύσεως.

25d

PR: Do you mean the nature which is limitless?

25d

S: Yes. And combine this in turn with the offspring of the limited.

25d

PR: What offspring?

25d

S: I am referring to the nature of the limited, which we should also have drawn into a unity just now, just as we did with the limitless. We did not do so, but perhaps we shall get the same result, if the latter nature is made evident by drawing the other two into a unity.

25d

PR: What nature? What do you mean?

25d

S: The nature which contains equal and double, and whatever prevents opposites from differing from one another, and renders them symmetric and harmonious by introducing number.

ΠΡΩ. τῆς τοῦ ἀπείρου λέγεις; ΣΩ. ναί. συμμείγνυ δέ γε εἰς αὐτὴν τὸ μετὰ ταῦτα τὴν αὖ τοῦ πέρατος γένναν. ΠΡΩ. ποίαν; ΣΩ. ἣν καὶ νυνδὴ, δέον ἡμᾶς καθάπερ τὴν τοῦ ἀπείρου συνηγάγομεν εἰς ἓν, οὕτω καὶ τὴν τοῦ περατοειδοῦς συναγαγεῖν, οὐ συνηγάγομεν. ἀλλ' ἴσως καὶ νῦν ταῦτ' ὁρᾷς, εἰ τούτων ἀμφοτέρων συναγομένων καταφανὲς κάκεινη γενήσεται. ΠΡΩ. ποίαν καὶ πῶς λέγεις; ΣΩ. τὴν τοῦ ἴσου καὶ διπλασίου, καὶ ὁπόση παύει πρὸς

25e

PR: I understand. I think you mean that when these are mixed, certain products arise as a consequence in each case.

25e

S: Yes, your understanding is correct.

25e

PR: Keep going.

25e

S: Well, in the case of disease, doesn't the proper combining of these opposites produce a healthy nature?

ἄλληλα τάναντία διαφόρως ἔχοντα, σύμμετρα δὲ καὶ σύμφωνα ἐνθεῖσα ἀριθμὸν ἀπεργάζεται. ΠΡΩ. μανθάνω· φαίνη γάρ μοι λέγειν μειγνύς ταῦτα γενέσεις τινὰς ἐφ' ἐκάστων αὐτῶν συμβαίνειν. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς γὰρ φαίνομαι. ΠΡΩ. λέγε τοίνυν. ΣΩ. ἄρα οὐκ ἐν μὲν νόσοις ἢ τούτων ὀρθή κοινωνία τὴν ὑγιείας φύσιν ἐγέννησεν;

26a

PR: Yes, certainly.

26a

S: And in the case of high and low pitch, and fast and slow, which are limitless, the same products arise. And once limit is brought about, the combinations establish all of music in perfection. Is this so?

26a

PR: Absolutely.

26a

S: And, indeed, if the combinations arise where there is cold or heat, having removed the excessive and limitless, they at the same time brought about measure and symmetry.

26a

PR: Yes, indeed.

ΠΡΩ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἐν δὲ ὀξεῖ καὶ βαρεῖ καὶ ταχεῖ καὶ βραδεῖ, ἀπείροις οὖσιν, ἄρ' οὐ ταῦτ' ἐγγιγνόμενα ταῦτα ἅμα πέρας τε ἀπηργάσατο καὶ μουσικὴν σύμπασαν τελεώτατα συνεστήσατο; ΠΡΩ.

κάλλιστά γε. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἔν γε χειμῶσιν καὶ πνίγεσιν ἐγγενομένη τὸ μὲν πολὺ λίαν καὶ ἄπειρον ἀφείλετο, τὸ δὲ ἔμμετρον καὶ ἅμα σύμμετρον ἀπηργάσατο. ΠΡΩ. τί μήν;

26b

S: Don't the seasons and all the other beauties of our world arise from this commingling of the limitless with whatever has limit?

26b

PR: It must be so.

26b

S: Yes. And there are countless other instances which I omit mentioning, such as beauty and strength in addition to health, and also the countless different and varied beauties of the soul. For this goddess, noble Philebus, beholding for herself the insolence and general vice of everyone without any limit on the pleasure or gratification among them, introduced law and order, which do possess limit. You may say that she afflicted us, but I would say the opposite. She saved us. Is this how it seems to you, Protarchus?

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐκ τούτων ὥραί τε καὶ ὅσα καλὰ πάντα ἡμῖν γέγονε, τῶν τε ἀπείρων καὶ τῶν πέρας ἔχόντων συμμειχθέντων; ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. καὶ ἄλλα γε δὴ μυρία ἐπιλείπω λέγων, οἷον μεθ' ὑγιείας κάλλος καὶ ἰσχύν, καὶ ἐν ψυχᾷ αὖ πάμπολλα ἕτερα καὶ πάγκαλα. ὕβριν γάρ που καὶ σύμπασαν πάντων πονηρίαν αὕτη κατιδοῦσα ἡ θεός, ὧ καλὲ Φίληβε, πέρας οὔτε ἡδονῶν οὐδὲν οὔτε πλησμονῶν ἐνὸν ἐν αὐτοῖς, νόμον καὶ τάξιν πέρας ἔχοντ' ἔθετο· καὶ σὺ μὲν ἀποκναῖσαι φῆς

26c

PR: Socrates, this is very much to my way of thinking.

26c

S: Well, you may notice that I have now described these three.

26c

PR: Yes, I think I can see that. Indeed, you seem to be saying that the limitless is one, and the limit in things is second and is also one.

However, I do not quite understand what you wish to designate as third.

26c

S: Yes, no wonder. The sheer scale of the third class has overwhelmed you. However, the limitless class also demonstrated multiplicity, and yet it turned out to be one, as it was stamped with the mark of the class of more, and its opposite.

αὐτήν, ἐγὼ δὲ τούναντίον ἀποσῶσαι λέγω. σοὶ δέ, ὦ Πρώταρχε, πῶς φαίνεται; ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔμοιγε κατὰ νοῦν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰ μὲν δὴ τρία ταῦτα εἴρηκα, εἰ συννοεῖς. ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' οἶμαι κατανοεῖν· ἐν μὲν γὰρ μοι δοκεῖς τὸ ἄπειρον λέγειν, ἐν δὲ καὶ δεύτερον τὸ πέρας ἐν τοῖς οὗσι· τρίτον δὲ οὐ σφόδρα κατέχω τί βούλει φράζειν. ΣΩ. τὸ γὰρ πλήθος σε, ὦ θαυμάσιε, ἐξέπληξε τῆς τοῦ τρίτου γενέσεως· καίτοι πολλά γε καὶ τὸ ἄπειρον παρέσχετο

26d

PR: True.

26d

S: Nor indeed did we make difficulties by saying that the limited neither involved multiplicity, nor was it one by nature.

26d

PR: No, why would we?

26d

S: There is no reason at all. But assume that I regard the third as the entire offspring of the other two, taken as one, a product brought into being from the measures which are generated along with the limited.

26d

PR: I understand.

γέννη, ὅμως δ' ἐπισφραγισθέντα τῷ τοῦ μᾶλλον καὶ ἐναντίου γένει ἐν ἐφάνη. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθῆ. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν τό γε πέρας οὔτε πολλά εἶχεν, οὔτ' ἐδυσκολαίνομεν ὥς οὐκ ἦν ἐν φύσει. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς. ἀλλὰ τρίτον φάθι με λέγειν, ἐν τοῦτο τιθέντα τὸ τούτων ἔκγονον ἅπαν,

γένεσιν εἰς οὐσίαν ἐκ τῶν μετὰ τοῦ πέρατος ἀπειργασμένων μέτρων.
ΠΡΩ. ἔμαθον.

26e

S: Well now, besides these three we should also consider the fourth class we mentioned earlier. Let's share the enquiry. Ask yourself whether it is necessary that everything which comes into being is generated because of some cause.

26e

PR: I think so, for how could it come into being without a cause?

26e

S: But doesn't the nature of the maker differ from the cause in nothing except its name, and should the maker and the cause properly be described as one?

26e

PR: Correct.

ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ δὴ πρὸς τρισὶ τέταρτόν τι τότε ἔφαμεν εἶναι γένος σκεπτόν· κοινὴ δ' ἡ σκέψις. ὅρα γὰρ εἴ σοι δοκεῖ ἀναγκαῖον εἶναι πάντα τὰ γιγνόμενα διὰ τινὰ αἰτίαν γίγνεσθαι. ΠΡΩ. ἔμοιγε· πῶς γὰρ ἂν χωρὶς τούτου γίγνοιτο; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἢ τοῦ ποιοῦντος φύσις οὐδὲν πλὴν ὀνόματι τῆς αἰτίας διαφέρει, τὸ δὲ ποιοῦν καὶ τὸ αἷτιον ὀρθῶς ἂν εἴη λεγόμενον ἔν; ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς.

27a

S: And, indeed, we shall also find that what is made is, in turn, different in nothing except name from 'what comes into being'. Is this so?

27a

PR: It is so.

27a

S: Now, isn't it natural that the maker always leads, while what is made follows that by coming into being?

27a

PR: Certainly.

27a

S: So, the cause, and whatever serves the cause in the productive process, are different and not the same.

27a

PR: Of course.

27a

S: Therefore, whatever comes into being and whatever everything arises from provide us with the three classes.

27a

PR: They do, indeed.

ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν τό γε ποιούμενον αὖ καὶ τὸ γιγνόμενον οὐδὲν πλὴν ὀνόματι, καθάπερ τὸ νυνδὴ, διαφέρον εὐρήσομεν. ἢ πῶς; ΠΡΩ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἡγεῖται μὲν τὸ ποιοῦν ἀεὶ κατὰ φύσιν, τὸ δὲ ποιούμενον ἐπακολουθεῖ γιγνόμενον ἐκείνῳ; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἄλλο ἄρα καὶ οὐ ταῦτόν αἰτία τ' ἐστὶ καὶ τὸ δουλεῦον εἰς γένεσιν αἰτία. ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰ μὲν γιγνόμενα καὶ ἐξ ὧν γίγνεται πάντα τὰ τρία παρέσχετο ἡμῖν γέννη; ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα.

27b

S: And, indeed, we say that the fourth which produces all these is the cause, since we have adequately demonstrated that it is different from them.

27b

PR: Yes, it is different.

27b

S: Well, now that the four have been distinguished, it is a good idea to list them in sequence as a reminder of each one.

27b

PR: Of course.

27b

S: Then I place the limitless first, the limited second, and the mixed-being produced from these, third. And would it be a mistake to say that the cause of the mixing and production is the fourth?

ΣΩ. τὸ δὲ δὴ πάντα ταῦτα δημιουργοῦν λέγομεν τέταρτον, τὴν αἰτίαν, ὡς ἱκανῶς ἕτερον ἐκείνων δεδηλωμένον; ΠΡΩ. ἕτερον γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς μὴν ἔχει, διωρισμένων τῶν τεττάρων, ἑνὸς ἐκάστου μνήμης ἕνεκα ἐφεξῆς αὐτὰ καταριθμήσασθαι. ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. πρῶτον μὲν τοίνυν ἄπειρον λέγω, δεύτερον δὲ πέρας, ἔπειτ' ἐκ τούτων τρίτον μεικτὴν καὶ γεγενημένην οὐσίαν· τὴν δὲ τῆς μείξεως αἰτίαν καὶ γενέσεως τετάρτην

27c

PR: No, how could it be?

27c

S: Well then, what is our next topic of discussion, and what consideration brought us to these issues? Wasn't it this? We were deciding whether the second-best life should consist of pleasure or understanding. Wasn't that it?

27c

PR: Yes, that was it.

27c

S: However, since we have now made this four-fold distinction, perhaps we may be better able to finalise the decision about first and second place, which was of course the first issue we disagreed about.

27c

PR: Perhaps.

λέγων ἄρα μὴ πλημμελοῖν ἄν τι; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πῶς; ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ, τὸ μετὰ τοῦθ' ἡμῖν τίς ὁ λόγος, καὶ τί ποτε βουλευθέντες εἰς ταῦτα ἀφικόμεθα; ἄρ' οὐ τόδε ἦν; δευτερεῖα ἐζητοῦμεν πότερον ἡδονῆς γίγνοιτ' ἂν ἢ φρονήσεως. οὐχ οὕτως ἦν; ΠΡΩ. οὕτω μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἴσως νῦν, ἐπειδὴ ταῦτα οὕτω διειλόμεθα, κάλλιον ἂν καὶ τὴν κρίσιν ἐπιτελεσαίμεθα πρώτου πέρι καὶ δευτέρου, περὶ ὧν δὴ τὸ πρῶτον ἡμφεσβητήσαμεν; ΠΡΩ. ἴσως.

27d

S: So come on, we awarded the victory to the mixed life of pleasure and understanding. Is this what we did?

27d

PR: It was.

27d

S: Shouldn't we look at this life and what it is, and which class it belongs to?

27d

PR: Why not?

27d

S: And we shall say, I presume, that it is part of the third class, for this does not consist of just two elements, but of the sum of all that is limitless, bound by limit. On this basis it is appropriate that this victorious mixed life should be part of that category.

27d

PR: Yes, you are quite right.

ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ νικῶντα μὲν ἔθεμέν που τὸν μεικτὸν βίον ἡδονῆς τε καὶ φρονήσεως. ἦν οὕτως; ΠΡΩ. ἦν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τοῦτον μὲν τὸν βίον ὀρῶμεν που τίς τέ ἐστι καὶ ὁποίου γένους; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. καὶ μέρος γ' αὐτὸν φήσομεν εἶναι τοῦ τρίτου οἶμαι γένους· οὐ γὰρ ὁ δυοῖν τινοῖν ἐστι μικτὸς ἐκεῖνος ἀλλὰ συμπάντων τῶν ἀπείρων ὑπὸ τοῦ πέρατος δεδεμένων, ὥστε ὀρθῶς ὁ νικηφόρος οὗτος βίος μέρος ἐκείνου γίγνοιτ' ἄν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα μὲν οὖν.

27e

S: Very well. But, Philebus, what about your life of pleasure which is unmixed? In which of the classes we mentioned should it properly be included? But before you tell us, let me ask this question.

27e

PL: Just ask.

27e

S: Do pleasure and pain have limit, or are they in the class involving both more and less?

27e

PL: Yes, pleasure involves more, Socrates, for it would not be entirely good unless it happened by nature to be limitless in extent and in intensity.

ΣΩ. εἶεν· τί δὲ ὁ σός, ὦ Φίληβε, ἡδὺς καὶ ἄμεικτος ὢν; ἐν τίνι γένει τῶν εἰρημένων λεγόμενος ὀρθῶς ἂν ποτε λέγοιτο; ὥδε δ' ἀπόκριναί μοι πρὶν ἀποφήνασθαι. ΦΙ. λέγε μόνον. ΣΩ. ἡδονὴ καὶ λύπη πέρας ἔχεται, ἢ τῶν τὸ μᾶλλον τε καὶ ἥττον δεχομένων ἐστών; ΦΙ. ναί, τῶν τὸ μᾶλλον, ὦ Σώκρατες· οὐ γὰρ ἂν ἡδονὴ πᾶν ἀγαθὸν ᾦν, εἰ μὴ ἄπειρον ἐτύγχανε πεφυκὸς καὶ πλήθει καὶ τῷ μᾶλλον.

28a

S: Nor would pain be entirely bad, Philebus, so we should look for something other than the limitless nature of pleasure, in order to furnish it with some part of good. So you may include these two among the classes of limitless things. But, Protarchus and Philebus, into which of the classes we mentioned may we now, without impiety, place understanding, knowledge and reason? Yes, I think there is a lot at stake if we do not get the answer to this question right.

ΣΩ. οὐδέ γ' ἂν, ὦ Φίληβε, λύπη πᾶν κακόν· ὥστ' ἄλλο τι νῶν σκεπτέον ἢ τὴν τοῦ ἀπείρου φύσιν ὥς παρέχεται τι μέρος ταῖς ἡδοναῖς ἀγαθοῦ. τούτω δὴ σοι τῶν ἀπεράντων γε γένους ἔστων· φρόνησιν δὲ καὶ ἐπιστήμην καὶ νοῦν εἰς τί ποτε τῶν προειρημένων, ὦ Πρώταρχε τε καὶ Φίληβε, νῦν θέντες οὐκ ἂν ἀσεβοῖμεν; οὐ γάρ μοι δοκεῖ σμικρὸς ἡμῖν εἶναι ὁ κίνδυνος κατορθώσασι καὶ μὴ περὶ τὸ νῦν ἐρωτώμενον.

28b

PL: Now you are exalting your own god, Socrates.

28b

S: Yes, and you are exalting your own goddess, my friend. Nevertheless, the question must be answered.

28b

PR: What Socrates is saying to you is right, Philebus, and you should do as he says.

28b

PL: Didn't you volunteer to speak on my behalf, Protarchus?

28b

PR: I did, indeed. But now I am a bit perplexed, Socrates, and I need you yourself to act as our spokesman, so that we don't miss the point and make some inappropriate statement about your contestant for second place.

ΦΙ. σεμνύνεις γάρ, ὦ Σώκρατες, τὸν σεαυτοῦ θεόν. ΣΩ. καὶ γὰρ σύ, ὦ ἑταῖρε, τὴν σαυτοῦ τὸ δ' ἐρωτώμενον ὁμῶς ἡμῖν λεκτέον. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς τοι λέγει Σωκράτης, ὦ Φίληβε, καὶ αὐτῷ πειστέον. ΦΙ. οὐκοῦν ὑπὲρ ἐμοῦ σύ, Πρώταρχε, προήρησαι λέγειν; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ γε· νῦν μέντοι σχεδὸν ἀπορῶ, καὶ δέομαί γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, αὐτόν σε ἡμῖν γενέσθαι προφήτην, ἵνα μηδὲν ἡμεῖς σοι περὶ τὸν ἀγωνιστὴν ἐξαμαρτάνοντες παρὰ μέλος φθεγξώμεθα τι.

28c

S: I should do as you say, Protarchus, as you are not making a difficult request. But did I really upset you with that playful exaltation, as Philebus calls it, when I asked what sort of class reason and knowledge should be in?

28c

PR: You certainly did, Socrates.

28c

S: Anyway, it is easy to answer, for all of the wise concur, in genuine self-exaltation, that reason is our lord of heaven and earth. And perhaps they are right. But we may carry out a more lengthy investigation of the class itself, if you wish.

ΣΩ. πειστέον, ὦ Πρώταρχε· οὐδὲ γὰρ χαλεπὸν οὐδὲν ἐπιτάττεις. ἀλλ' ὄντως σε ἐγώ, καθάπερ εἶπε Φίληβος, σεμνύνων ἐν τῷ παίζειν ἐθορύβησα, νοῦν καὶ ἐπιστήμην ἐρόμενος ὁποίου γένους εἶεν; ΠΡΩ. παντάπασί γε, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ῥάδιον· πάντες γὰρ συμφωνοῦσιν οἱ σοφοί, ἑαυτοὺς ὄντως σεμνύνοντες, ὡς νοῦς ἐστι βασιλεὺς ἡμῖν οὐρανοῦ τε καὶ γῆς. καὶ ἴσως εὖ λέγουσι. διὰ μακροτέρων δ', εἰ βούλει, τὴν σκέψιν αὐτοῦ τοῦ γένους ποιησώμεθα.

28d

PR: Proceed as you wish, Socrates! Regardless of the length, you will not bore us.

28d

S: Well said! Let us begin by repeating this question.

28d

PR: What question?

28d

S: Whether we should say, Protarchus, that this so-called universe and everything else is ruled by an irrational and random power, and that things happen by chance, or conversely as our predecessors said, that it is governed by reason and ordered by a wonderful understanding.

ΠΡΩ. λέγ' ὅπως βούλει, μηδὲν μῆκος ἡμῖν ὑπολογιζόμενος, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὡς οὐκ ἀπεχθισόμενος. ΣΩ. καλῶς εἶπες. ἀρξώμεθα δέ πως ὧδε ἐπανερωτῶντες. ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. πότερον, ὦ Πρώταρχε, τὰ σύμπαντα καὶ τότε τὸ καλούμενον ὅλον ἐπιτροπεύειν φῶμεν τὴν τοῦ ἀλόγου καὶ εἰκῇ δύναμιν καὶ τὸ ὅπῃ ἔτυχεν, ἢ τὰναντία, καθάπερ οἱ πρόσθεν ἡμῶν ἔλεγον, νοῦν καὶ φρόνησιν τινα θαυμαστὴν συντάττουσαν διακυβερνᾶν;

28e

PR: It's you, Socrates, who is wonderful. But the two accounts have nothing in common. I see the first option sounds quite irreverent to me. However, the statement that reason brings order to everything is worthy of the ordered vision of the universe, and sun, moon and stars, and the revolving heavens, and I myself would never say nor even think anything else about them.

ΠΡΩ. οὐδὲν τῶν αὐτῶν, ὦ θαυμάσιε Σώκρατες· ὁ μὲν γὰρ σὺ νῦν λέγεις, οὐδὲ ὅσιον εἶναί μοι φαίνεται. τὸ δὲ νοῦν πάντα διακοσμεῖν αὐτὰ φάναι καὶ τῆς ὀψεως τοῦ κόσμου καὶ ἡλίου καὶ σελήνης καὶ ἀστέρων καὶ πάσης τῆς περιφορᾶς ἄξιον, καὶ οὐκ ἄλλως ἔγωγ' ἂν ποτε περὶ αὐτῶν εἴποιμι οὐδ' ἂν δοξάσαιμι. ΣΩ. βούλει δῆτ' αὖ καὶ ἡμεῖς τοῖς ἐμπροσθεν ὁμολογούμενον

29a

S: Well, is this what you want? Should we agree with our predecessors and join them in declaring that these things are so, not merely speaking the words of others in safety, but sharing the danger and partaking of the abuse whenever a clever man says that the universe is not ordered like this, but is disordered?

29a

PR: Yes. What else could I want?

29a

S: Then come on and think about the argument we are facing here.

29a

PR: Please explain.

29a

S: I presume we realise that fire, water, air and earth – which storm-battered sailors call land – are involved in the formation of the physical nature of all creatures.

συμφήσωμεν ὡς ταῦθ' οὕτως ἔχει, καὶ μὴ μόνον οἰώμεθα δεῖν τὰλλότρια ἄνευ κινδύνου λέγειν, ἀλλὰ καὶ συγκινδυνεύωμεν καὶ μετέχωμεν τοῦ ψόγου, ὅταν ἀνὴρ δεινὸς φῇ ταῦτα μὴ οὕτως ἀλλ' ἀτάκτως ἔχειν; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ ἂν βουλοίμην; ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ, τὸν ἐπιόντα περὶ τούτων νῦν ἡμῖν λόγον ἄθρει. ΠΡΩ. λέγε μόνον. ΣΩ. τὰ περὶ τὴν τῶν σωμάτων φύσιν ἀπάντων τῶν ζώων, πῦρ καὶ ὕδωρ καὶ πνεῦμα καθορῶμέν που καὶ γῆν καθάπερ οἱ χειμαζόμενοι, φασίν, ἐνόντα ἐν τῇ συστάσει.

29b

PR: Very much so, and we are truly being battered by the perplexities of the current argument.

29b

S: Now, there is something you should understand about these constituents of our nature.

29b

PR: What is it?

29b

S: That the portion of each of these elements in us is small, mundane, and not at all pure, and does not possess the power worthy of its nature. Let's take a single example, but it is the same for them all. For instance, there is fire in us and also fire in the universe.

29b

PR: Of course.

ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα χειμαζόμεθα γὰρ ὄντως ὑπ' ἀπορίας ἐν τοῖς νῦν λόγοις. ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ, περὶ ἐκάστου τῶν παρ' ἡμῖν λαβὲ τὸ τοιόνδε. ΠΡΩ. ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὅτι μικρὸν τε τούτων ἕκαστον παρ' ἡμῖν ἔνεστι καὶ φαῦλον καὶ οὐδαμῇ οὐδαμῶς εἰλικρινὲς ὃν καὶ τὴν δύναμιν οὐκ ἀξίαν τῆς φύσεως ἔχον. ἐν ἐνὶ δὲ λαβὼν περὶ πάντων νόει ταυτόν. οἷον πῦρ ἔστι μὲν που παρ' ἡμῖν, ἔστι δ' ἐν τῷ παντί. ΠΡΩ. τί μήν;

29c

S: Now, the portion in us is small, weak and insignificant, while the fire in the universe is wondrous in extent, in beauty, and all the power associated with fire.

29c

PR: Yes. What you say is very true.

29c

S: Well then, is the universal fire sustained, given existence and augmented by the fire within us? Or is it the other way around, that the fire in you and in me and in the other creatures derives everything from the universal?

29c

PR: This question is not even worthy of a reply.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν σμικρὸν μὲν τι τὸ παρ' ἡμῖν καὶ ἀσθενὲς καὶ φαῦλον, τὸ δ' ἐν τῷ παντί πληθεῖ τε θαυμαστὸν καὶ κάλλει καὶ πάσῃ δυνάμει τῇ περὶ τὸ πῦρ οὔσῃ. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλ' ἀληθὲς ὃ λέγεις. ΣΩ. τί δέ; τρέφεται καὶ γίγνεται ἐκ τούτου καὶ αὖξεται τὸ τοῦ παντός πῦρ ὑπὸ τοῦ παρ' ἡμῖν πυρός, ἢ τοῦναντίον ὑπ' ἐκείνου τό τ' ἐμὸν καὶ τὸ σὸν καὶ τὸ τῶν ἄλλων

ζώων ἅπαντ' ἴσχει ταῦτα; ΠΡΩ. τοῦτο μὲν οὐδ' ἀποκρίσεως ἄξιον ἔρωτᾷς.

29d

S: Correct. And I imagine you will say the same thing about the earth which is here in the creatures and the earth in the universe, and will answer likewise in the case of all of the other elements I asked you about a little earlier. Would you reply in this way?

29d

PR: Well, could anyone answer differently and still appear sane?

29d

S: Hardly anyone at all. But follow this next point. When we see all the elements we mentioned combined into one, don't we call it a body?

29d

PR: Of course.

ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς· ταῦτὰ γὰρ ἐρεῖς οἶμαι περὶ τε τῆς ἐν τοῖς ζώοις γῆς τῆς ἐνθάδε καὶ τῆς ἐν τῷ παντί, καὶ τῶν ἄλλων δὴ πάντων ὅσων ἠρώτησα ὀλίγον ἔμπροσθεν. οὕτως ἀποκρινῇ; ΠΡΩ. τίς γὰρ ἀποκρινόμενος ἄλλως ὑγιαίνων ἂν ποτε φανείη; ΣΩ. σχεδὸν οὐδ' ὅστισοῦν· ἀλλὰ τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο ἐξῆς ἔπου. πάντα γὰρ ἡμεῖς ταῦτα τὰ νυνδὴ λεχθέντα ἄρ' οὐκ εἰς ἓν συγκείμενα ἰδόντες ἐπωνομάσαμεν σῶμα; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν;

29e

S: Now, understand that the same applies to what we call the universe, which is composed of the same elements and would, therefore, I suppose, be a body on the same basis.

29e

PR: Absolutely correct.

29e

S: And are our bodies sustained by this body, or is it sustained by ours? And has it acquired and does it possess whatever we ascribed to them just now?

29e

PR: That, Socrates, is another question which is not worth asking.

ΣΩ. ταῦτόν δὴ λαβὲ καὶ περὶ τοῦδε ὃν κόσμον λέγομεν· διὰ τὸν αὐτὸν γὰρ τρόπον ἂν εἴη που σῶμα, σύνθετον ὃν ἐκ τῶν αὐτῶν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν ἐκ τούτου τοῦ σώματος ὅλως τὸ παρ' ἡμῖν σῶμα ἢ ἐκ τοῦ παρ' ἡμῖν τοῦτο τρέφεται τε καὶ ὅσα νυνδὴ περὶ αὐτῶν εἶπομεν εἴληφέν τε καὶ ἔχει; ΠΡΩ. καὶ τοῦθ' ἕτερον, ὧ Σώκρατες, οὐκ ἄξιον ἐρωτήσεως.

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S: Well then, is this next question worth asking? What do you think?

30a

PR: What is the question?

30a

S: Wouldn't we say that our body has a soul?

30a

PR: Obviously we would.

30a

S: But where, my dear Protarchus, did it get it, unless the body of the universe – a body which has the same as our body but in far greater beauty – is also ensouled?

30a

PR: Obviously there is nowhere else it could come from, Socrates.

30a

S: Now, Protarchus, in the case of the four classes – limit, limitless, their combination and the causal class – I presume we realise that this fourth, present in everything, furnishing us with soul, producing regimen and exercise for the body when it falls ill, is called extensive and multifaceted wisdom when we hear of it in other instances. But do we believe that when these same four are present in the whole universe on a large scale, and, what is more, in greater beauty and purity, this wisdom would fail to generate a beautiful and hallowed nature among them?

ΣΩ. τί δέ; τόδε ἄρα ἄξιον; ἢ πῶς ἐρεῖς; ΠΡΩ. λέγε τὸ ποῖον. ΣΩ. τὸ παρ' ἡμῖν σῶμα ἄρ' οὐ ψυχὴν φήσομεν ἔχειν; ΠΡΩ. δήλον ὅτι φήσομεν. ΣΩ.

πόθεν, ὦ φίλε Πρώταρχε, λαβόν, εἴπερ μὴ τό γε τοῦ παντός σῶμα ἔμψυχον ὃν ἐτύγχανε, ταῦτά γε ἔχον τούτῳ καὶ ἔτι πάντῃ καλλίονα; ΠΡΩ. δῆλον ὡς οὐδαμῶθεν ἄλλοθεν, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. οὐ γάρ που δοκοῦμέν γε, ὦ Πρώταρχε, τὰ τέτταρα ἐκεῖνα, πέρας καὶ ἄπειρον καὶ κοινὸν καὶ τὸ τῆς αἰτίας γένος ἐν ἅπασι τέταρτον ἐνόν, τοῦτο ἐν μὲν τοῖς παρ' ἡμῖν ψυχὴν τε παρέχον καὶ σωμασκήν ἐμποιοῦν καὶ πταίσαντος σώματος ἱατρικὴν καὶ ἐν ἄλλοις ἄλλα συντιθὲν καὶ ἀκούμενον πᾶσαν καὶ παντοίαν σοφίαν ἐπικαλεῖσθαι, τῶν δ' αὐτῶν τούτων ὄντων ἐν ὅλῳ τε οὐρανῷ καὶ κατὰ μεγάλα μέρη, καὶ προσέτι καλῶν καὶ εἰλικρινῶν, ἐν τούτοις δ' οὐκ ἄρα μεμηχανῆσθαι τὴν τῶν καλλίστων καὶ τιμιωτάτων φύσιν.

30c

PR: That would not be at all reasonable.

30c

S: Well, if that is invalid, we had better go with the other account which suggests, as we have often said, that there is extensive limitlessness in the universe, sufficient limit, and an extraordinary cause which governs them, ordering and arranging the years, seasons and months, which may rightly be referred to as wisdom and reason.

30c

PR: Rightly so, indeed.

30c

S: But there could never be wisdom and reason without soul.

30c

PR: There could not.

ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' οὐδαμῶς τοῦτό γ' ἂν λόγον ἔχοι. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ μὴ τοῦτο, μετ' ἐκείνου τοῦ λόγου ἂν ἐπόμενοι βέλτιον λέγοιμεν ὡς ἔστιν, ἃ πολλάκις εἰρήκαμεν, ἄπειρόν τε ἐν τῷ παντὶ πολὺ, καὶ πέρας ἱκανόν, καὶ τις ἐπ' αὐτοῖς αἰτία οὐ φαύλη, κοσμοῦσά τε καὶ συντάττουσα ἐνιαυτούς τε καὶ ὥρας καὶ μῆνας, σοφία καὶ νοῦς λεγομένη δικαιοτάτ' ἂν. ΠΡΩ. δικαιοτάτα δῆτα. ΣΩ. σοφία μὴν καὶ νοῦς ἄνευ ψυχῆς οὐκ ἂν ποτε γενοίσθην. ΠΡΩ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν.

30d

S: Then, you will say that there is a lordly soul in the nature of Zeus, and lordly reason is engendered through the power of the cause, while in other gods there are other glories, and each of them likes to be described accordingly.

30d

PR: Very much so.

30d

S: Now, Protarchus, do not imagine that this statement we have made is some trifle. No, it lends support to those people of old who said that reason always rules the universe.

30d

PR: Yes, it does indeed.

30d

S: And, in fact, it has provided an answer to my query, by saying that of the four classes, reason belongs to the one which we referred to as the cause of everything. I presume that you have got our answer to the question at this stage.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐν μὲν τῇ τοῦ Διὸς ἐρεῖς φύσει βασιλικὴν μὲν ψυχὴν, βασιλικὸν δὲ νοῦν ἐγγίγνεσθαι διὰ τὴν τῆς αἰτίας δύναμιν, ἐν δ' ἄλλοις ἄλλα καλὰ, καθ' ὅτι φίλον ἐκάστοις λέγεσθαι. ΠΡΩ. μάλα γε. ΣΩ. τοῦτον δὴ τὸν λόγον ἡμᾶς μή τι μάτην δόξης, ὧ Πρώταρχε, εἰρηκέναι, ἀλλ' ἔστι τοῖς μὲν πάλαι ἀποφηνάμενοις ὡς αἰὲ τοῦ παντὸς νοῦς ἄρχει σύμμαχος ἐκεῖνοις. ΠΡΩ. ἔστι γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. τῇ δέ γε ἐμῇ ζητήσῃ πεπορικῶς ἀπόκρισιν, ὅτι νοῦς

30e

PR: Yes I have, and it is most satisfactory, though I did not realise you were answering me.

30e

S: Indeed, Protarchus, playfulness sometimes brings relief from seriousness.

30e

PR: Well put.

ἐστὶ γένους τῆς τοῦ πάντων αἰτίου λεχθέντος τῶν τεττάρων, ὧν ἦν ἡμῖν ἔν τοῦτο. ἔχεις γὰρ δήπου νῦν ἡμῶν ἤδη τὴν ἀπόκρισιν. ΠΡΩ. ἔχω καὶ μάλα ἱκανῶς· καίτοι με ἀποκρινάμενος ἔλαθες. ΣΩ. ἀνάπαυλα γάρ, ὦ Πρώταρχε, τῆς σπουδῆς γίγνεται ἐνίοτε ἡ παιδιά. ΠΡΩ. καλῶς εἶπες.

31a

S: Surely, my friend, we have now explained quite plausibly the class to which reason belongs, and the power it possesses.

31a

PR: Yes, certainly.

31a

S: And, indeed, the class to which pleasure belongs was evident in like manner some time ago.

31a

PR: Very much so.

31a

S: So, let us also recall some facts about both. Reason was akin to a cause, and fitted that class quite well, while pleasure itself was limitless, and belonged in the class which does not possess beginning, middle or end within itself, from itself, nor will ever do so.

ΣΩ. νῦν δήπου, ὦ ἐταῖρε, οὗ μὲν γένους ἐστὶ καὶ τίνα ποτὲ δύναμιν κέκτηται, σχεδὸν ἐπιεικῶς ἡμῖν τὰ νῦν δεδήλωται. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἡδονῆς γε ὡσαύτως πάλαι τὸ γένος ἐφάνη. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. μεμνώμεθα δὴ καὶ ταῦτα περὶ ἀμφοῖν, ὅτι νοῦς μὲν αἰτίας ἦν συγγενῆς καὶ τούτου σχεδὸν τοῦ γένους, ἡδονὴ δὲ ἄπειρός τε αὐτὴ καὶ τοῦ μήτε ἀρχὴν μήτε μέσα μήτε τέλος ἐν αὐτῷ ἄφ' ἑαυτοῦ ἔχοντος μηδὲ ἔξοντός ποτε γένους.

31b

PR: We shall remember. Indeed, how could we forget?

31b

S: Now, the next thing we need to do is see what each of them reside in, and what condition causes them to arise when they do arise. Let us

take pleasure first since we examined its class first. Let us do the same with these questions. However, we could never examine pleasure adequately in isolation from pain.

31b

PR: Well, if it is necessary to proceed in that way, let's proceed in that way.

31b

S: Does the generation of these appear to you as it does to me?

ΠΡΩ. μεμνησόμεθα· πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. δεῖ δὴ τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο, ἐν ᾧ τέ ἐστιν ἑκάτερον αὐτοῖν καὶ διὰ τί πάθος γίνεσθον ὁπόταν γίγνησθον ἰδεῖν ἡμᾶς. πρῶτον τὴν ἡδονήν· ὥσπερ τὸ γένος αὐτῆς πρότερον ἐβασανίσαμεν, οὕτω καὶ ταῦτα πρότερα. λύπης δὲ αὖ χωρὶς τὴν ἡδονὴν οὐκ ἂν ποτε δυναίμεθα ἱκανῶς βασανίσαι. ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' εἰ ταύτη χρὴ πορεύεσθαι, ταύτη πορευόμεθα. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν σοὶ καθάπερ ἐμοὶ φαίνεται τῆς γενέσεως αὐτῶν πέρι;

31c

PR: How is that?

31c

S: It appears to me that, by nature, pleasure and pain both arise at the same time in the combined class.

31c

PR: But Socrates, my friend, please remind us which of the four classes, from our earlier discussion, you wish to designate as 'combined'.

31c

S: Well, you're a wonder! I'll do the best I can.

31c

PR: Well said.

31c

S: Well, we should regard the 'combined' as the third of the classes we mentioned.

31c

PR: Is it the one you listed after the limitless and limit, and in which, I think, you placed health and harmony?

31c

S: Excellent! Now give me your closest attention.

31c

PR: Speak on.

ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ἐν τῷ κοινῷ μοι γένει ἅμα φαίνεσθον λύπη τε καὶ ἡδονὴ γίγνεσθαι κατὰ φύσιν. ΠΡΩ. κοινὸν δέ γε, ὃ φίλε Σώκρατες, ὑπομίμνησκε ἡμᾶς τί ποτε τῶν προειρημένων βούλει δηλοῦν. ΣΩ. ἔσται ταῦτ' εἰς δύναμιν, ὃ θαυμάσιε. ΠΡΩ. καλῶς εἶπες. ΣΩ. κοινὸν τοίνυν ὑπακούωμεν ὃ δὴ τῶν τεττάρων τρίτον ἐλέγομεν. ΠΡΩ. ὃ μετὰ τὸ ἄπειρον καὶ πέρας ἔλεγες, ἐν ᾧ καὶ ὑγίειαν, οἶμαι δὲ καὶ ἀρμονίαν, ἐτίθεσο;

31d

S: Then, I claim that when harmony is disrupted in us living creatures, then a disruption of our natural state and a generation of pain arise at the same time.

31d

PR: Quite likely.

31d

S: But if harmony is again restored and it returns to its own nature, we should say that pleasure arises, if we must speak on a vast subject briefly and most hastily.

ΣΩ. κάλλιστ' εἶπες. τὸν νοῦν δὲ ὅτι μάλιστ' ἤδη πρόσεχε. ΠΡΩ. λέγε μόνον. ΣΩ. λέγω τοίνυν τῆς ἀρμονίας μὲν λυομένης ἡμῖν ἐν τοῖς ζώοις ἅμα λύσιν τῆς φύσεως καὶ γένεσιν ἀλγηδόνων ἐν τῷ τότε γίγνεσθαι χρόνῳ. ΠΡΩ. πάννυ λέγεις εἰκός. ΣΩ. πάλιν δὲ ἀρμοττομένης τε καὶ εἰς τὴν αὐτῆς φύσιν ἀπιούσης ἡδονὴν γίγνεσθαι λεκτέον, εἰ δεῖ δι' ὀλίγων περὶ μεγίστων ὅτι τάχιστα ῥηθῆναι.

31e

PR: I do think that what you are saying is correct, Socrates, but let's try to describe these particular issues more clearly.

31e

S: Aren't the commonplace and obvious instances somehow easiest to understand?

31e

PR: What instances?

31e

S: Is hunger, in a sense, a disruption and a pain?

31e

PR: Yes.

31e

S: And is eating, and being filled once more, a pleasure?

31e

PR: Yes.

ΠΡΩ. οἶμαι μὲν σε ὁρθῶς λέγειν, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἐμφανέστερον δὲ ἔτι ταῦτ' αὐτὰ πειρώμεθα λέγειν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὰ δημόσια που καὶ περιφανῆ ῥᾶστον συννοεῖν; ΠΡΩ. ποῖα; ΣΩ. πείνη μὲν που λύσις καὶ λύπη; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. ἔδωδ' ἡ δέ, πλήρωσις γιγνομένη πάλιν, ἡδονή; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. δίψος δ' αὖ φθορὰ καὶ λύπη καὶ λύσις, ἡ δὲ τοῦ

32a

S: Thirst, for its part, is a disturbance and a pain, while pleasure is the ability of a liquid to replenish what has dried out. Again, the unnatural dispersal and dissolution which are the effects of heat is a pain, while the natural restoration and cooling is a pleasure.

32a

PR: Yes, certainly.

32a

S: Also, the unnatural congealing of the fluids in a creature due to cold is a pain, whereas their dispersal and return to their former state, the natural course, is a pleasure. And in short, consider whether it would be reasonable for someone to say that when the natural form of limit and limitless, which as we said earlier constitutes an ensouled being, is

disrupted, this disruption is a pain, while the restoration of them all once more, back to the course of their own being, is a pleasure.

ύγροῦ πάλιν τὸ ξηρανθὲν πληροῦσα δύναμις ἡδονή· διάκρισις δέ γ' αὖ καὶ διάλυσις ἢ παρὰ φύσιν, τοῦ πνίγους πάθη, λύπη, κατὰ φύσιν δὲ πάλιν ἀπόδοσίς τε καὶ ψῦξις ἡδονή. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ ρίγους ἢ μὲν παρὰ φύσιν τοῦ ζῶου τῆς ὑγρότητος πῆξις λύπη· πάλιν δ' εἰς ταῦτον ἀπιόντων καὶ διακρινομένων ἢ κατὰ φύσιν ὁδὸς ἡδονή. καὶ ἐνὶ λόγῳ σκόπει εἴ σοι μέτριος ὁ λόγος ὃς ἂν φῇ τὸ ἐκ τῆς ἀπείρου καὶ

32b

PR: Good. That sounds to me like a fair summary.

32b

S: Then, may we propose that either of these experiences constitutes one form of pleasure and of pain?

32b

PR: We may.

πέρατος κατὰ φύσιν ἔμψυχον γεγονὸς εἶδος, ὅπερ ἔλεγον ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν, ὅταν μὲν τοῦτο φθείρηται, τὴν μὲν φθορὰν λύπην εἶναι, τὴν δ' εἰς τὴν αὐτῶν οὐσίαν ὁδόν, ταύτην δὲ αὖ πάλιν τὴν ἀναχώρησιν πάντων ἡδονήν. ΠΡΩ. ἔστω· δοκεῖ γάρ μοι τύπον γέ τινα ἔχειν. ΣΩ. τοῦτο μὲν τοίνυν ἐν εἶδος τιθώμεθα λύπης τε καὶ ἡδονῆς ἐν τούτοις τοῖς πάθεσιν ἑκατέρους; ΠΡΩ. κείσθω. ΣΩ. τίθει τοίνυν αὐτῆς τῆς ψυχῆς κατὰ τὸ τούτων τῶν

32c

S: Also, let us propose that there is expectation of these experiences by the soul itself, the sweet and confident anticipation prior to the pleasures, and the fear and anxiety prior to the pains.

32c

PR: Yes, and this is a different form of pleasure and pain, which arises in the soul itself independently of the body, through anticipation.

32c

S: Your understanding is correct. For in these instances, in my opinion, I believe that each arises in a pure form, and seemingly are not

mixtures of pleasure and pain. So, it will be evident, in the case of pleasure, whether the entire class is desirable, or whether we should say this about one of the other classes we mentioned, rather than about pleasure and pain. In which case, pleasure and pain, just like hot and cold and everything of that sort, should sometimes be desired and sometimes not, as they are not actually good, though some of them, on occasion, assume the nature of things that are good at the time.

παθημάτων προσδόκημα τὸ μὲν πρὸ τῶν ἡδέων ἐλπιζόμενον ἡδὺ καὶ θαρραλέον, τὸ δὲ πρὸ τῶν λυπηρῶν φοβερὸν καὶ ἀλγεινόν. ΠΡΩ. ἔστι γὰρ οὖν τοῦθ' ἡδονῆς καὶ λύπης ἕτερον εἶδος, τὸ χωρὶς τοῦ σώματος αὐτῆς τῆς ψυχῆς διὰ προσδοκίας γιγνόμενον. ΣΩ. ὁρθῶς ὑπέλαβες. ἐν γὰρ τούτοις οἶμαι, κατὰ γε τὴν ἐμὴν δόξαν, εἰλικρινέσιν τε ἑκατέροις γιγνομένοις, ὥς δοκεῖ, καὶ ἀμείκτοις λύπης τε καὶ ἡδονῆς, ἐμφανὲς ἔσεσθαι

32d

PR: You are quite right to say that we should work through the difficulty we are now pursuing in this sort of manner.

τὸ περὶ τὴν ἡδονήν, πότερον ὅλον ἐστὶ τὸ γένος ἀσπαστόν, ἢ τοῦτο μὲν ἑτέρῳ τινὶ τῶν προειρημένων δοτέον ἡμῖν γενῶν, ἡδονῇ δὲ καὶ λύπῃ, καθάπερ θερμῷ καὶ ψυχρῷ καὶ πᾶσι τοῖς τοιούτοις, τοτὲ μὲν ἀσπαστέον αὐτά, τοτὲ δὲ οὐκ ἀσπαστέον, ὥς ἀγαθὰ μὲν οὐκ ὄντα, ἐνίοτε δὲ καὶ ἔνια δεχόμενα τὴν τῶν ἀγαθῶν ἔστιν ὅτε φύσιν. ΠΡΩ. ὁρθότατα λέγεις, ὅτι ταύτῃ πῃ δεῖ διαπορηθῆναι τὸ νῦν μεταδιωκόμενον. ΣΩ. πρῶτον μὲν τοίνυν τόδε συνίδωμεν· ὥς εἶπερ

32e

S: Well, let's agree on something first, that if what was said is indeed the case, and pain is disruptive while pleasure is restorative, we should also reflect upon the absence of disruption and restoration, and the precise state of each living creature under such circumstances. Think hard about this, and then respond. Isn't it inescapable that the creature, at that particular time, experiences neither pleasure nor pain to any degree?

32e

PR: Yes, it must be so.

ὄντως ἔστι τὸ λεγόμενον, διαφθειρομένων μὲν αὐτῶν ἀλγηδῶν, ἀνασφζομένων δὲ ἡδονή, τῶν μήτε διαφθειρομένων μήτε ἀνασφζομένων ἐννοήσωμεν περί, τίνα ποτὲ ἔξιν δεῖ τότε ἐν ἐκάστοις εἶναι τοῖς ζώοις, ὅταν οὕτως ἴσχη. σφόδρα δὲ προσέχων τὸν νοῦν εἶπέ· ἄρα οὐ πᾶσα ἀνάγκη πᾶν ἐν τῷ τότε χρόνῳ ζῶον μήτε τι λυπεῖσθαι μήτε ἡδεσθαι μήτε μέγα μήτε μικρόν; ΠΡΩ. ἀνάγκη μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἔστι τις τρίτη ἡμῶν ἢ τοιαύτη διάθεσις

33a

S: Isn't such a condition a third option for us besides those of pleasure and pain?

33a

PR: Of course.

33a

S: Well, try to remember this as we proceed, for it is quite significant for our decision about pleasure whether we remember this or not. And we should say a little more about it if you have no objection.

33a

PR: Tell me.

33a

S: Note that there is nothing to prevent someone, who has chosen the life of understanding, from living in this manner.

παρά τε τὴν τοῦ χαίροντος καὶ παρά τὴν τοῦ λυπούμενου; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. ἄγε δὴ τοίνυν, ταύτης προθυμοῦ μεμνησθαι. πρὸς γὰρ τὴν τῆς ἡδονῆς κρίσιν οὐ μικρόν μεμνησθαι ταύτην ἔσθ' ἡμῖν ἢ μή. βραχὺ δὲ τι περὶ αὐτῆς, εἰ βούλει, διαπεράνωμεν. ΠΡΩ. λέγε ποῖον. ΣΩ. τῷ τὸν τοῦ φρονεῖν ἐλομένῳ βίον οἶσθ' ὥς τοῦτον τὸν τρόπον οὐδὲν ἀποκωλύει ζῆν.

33b

PR: Do you mean living without either pleasure or pain?

33b

S: Yes. For it was stated, I believe, in the comparison of lives, that the person who chooses the life of reason and understanding must not experience pleasure to any degree.

33b

PR: Yes, that is certainly what was said.

33b

S: Therefore, he would live like this, and it would not be surprising if it proved to be the most divine of the lives.

33b

PR: Yes, as it is quite unlikely that the gods experience either pleasure or its opposite.

33b

S: Most unlikely indeed, as it would be quite unbecoming for them to experience either. However, we shall consider this again later, if it is relevant to our discussion, and we shall add it to the evidence that reason should have second place, if we cannot do so for first place.

ΠΡΩ. τὸν τοῦ μὴ χαίρειν μηδὲ λυπεῖσθαι λέγεις; ΣΩ. ἐρρήθη γάρ που τότε ἐν τῇ παραβολῇ τῶν βίων μηδὲν δεῖν μήτε μέγα μήτε μικρὸν χαίρειν τῷ τὸν τοῦ νοεῖν καὶ φρονεῖν βίον ἐλομένῳ. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα οὕτως ἐρρήθη. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οὕτως ἂν ἐκείνῳ γε ὑπάρχοι καὶ ἴσως οὐδὲν ἄτοπον εἰ πάντων τῶν βίων ἐστὶ θεϊότατος. ΠΡΩ. οὐκ οὐν εἰκός γε οὔτε χαίρειν θεοὺς οὔτε τὸ ἐναντίον. ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν οὐκ εἰκός· ἄσχημον γοῦν αὐτῶν ἐκάτερον γιγνόμενόν ἐστιν. ἀλλὰ δὴ τοῦτο μὲν ἔτι καὶ εἰς

33c

PR: A very appropriate suggestion.

33c

S: And, indeed, the other form of pleasure, which we said belongs to the soul itself, comes into being entirely through memory.

33c

PR: How?

33c

S: It seems we must first understand what precisely memory is, and may even have to understand perception before memory, if all of these related issues are to become clearer to us in an appropriate manner.

αὐθις ἐπισκεψόμεθα, ἐὰν πρὸς λόγον τι ᾦ, καὶ τῷ νῶ πρὸς τὰ δευτερεῖα, ἐὰν μὴ πρὸς τὰ πρωτεῖα δυνώμεθα προσθεῖναι, προσθήσομεν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν τό γε ἕτερον εἶδος τῶν ἡδονῶν, ὃ τῆς ψυχῆς αὐτῆς ἔφαμεν εἶναι, διὰ μνήμης πᾶν ἐστι γεγονός. ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. μνήμην, ὡς ἔοικεν, ὅτι ποτ' ἔστιν πρότερον ἀναληπτέον, καὶ κινδυνεύει πάλιν ἔτι πρότερον αἰσθησιν μνήμης, εἰ μέλλει τὰ περὶ ταῦθ' ἡμῖν κατὰ τρόπον φανερά πη γενήσεσθαι.

33d

PR: How do you mean?

33d

S: Take the case of the experiences of our body. Some of these are extinguished within the body before they arrive at the soul, leaving soul unaffected, while others proceed through both body and soul, engendering a sort of vibration which is particular to each but common to both.

33d

PR: Very well.

33d

S: Now, in the case where the experiences do not proceed through both body and soul, would we say that the soul is unaware, while, on the other hand, when they do involve both, shall we be quite right to say that it is not unaware?

ΠΡΩ. πῶς φής; ΣΩ. θεῖς τῶν περὶ τὸ σῶμα ἡμῶν ἐκάστοτε παθημάτων τὰ μὲν ἐν τῷ σώματι κατασβεννύμενα πρὶν ἐπὶ τὴν ψυχὴν διεξελεθῆναι ἀπαθῆ ἐκείνην ἔασαντα, τὰ δὲ δι' ἀμφοῖν ἰόντα καὶ τινα ὥσπερ σεισμὸν ἐντιθέντα ἴδιόν τε καὶ κοινὸν ἐκατέρῳ. ΠΡΩ. κείσθω. ΣΩ. τὰ μὲν δὴ μὴ δι' ἀμφοῖν ἰόντα ἐὰν τὴν ψυχὴν ἡμῶν φῶμεν λανθάνειν, τὰ δὲ δι' ἀμφοῖν μὴ λανθάνειν, ἄρ' ὀρθότατα ἐροῦμεν;

33e

PR: This must be so.

33e

S: However, you should certainly not assume that I am saying that the unawareness somehow produces forgetfulness in this case. Indeed, forgetfulness is the departure of a memory, which in the case we are describing has not yet arisen. And it would be strange to speak of the loss of something which is not, and has not yet come into existence. Is that so?

33e

PR: Of course.

33e

S: Then you should just change the names.

33e

PR: In what way?

33e

S: Rather than saying that the soul is ‘unaware’ when it is not affected by the vibrations associated with the body, let’s use the term ‘insensible’ for what we now call forgetting.

ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. τὸ τοίνυν λεληθέναι μηδαμῶς ὑπολάβης ὡς λέγω λήθης ἐνταῦθά που γένεσιν· ἔστι γὰρ λήθη μνήμης ἔξοδος, ἡ δ’ ἐν τῷ λεγομένῳ νῦν οὕτω γέγονε. τοῦ δὴ μήτε ὄντος μήτε γεγονότος πω γίγνεσθαι φάναι τινὰ ἀποβολὴν ἄτοπον. ἦ γάρ; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. τὰ τοίνυν ὀνόματα μετέβαλε μόνον. ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ἀντὶ μὲν τοῦ λεληθέναι τὴν ψυχὴν, ὅταν ἀπαθὴς αὕτη γίγνηται τῶν σεισμῶν τῶν τοῦ σώματος, ἦν νῦν λήθη

34a

PR: I understand.

34a

S: On the other hand, the coming together of body and soul in a single experience, where they are also moved together, is a movement which, for its part, could appropriately be referred to by the name ‘perception’.

34a

PR: Very true.

34a

S: So, do we now understand what we mean when we use the term perception?

34a

PR: Of course.

34a

S: So, anyone who says that memory is the preservation of perception would, in my view, be quite right to say so.

καλεῖς ἀναισθησίαν ἐπονόμασον. ΠΡΩ. ἔμαθον. ΣΩ. τὸ δ' ἐν ἐνὶ πάθει τὴν ψυχὴν καὶ τὸ σῶμα κοινῇ γιγνόμενον κοινῇ καὶ κινεῖσθαι, ταύτην δ' αὖ τὴν κίνησιν ὀνομάζων αἴσθησιν οὐκ ἀπὸ τρόπου φθέγγοι' ἄν. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἤδη μανθάνομεν ὃ βουλόμεθα καλεῖν τὴν αἴσθησιν; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. σωτηρίαν τοίνυν αἰσθήσεως τὴν μνήμην λέγων ὀρθῶς ἂν τις λέγοι κατὰ γε τὴν ἐμὴν δόξαν.

34b

PR: Yes, correct indeed.

34b

S: And don't we say that recollection is different from memory?

34b

PR: Perhaps.

34b

S: Are they not different in the following way?

34b

PR: What way?

34b

S: When the soul itself, without use of the body, retrieves within itself as best it can whatever it once experienced along with the body, presumably we say that it is then recollecting. Is this so?

34b

PR: It certainly is.

34b

S: And, indeed, when memory of either a perception or piece of knowledge has been lost, and the soul itself digs it up again within itself all these occurrences are also called recollections, I presume.

ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. μνήμης δὲ ἀνάμνησιν ἄρ' οὐ διαφέρουσιν λέγομεν; ΠΡΩ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ τόδε; ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὅταν ἂ μετὰ τοῦ σώματος ἔπασχέν ποθ' ἡ ψυχὴ, ταῦτ' ἄνευ τοῦ σώματος αὐτὴ ἐν ἑαυτῇ ὅτι μάλιστα ἀναλαμβάνη, τότε ἀναμιμνήσκεσθαι που λέγομεν. ἢ γάρ; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ ὅταν ἀπολέσασα μνήμην εἴτ' αἰσθήσεως εἴτ' αὖ μαθήματος αὐθις ταύτην ἀναπολήσῃ πάλιν

34c

PR: You are right.

34c

S: Now, the reason we have said all this is as follows.

34c

PR: Tell me.

34c

S: So that we may understand the pleasure of the soul without body as comprehensively and clearly as we can, and also its desire at the same time. Indeed, through these two it seems that both will be clarified.

34c

PR: In that case, Socrates, we should discuss them next.

34c

S: It seems that our investigation must involve a lot of discussion about the origin of pleasure and every form it has, and, indeed, it appears the first thing we must understand is what desire is and where it arises.

αὐτὴ ἐν ἑαυτῇ, καὶ ταῦτα σύμπαντα ἀναμνήσεις καὶ μνήμας που λέγομεν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὗ δὴ χάριν ἅπαντ' εἴρηται ταῦτ', ἔστι τόδε. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ἵνα πῃ τὴν ψυχῆς ἡδονὴν χωρὶς σώματος ὅτι μάλιστα καὶ ἐναργέστατα λάβοιμεν, καὶ ἅμα ἐπιθυμίαν· διὰ γὰρ τούτων πως ταῦτα ἀμφοτέρω ἐοικεν δηλοῦσθαι. ΠΡΩ. λέγωμεν τοίνυν, ὦ

Σώκρατες, ἤδη τὸ μετὰ ταῦτα. ΣΩ. πολλά γε περὶ γενέσιν ἡδονῆς καὶ πᾶσαν τὴν

34d

PR: Then let's investigate it, for we have nothing to lose.

34d

S: We do have something to lose, Protarchus. If we find what we are now looking for, we lose our perplexity about these very matters.

34d

PR: You are right to remind us, but now let's try to address the next issues.

μορφὴν αὐτῆς ἀναγκαῖον, ὥς ἔοικε, λέγοντας σκοπεῖν. καὶ γὰρ νῦν πρότερον ἔτι φαίνεται ληπτέον ἐπιθυμίαν εἶναι τί ποτ' ἔστι καὶ ποῦ γίγνεται. ΠΡΩ. σκοπῶμεν τοίνυν· οὐδὲν γὰρ ἀπολοῦμεν. ΣΩ. ἀπολοῦμεν μὲν οὖν καὶ ταῦτά γε, ὧ Πρώταρχε· εὐρόντες ὃ νῦν ζητοῦμεν, ἀπολοῦμεν τὴν περὶ αὐτὰ ταῦτα ἀπορίαν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς ἡμύνω· τὸ δ' ἐφεξῆς τούτοις πειρώμεθα λέγειν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν νυνδὴ πείνην τε καὶ δίψος καὶ πολλὰ ἕτερα

34e

S: Didn't we say just now that hunger and thirst, and numerous other things of that sort, were desires?

34e

PR: Most definitely.

34e

S: So, what precisely is the sameness we look to, whereby we call them by one name though they differ so much?

34e

PR: By Zeus, Socrates, that question may not be easy to answer, but it deserves a response nonetheless.

34e

S: Then let's resume the discussion again from there, based on the same examples.

34e

PR: From where?

34e

S: We say, do we not, that someone is thirsty?

34e

PR: Of course.

34e

S: And does this mean that he is empty of something?

34e

PR: Indeed.

34e

S: Now, is thirst a desire?

34e

PR: Yes, a desire for drink.

τοιαῦτα ἔφαμεν εἶναί τινας ἐπιθυμίας; ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. πρὸς τί ποτε ἄρα ταῦτόν βλέψαντες οὕτω πολὺ διαφέροντα ταῦθ' ἐνὶ προσαγορεύομεν ὀνόματι; ΠΡΩ. μὰ Δί' οὐ ῥάδιον ἴσως εἰπεῖν, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἀλλ' ὅμως λεκτέον. ΣΩ. ἐκεῖθεν δὴ ἐκ τῶν αὐτῶν πάλιν ἀναλάβωμεν. ΠΡΩ. πόθεν δῆ; ΣΩ. διψῇ γέ που λέγομεν ἐκάστοτέ τι; ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. τοῦτο δέ γ' ἐστὶ κενοῦται; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὐν τὸ διψῶς ἐστὶν ἐπιθυμία; ΠΡΩ. ναί, πώματός γε.

35a

S: For drink, or satisfaction through drink?

35a

PR: I think it is for satisfaction.

35a

S: So, when one of us is empty, it seems that he desires the opposite of whatever he experiences, for being empty he desires satisfaction.

35a

PR: Obviously.

35a

S: What about this? When we are empty for the first time, is there any way we can have contact with satisfaction, either through perception

or through memory, when we have no present experience of satisfaction, and have never experienced it before?

35a

PR: No, how could we?

ΣΩ. πώματος, ἢ πληρώσεως πώματος; ΠΡΩ. οἶμαι μὲν πληρώσεως. ΣΩ. ὁ κενούμενος ἡμῶν ἄρα, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἐπιθυμεῖ τῶν ἐναντίων ἢ πάσχει· κενούμενος γὰρ ἐρᾷ πληροῦσθαι. ΠΡΩ. σαφέστατά γε. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ὁ τὸ πρῶτον κενούμενος ἔστιν ὁπόθεν εἴτ' αἰσθήσει πληρώσεως ἐφάπτοιτ' ἂν εἴτε μνήμη, τούτου ὃ μήτ' ἐν τῷ νῦν χρόνῳ πάσχει μήτ' ἐν τῷ πρόσθεν πώποτε ἔπαθεν; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πῶς;

35b

S: And yet we say that whoever is desiring, desires something.

35b

PR: It must be so.

35b

S: So he does not desire that which he is experiencing, for he is thirsty and this is an emptiness, but his desire is for satisfaction.

35b

PR: Yes.

35b

S: Therefore, some aspect of the thirsty person would somehow have contact with satisfaction.

35b

PR: It must.

35b

S: However, it cannot be the body, for it is presumably empty.

35b

PR: Yes.

35b

S: The only other option is that the soul would have contact with satisfaction, obviously through memory, for how else could it have contact with it?

ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ὃ γε ἐπιθυμῶν τινὸς ἐπιθυμεῖ, φαμέν. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ;
 ΣΩ. οὐκ ἄρα ὃ γε πάσχει, τούτου ἐπιθυμεῖ. διψῇ γάρ, τοῦτο δὲ κένωσις· ὃ
 δ' ἐπιθυμεῖ πληρώσεως. ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. πληρώσεώς γ' ἄρα πῇ τι τῶν τοῦ
 διψῶντος ἂν ἐφάπτοιτο. ΠΡΩ. ἀναγκαῖον. ΣΩ. τὸ μὲν δὴ σῶμα
 ἀδύνατον· κενοῦται γάρ που. ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. τὴν ψυχὴν ἄρα τῆς
 πληρώσεως ἐφάπτεσθαι λοιπόν,

35c

PR: There is hardly any alternative.

35c

S: Do we understand what consequences these arguments have for us?

35c

PR: What are they?

35c

S: This argument is telling us that desire belonging to the body does not arise.

35c

PR: In what way?

35c

S: Because it reveals that every creature consistently strives for the opposite of what it is experiencing.

35c

PR: Very much so.

35c

S: But the urge leading towards the opposite of what is being experienced would presumably make it clear that there is memory of those opposite experiences.

35c

PR: Very much so.

τῇ μνήμῃ δῆλον ὅτι· τῷ γὰρ ἂν ἔτ' ἄλλω ἐφάψαιτο; ΠΡΩ. σχεδὸν οὐδενί.
 ΣΩ. μανθάνομεν οὖν ὃ συμβέβηχ' ἡμῖν ἐκ τούτων τῶν λόγων; ΠΡΩ. τὸ
 ποῖον; ΣΩ. σώματος ἐπιθυμίαν οὐ φησιν ἡμῖν οὗτος ὁ λόγος γίνεσθαι.
 ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ὅτι τοῖς ἐκείνου παθήμασιν ἐναντίαν ἀεὶ παντὸς ζώου

μηνύει τὴν ἐπιχείρησιν. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. ἡ δ' ὁρμή γε ἐπὶ τοῦναντίον ἄγουσα ἢ τὰ παθήματα δηλοῖ που μνήμην οὕσαν τῶν τοῖς παθήμασιν ἐναντίων. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ γε.

35d

S: So, having shown that memory is what impels us towards objects of desire, the argument has demonstrated that every urge and desire, and the motive principle of the entire creature, belongs to soul.

35d

PR: Correct.

35d

S: Therefore, the argument will not accept that our body experiences thirst or hunger or anything of that sort.

35d

PR: Very true.

35d

S: Now, there is something else we should observe about these same examples. Indeed, the argument seems to want to show us that a certain mode of life is implied in these particular cases.

ΣΩ. τὴν ἄρα ἐπάγουσαν ἐπὶ τὰ ἐπιθυμούμενα ἀποδείξας μνήμην ὁ λόγος ψυχῆς σύμπασαν τὴν τε ὁρμὴν καὶ ἐπιθυμίαν καὶ τὴν ἀρχὴν τοῦ ζῶου παντὸς ἀπέφηνεν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα. ΣΩ. διψῆν ἄρα ἡμῶν τὸ σῶμα ἢ πεινῆν ἢ τι τῶν τοιούτων πάσχειν οὐδαμῇ ὁ λόγος αἰρεῖ. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. ἔτι δὲ καὶ τόδε περὶ ταῦτα ταῦτα κατανοήσωμεν. βίου γὰρ εἰδὸς τί μοι φαίνεται βούλεσθαι δηλοῦν ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν ἐν τούτοις αὐτοῖς.

35e

PR: In what cases, and to what sort of life are you referring?

35e

S: I mean cases where there is satisfaction and deficiency, and whatever else is associated with the preservation or destruction of living beings. When one of us encounters either process, he experiences either pain or pleasure, depending on the transformation.

35e

PR: Yes, that is what happens.

35e

S: And what happens if we are in between the two conditions?

35e

PR: How?

35e

S: When someone is pained by an experience, and remembers the pleasures which would stop the pain but is not yet satisfied, what about that? Shall we say that he is in between the two conditions, or shall we not?

ΠΡΩ. ἐν τίσι καὶ ποίου πέρι βίου φράζεις; ΣΩ. ἐν τῷ πληροῦσθαι καὶ κενοῦσθαι καὶ πᾶσιν ὅσα περὶ σωτηρίαν τέ ἐστι τῶν ζώων καὶ τὴν φθοράν, καὶ εἴ τις τούτων ἐν ἑκατέρῳ γιγνόμενος ἡμῶν ἀλγεῖ, τοτὲ δὲ χαίρει κατὰ τὰς μεταβολάς. ΠΡΩ. ἔστι ταῦτα. ΣΩ. τί δ' ὅταν ἐν μέσῳ τούτων γίγνηται; ΠΡΩ. πῶς ἐν μέσῳ; ΣΩ. διὰ μὲν τὸ πάθος ἀλγῆ, μεμνηῖται δὲ τῶν ἡδέων ὧν γενομένων παύοιτ' ἂν τῆς ἀλγηδόνος, πληρῶται δὲ μήπω τί

36a

PR: Let's say that he is.

36a

S: Is he experiencing complete pleasure or complete pain?

36a

PR: Not pleasure, by Zeus. Instead he is afflicted by a twofold pain, one based upon what the body is experiencing, the other based upon the soul's anticipation and longing.

36a

S: Protarchus, how can you say that the pain is twofold? Is it not the case that sometimes when we lack something we stand in evident hope of being satisfied, while at other times, on the contrary, we have no hope?

τότε; φῶμεν ἢ μὴ φῶμεν αὐτὸν ἐν μέσῳ τῶν παθημάτων εἶναι; ΠΡΩ. φῶμεν μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. πότερον ἀλγοῦνθ' ὅλως ἢ χαίροντα; ΠΡΩ. μὰ Δί', ἀλλὰ διπλῇ τινὶ λύπῃ λυπούμενον, κατὰ μὲν τὸ σῶμα ἐν τῷ παθήματι, κατὰ δὲ τὴν ψυχὴν προσδοκίας τινὶ πόθῳ. ΣΩ. πῶς, ὦ Πρώταρχε, τὸ διπλοῦν τῆς λύπης εἶπες; ἄρ' οὐκ ἔστι μὲν ὅτε τις ἡμῶν κενούμενος ἐν ἐλπίδι φανερεῖ τοῦ

36b

PR: Yes, very much so.

36b

S: Don't you think that we are pleased by the memory when there is hope of being satisfied, even though there is also deficiency and we are in pain at that time?

36b

PR: This must be so.

36b

S: On such an occasion, man and the other creatures experience both pleasure and pain simultaneously.

36b

PR: Quite likely.

36b

S: But what if he is empty, with no hope of attaining satisfaction? Isn't that when the twofold affliction would arise over the painful experience which you considered just now, when you expressed the view that the pain is always twofold?

πληρωθήσεσθαι καθέστηκε, τοτὲ δὲ τούναντίον ἀνελπίστως ἔχει; ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα γε. ΣΩ. μὴ οὖν οὐχὶ ἐλπίζων μὲν πληρωθήσεσθαι τῷ μεμνησθαι δοκεῖ σοι χαίρειν, ἅμα δὲ κενούμενος ἐν τούτοις τοῖς χρόνοις ἀλγεῖν; ΠΡΩ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. τότε ἄρ' ἄνθρωπος καὶ τᾶλλα ζῶα λυπεῖται τε ἅμα καὶ χαίρει. ΠΡΩ. κινδυνεύει. ΣΩ. τί δ' ὅταν ἀνελπίστως ἔχῃ κενούμενος τεύξεσθαι πληρώσεως; ἄρ' οὐ τότε τὸ διπλοῦν γίγνεται ἂν περὶ τὰς λύπας πάθος, ὃ σὺ νυνδὴ κατιδὼν ὠήθης ἀπλῶς εἶναι

36c

PR: That is very true, Socrates.

36c

S: Now, let us make some use of this investigation into these experiences in the following way.

36c

PR: In what way?

36c

S: Should we declare that these pains and pleasures are true, or that they are false? Or are some true and others not?

36c

PR: But Socrates, how could pleasures or pains be false?

36c

S: But Protarchus, how could there be true or false fears, or expectations which are true or untrue, or true and false opinions?

διπλοῦν; ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ταύτη δὴ τῇ σκέψει τούτων τῶν παθημάτων τόδε χρῶμεθα. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. πότερον ἀληθεῖς ταύτας τὰς λύπας τε καὶ ἡδονὰς ἢ ψευδεῖς εἶναι λέξομεν; ἢ τὰς μὲν τινὰς ἀληθεῖς, τὰς δ' οὐ; ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ', ὦ Σώκρατες, ἂν εἶεν ψευδεῖς ἡδοναὶ ἢ λύπαι; ΣΩ. πῶς δέ, ὦ Πρώταρχε, φόβοι ἂν ἀληθεῖς ἢ ψευδεῖς, ἢ προσδοκίαι ἀληθεῖς ἢ μὴ, ἢ δόξαι ἀληθεῖς ἢ ψευδεῖς;

36d

PR: Well, I would agree with you about the opinions, but not the others.

36d

S: Do you realise what you are saying? It is very likely that we are initiating a significant discussion.

36d

PR: That's true.

36d

S: Son of a great man! But if it is relevant to what has been said before, we should consider this.

36d

PR: Perhaps, in this case anyway.

36d

S: Then we must forgo any lengthy digression or irrelevant discussions.

36d

PR: Correct.

ΠΡΩ. δόξας μὲν ἔγωγ' ἄν που συγχωροίην, τὰ δ' ἕτερα ταῦτ' οὐκ ἄν. ΣΩ. πῶς φῆς; λόγον μέντοι τινὰ κινδυνεύομεν οὐ πάνυ σμικρὸν ἐπεγείρειν. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθῆ λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' εἰ πρὸς τὰ παρεληλυθότα, ὧ παῖ 'κείνου τάνδρος, προσήκοντα, τοῦτο σκεπτέον. ΠΡΩ. ἴσως τοῦτό γε. ΣΩ. χαίρειν τοίνυν δεῖ λέγειν τοῖς ἄλλοις μήκεσιν ἢ καὶ ὁτῶ οὖν τῶν παρὰ τὸ προσῆκον λεγομένων. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς.

36e

S: So, discuss this with me, for the very perplexities we presented just now are a source of constant wonder to me. What have you to say? Are there not false as well as true pleasures?

36e

PR: How could there be?

36e

S: In that case, you are saying that no one in a dream or awake, in madness or mental disorder, ever presumes that he is experiencing pleasure when he is not experiencing pleasure, or, on the other hand, presumes that he is experiencing pain when he is not experiencing pain.

36e

PR: Socrates, we all presume that these things do happen.

36e

S: But are we right to presume so or should we consider whether this is correct or incorrect?

36e

PR: I'd say we should consider this.

ΣΩ. λέγε δή μοι· θαῦμα γάρ μέ γε ἔχει διὰ τέλους αἰεὶ περὶ τὰ αὐτὰ ἄνυνδῃ προυθέμεθα ἀπορήματα. πῶς δὲ φῆς; ψευδεῖς, αἱ δ' ἀληθεῖς οὐκ εἰσὶν ἡδοναί; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΣΩ. οὔτε δὲ ὄναρ οὔθ' ὕπαρ, ὡς φῆς, ἔστιν οὔτ' ἐν μανίαις οὔτ' ἐν παραφροσύναις οὐδεὶς ἔσθ' ὅστις ποτὲ δοκεῖ μὲν χαίρειν, χαίρει δὲ οὐδαμῶς, οὐδ' αὖ δοκεῖ μὲν λυπεῖσθαι, λυπεῖται δ' οὔ. ΠΡΩ. πάνθ' οὕτω ταῦτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἔχειν πάντες ὑπελήφαμεν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ὀρθῶς; ἢ σκεπτέον εἴτ' ὀρθῶς εἴτε μὴ ταῦτα λέγεται; ΠΡΩ. σκεπτέον, ὥς γ' ἐγὼ φαίην ἄν.

37a

S: Then let us be more precise and clear in discussing pleasure and opinion. Indeed, we do have the power to form opinions, I presume?

37a

PR: Yes.

37a

S: And to experience pleasure?

37a

PR: Yes.

37a

S: And, indeed, is there also an object of opinion?

37a

PR: How could there not be?

37a

S: And is there something by which the enjoyer is pleased?

37a

PR: Again, there must be.

37a

S: Now, whether the one who forms opinions forms them correctly or incorrectly, the actual opinion forming is never lost.

ΣΩ. διορισώμεθα δὴ σαφέστερον ἔτι τὸ νυνδὴ λεγόμενον ἡδονῆς τε πέρι καὶ δόξης. ἔστιν γὰρ πού τι δοξάζειν ἡμῖν; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ ἡδυσθαι; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ τὸ δοξαζόμενόν ἐστί τι; ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. καὶ τό γε ᾧ τὸ ἡδόμενον ἡδεται; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν

τὸ δοξάζον, ἅντε ὀρθῶς ἅντε μὴ ὀρθῶς δοξάζῃ, τό γε δοξάζειν ὄντως οὐδέποτε ἀπόλλυσιν.

37b

PR: No, how could it?

37b

S: And again, whether the enjoyer enjoys correctly or incorrectly, obviously he will never lose the actual enjoying.

37b

PR: Yes, that is also the case.

37b

S: Therefore, we must consider how it comes about that opinion can be either true or false, while pleasure is only true. And yet, the opinion forming and the enjoying are both alike designated as actual.

37b

PR: We should consider this.

ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τὸ ἡδόμενον, ἅντε ὀρθῶς ἅντε μὴ ὀρθῶς ἥδηται, τό γε ὄντως ἥδεσθαι δῆλον ὡς οὐδέποτ' ἀπολεῖ. ΠΡΩ. ναί, καὶ τοῦθ' οὕτως ἔχει. ΣΩ. ὅτω ποτὲ οὖν δὴ τρὸς δόξα ψευδὴς τε καὶ ἀληθὴς ἡμῖν φιλεῖ γίνεσθαι, τὸ δὲ τῆς ἡδονῆς μόνον ἀληθές, δοξάζειν δ' ὄντως καὶ χαίρειν ἀμφοτέρω ὁμοίως εἴληχεν σκεπτόν. ΠΡΩ. σκεπτόν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' ὅτι δόξῃ μὲν ἐπιγίγνεσθον ψευδός τε καὶ

37c

S: True and false are applicable to opinion, and on that account it becomes not just opinion, but opinion with one of these qualities. Is this what you say we should consider?

37c

PR: Yes.

37c

S: But, besides this, we also need to agree whether in general there are things which have qualities, while on the other hand pleasure and pain are just as they are and do not take on any qualities.

37c

PR: Obviously.

37c

S: But it is not hard to see that these two have qualities. For we said a while ago that pleasures and pains can become great or small in varying degrees of intensity.

ἀληθές, καὶ ἐγένετο οὐ μόνον δόξα διὰ ταῦτα ἀλλὰ καὶ ποιὰ τις ἐκάτερα, σκεπτέον φῆς τοῦτ' εἶναι; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. πρὸς δέ γε τούτοις, εἰ καὶ τὸ παράπαν ἡμῖν τὰ μέν ἐστι ποί' ἄττα, ἡδονὴ δὲ καὶ λύπη μόνον ἅπερ ἐστί, ποιῶ τινε δὲ οὐ γίγνεσθον, καὶ ταῦθ' ἡμῖν διομολογητέον. ΠΡΩ. δῆλον. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐδὲν τοῦτό γε χαλεπὸν ἰδεῖν, ὅτι καὶ ποιῶ τινε· πάλα γὰρ εἵπομεν ὅτι μεγάλαί τε καὶ μικραὶ καὶ σφόδρα ἐκότεραι γίνονται, λυπαὶ τε καὶ ἡδοναί.

37d

PR: We certainly did.

37d

S: And yet, Protarchus, if some badness attaches to any of these, shall we say that the opinion becomes bad in this way, and the pleasure also becomes bad?

37d

PR: But of course, Socrates.

37d

S: And what if correctness or the opposite of correctness attaches to any of these? Won't we say that the opinion is correct if it possesses correctness, and that the same goes for pleasure?

37d

PR: We must.

ΠΡΩ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἂν δέ γε πονηρία τούτων, ὧ Πρώταρχε, προσγίγνηται τινι, πονηρὰν μὲν φήσομεν οὕτω γίγνεσθαι δόξαν, πονηρὰν δὲ καὶ ἡδονήν; ΠΡΩ. ἀλλὰ τί μήν, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. τί δ', ἂν ὀρθότης ἢ τούναντίον ὀρθότητι τινὶ τούτων προσγίγνηται; μὴν οὐκ ὀρθὴν μὲν δόξαν ἐροῦμεν, ἂν ὀρθότητα ἴσχη, ταῦτόν δὲ ἡδονήν; ΠΡΩ. ἀναγκαῖον.

37e

S: But if the formation of the opinion involves an error, then the opinion involves an error, and we must agree that it is not correct, and is not being correctly formed.

37e

PR: Yes, how could it be?

37e

S: Then again, if we discern that pain or pleasure involve an error about the object which pains or pleases, should we refer to them as correct, or useful, or apply any other term of praise?

37e

PR: No, we should not, if pleasure can actually be in error.

37e

S: And, indeed, it seems anyway that pleasure often arises in us in conjunction with false opinion rather than correct opinion.

ΣΩ. ἂν δέ γε ἀμαρτανόμενον τὸ δοξαζόμενον ἦ, τὴν δόξαν τότε ἀμαρτάνουσάν γε οὐκ ὀρθὴν ὁμολογητέον οὐδ' ὀρθῶς δοξάζουσιν; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΣΩ. τί δ', ἂν αὖ λύπην ἢ τινα ἡδονὴν περὶ τὸ ἐφ' ᾧ λυπεῖται ἢ τούναντίον ἀμαρτάνουσιν ἐφορῶμεν, ὀρθὴν ἢ χρηστὴν ἢ τι τῶν καλῶν ὀνομάτων αὐτῇ προσθήσομεν; ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' οὐχ οἶόν τε, εἴπερ ἀμαρτήσεται γε ἡδονή. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἔοικέν γε ἡδονὴ πολλάκις οὐ μετὰ δόξης ὀρθῆς ἀλλὰ μετὰ ψεύδους ἡμῖν γίνεσθαι. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὗ; καὶ τὴν μὲν δόξαν γε, ᾧ Σώκρατες,

38a

PR: Yes, of course, Socrates. But in that case, it is the opinion which we then call false, but no one would ever refer to the pleasure itself as false.

38a

S: Protarchus, you are putting up a brave defence with your current statement about pleasure.

38a

PR: Not really. I'm just reporting what I hear.

38a

S: But, my friend, is there no difference for us between the pleasure accompanied by correct opinion and knowledge, and the pleasure accompanied by false opinion and ignorance which frequently arises in each of us?

ἐν τῷ τοιούτῳ καὶ τότε λέγομεν ψευδῆ, τὴν δ' ἡδονὴν αὐτὴν οὐδεὶς ἂν ποτε προσείποι ψευδῆ. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ προθύμως ἀμύνεις τῷ τῆς ἡδονῆς, ὧ Πρώταρχε, λόγῳ τὰ νῦν. ΠΡΩ. οὐδέν γε, ἀλλ' ἅπερ ἀκούω λέγω. ΣΩ. διαφέρει δ' ἡμῖν οὐδέν, ὧ ἑταῖρε, ἢ μετὰ δόξης τε ὀρθῆς καὶ μετ' ἐπιστήμης ἡδονὴ τῆς μετὰ τοῦ ψεύδους καὶ ἀγνοίας πολλάκις ἐκάστοις ἡμῶν ἐγγιγνομένης;

38b

PR: There is probably a significant difference.

38b

S: Then let's proceed to contemplate the difference between them.

38b

PR: Proceed as you see fit.

38b

S: Then I shall proceed in a particular way.

38b

PR: What way?

38b

S: Do we say that our opinion is sometimes true, sometimes false?

38b

PR: It is.

38b

S: And as we said, pleasure and pain often follow these – follow true and false opinion I mean.

38b

PR: Certainly.

38b

S: Don't opinion, and the attempt to form definite opinions, always arise in us, in each case, from memory and perception?

ΠΡΩ. εἰκὸς γοῦν μὴ σμικρὸν διαφέρειν. ΣΩ. τῆς δὴ διαφορᾶς αὐτοῖν ἐπὶ θεωρίαν ἔλθωμεν. ΠΡΩ. ἄγ' ὅπῃ σοι φαίνεται. ΣΩ. τῇδε δὴ ἄγω. ΠΡΩ. πῃ; ΣΩ. δόξα, φαμέν, ἡμῖν ἔστι μὲν ψευδής, ἔστι δὲ καὶ ἀληθής; ΠΡΩ. ἔστιν. ΣΩ. ἔπεται μὴν ταύταις, ὃ νυνδὴ ἐλέγομεν, ἡδονὴ καὶ λύπη πολλάκις, ἀληθεῖ καὶ ψευδεῖ δόξῃ λέγω. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐκ μνήμης τε καὶ αἰσθήσεως δόξα ἡμῖν καὶ τὸ διαδοξάζειν ἐγχειρεῖν γίγνεθ' ἐκάστοτε;

38c

PR: Very much so.

38c

S: Now, do we believe that the following example must be relevant in these cases?

38c

PR: What example?

38c

S: Would you agree that often, when someone happens to see things from a distance, not very clearly, he will want to decide what the objects he is looking at actually are?

38c

PR: I would agree.

38c

S: And wouldn't he go on to a particular question?

38c

PR: Such as?

ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἡμᾶς ὧδε περὶ ταῦτα ἀναγκαῖον ἡγούμεθ' ἴσχειν; ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. πολλάκις ἰδόντι τινὶ πόρρωθεν μὴ πάνυ σαφῶς τὰ καθορώμενα συμβαίνειν βούλεσθαι κρίνειν φαίης ἂν ταῦθ' ἄπερ ὀρᾷ; ΠΡΩ. φαίην ἂν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο αὐτὸς αὐτὸν οὗτος ἀνέροιτ' ἂν ὧδε; ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. τί ποτ' ἄρ' ἔστι τὸ παρὰ τὴν πέτρην τοῦθ' ἐστάναι

38d

S: “What exactly is it that appears to be situated beside that rock under a tree?” Do you think he might say that to himself, when presented with appearances of that nature?

38d

PR: Yes, certainly.

38d

S: And after this, as an answer to such a question, might he say that it is a man, and be correct in his assertion?

38d

PR: Absolutely.

38d

S: And if he makes a mistake, he might say instead that he is looking at a statue, the work of some shepherds.

38d

PR: Very much so.

38d

S: And if someone was with him, he might repeat once more, out loud to his companion, the very words he had spoken to himself. And in this way, what we previously called an opinion would then become a statement.

38d

PR: Of course.

φανταζόμενον ὑπό τινι δένδρῳ; ταῦτ' εἰπεῖν ἂν τις πρὸς ἑαυτὸν δοκεῖ σοι, τοιαῦτ' ἄττα κατιδὼν φαντασθέντα αὐτῷ ποτε; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν μετὰ ταῦτα ὁ τοιοῦτος ὡς ἀποκρινόμενος ἂν πρὸς αὐτὸν εἴποι τοῦτο, ὡς ἔστιν ἄνθρωπος, ἐπιτυχῶς εἰπών; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. καὶ παρενεχθεῖς γ' αὖ τάχ' ἂν ὡς ἔστι τινῶν ποιμένων ἔργον τὸ καθορώμενον ἄγαλμα προσείποι. ΠΡΩ. μάλα γε.

38e

S: However, if he is alone, he thinks the same thing to himself and sometimes proceeds for a considerable time with that idea in mind.

38e

PR: Yes, certainly.

38e

S: Well, I wonder if your view of these situations is like mine.

38e

PR: What is yours like?

38e

S: It seems to me that our soul is then like a book.

38e

PR: How so?

ΣΩ. κἂν μὲν τίς γ' αὐτῷ παρῇ, τά τε πρὸς αὐτὸν ῥηθέντα ἐντείνας εἰς φωνὴν πρὸς τὸν παρόντα αὐτὰ ταῦτ' ἂν πάλιν φθέγγαιτο, καὶ λόγος δὴ γέγονεν οὕτως ὃ τότε δόξαν ἐκαλοῦμεν; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. ἂν δ' ἄρα μόνος ἦ τοῦτο ταῦτὸν πρὸς αὐτὸν διανοούμενος, ἐνίστε καὶ πλείω χρόνον ἔχων ἐν αὐτῷ πορεύεται. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ἄρα σοὶ φαίνεται τὸ περὶ τούτων ὅπερ ἐμοί; ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. δοκεῖ μοι τότε ἡμῶν ἡ ψυχὴ βιβλίῳ τινὶ προσεικέναι. ΠΡΩ. πῶς;

39a

S: When memory coincides with the perceptions and the experiences which are associated with them, they almost seem to me then, in a way, to write words in our souls. And when the truth is written, it results in the generation of true opinion and true arguments within us. However, when our so-called internal scribe writes what is false, it results in the opposite of true opinions and arguments.

ΣΩ. ἡ μνήμη ταῖς αἰσθήσεσι συμπίπτουσα εἰς ταῦτὸν κάκεινα ἃ περὶ ταῦτ' ἐστὶ τὰ παθήματα φαίνονται μοι σχεδὸν οἷον γράφειν ἡμῶν ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς τότε λόγους· καὶ ὅταν μὲν ἀληθῆ γράφῃ τοῦτο τὸ πάθημα, δόξα τε ἀληθῆς καὶ λόγοι ἀπ' αὐτοῦ συμβαίνουσιν ἀληθεῖς ἐν ἡμῖν γιγνόμενοι· ψευδῆ δ' ὅταν ὁ τοιοῦτος παρ' ἡμῖν γραμματεὺς γράφῃ, τάναντία τοῖς ἀληθέσιν ἀπέβη.

39b

PR: Yes, that is how it seems to me, and I accept this manner of describing it.

39b

S: Then you should also accept that another craftsman arises in our souls at the same time.

39b

PR: Who is he?

39b

S: A painter, who is beside the writer of whatever is said, drawing images of this in the soul.

39b

PR: Yes, but how do we say he does this, and when?

39b

S: It occurs when a person has derived opinions and formulations from sight or some other sense perception, and then somehow beholds images of the opinions and formulations within himself. Doesn't this happen to us?

ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν δοκεῖ μοι, καὶ ἀποδέχομαι τὰ ῥηθέντα οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἀποδέχου δὴ καὶ ἕτερον δημιουργὸν ἡμῶν ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς ἐν τῷ τότε χρόνῳ γιγνόμενον. ΠΡΩ. τίνα; ΣΩ. ζωγράφον, ὃς μετὰ τὸν γραμματιστὴν τῶν λεγομένων εἰκόνας ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ τούτων γράφει. ΠΡΩ. πῶς δὴ τοῦτον αὖ καὶ πότε λέγομεν; ΣΩ. ὅταν ἀπ' ὅψεως ἢ τινος ἄλλης αἰσθήσεως τὰ τότε δοξαζόμενα καὶ λεγόμενα ἀπαγαγὼν τις τὰς τῶν δοξασθέντων

39c

PR: It certainly does.

39c

S: And aren't the images of the true opinions and formulations true, while the images of the false ones are false?

39c

PR: Entirely so.

39c

S: Now, if we have described this correctly, there is an additional point we must consider.

39c

PR: What is it?

39c

S: Whether this is how we must experience the present or the past events, but not, however, the future events.

39c

PR: Surely it applies to all divisions of time.

καὶ λεχθέντων εἰκόνας ἐν αὐτῷ ὁρᾷ πως. ἢ τοῦτο οὐκ ἔστι γιγνόμενον παρ' ἡμῖν; ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν αἱ μὲν τῶν ἀληθῶν δοξῶν καὶ λόγων εἰκόνες ἀληθεῖς, αἱ δὲ τῶν ψευδῶν ψευδεῖς; ΠΡΩ. παντάπασιν. ΣΩ. εἰ δὴ ταῦτ' ὁρθῶς εἰρήκαμεν, ἔτι καὶ τόδε ἐπὶ τούτοις σκεψώμεθα. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. εἰ περὶ μὲν τῶν ὄντων καὶ τῶν γεγονότων ταῦτα ἡμῖν οὕτω πάσχειν ἀναγκαῖον, περὶ δὲ τῶν μελλόντων οὐ; ΠΡΩ. περὶ ἀπάντων μὲν οὖν τῶν χρόνων ὡσαύτως.

39d

S: Wasn't it stated earlier that pleasures and pains arising from the soul itself may come into being before pleasures and pains arising from the body? As a consequence, anticipated pleasures and pains about the future arise in us.

39d

PR: Very true.

39d

S: Now, we proposed a little earlier that writings and drawings are produced within us. But do these relate only to past and present time, and not to the future?

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν αἱ γε διὰ τῆς ψυχῆς αὐτῆς ἡδοναὶ καὶ λυπαὶ ἐλέχθησαν ἐν τοῖς πρόσθεν ὡς πρὸ τῶν διὰ τοῦ σώματος ἡδονῶν καὶ λυπῶν προγίγνοιντ' ἄν, ὥσθ' ἡμῖν συμβαίνει τὸ προχαίρειν τε καὶ προλυπεῖσθαι περὶ τὸν μέλλοντα χρόνον εἶναι γιγνόμενον; ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν τὰ γράμματά τε καὶ ζωγραφήματα, ἃ σμικρῷ πρότερον ἐτίθεμεν ἐν ἡμῖν γίγνεσθαι, περὶ μὲν τὸν

39e

PR: They definitely relate to the future.

39e

S: So, are you stating emphatically that all these are hopes for the future, and that we, for our part, are always full of hopes throughout our entire life?

39e

PR: Entirely so.

39e

S: Come now, I have a further question from what we have just said.

39e

PR: What is it?

39e

S: Isn't a just and holy and entirely good man also divinely favoured?

39e

PR: Of course.

γεγονότα καὶ τὸν παρόντα χρόνον ἐστίν, περὶ δὲ τὸν μέλλοντα οὐκ ἔστιν; ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. ἄρα σφόδρα λέγεις, ὅτι πάντ' ἐστὶ ταῦτα ἐλπίδες εἰς τὸν ἔπειτα χρόνον οὔσαι, ἡμεῖς δ' αὖ διὰ παντὸς τοῦ βίου ἀεὶ γέμομεν ἐλπίδων; ΠΡΩ. παντάπασι μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἄγε δὴ, πρὸς τοῖς νῦν εἰρημένοις καὶ τόδε ἀπόκριναι. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. δίκαιος ἀνὴρ καὶ εὐσεβὴς καὶ ἀγαθὸς πάντως ἄρ' οὐ θεοφιλὴς ἐστίν; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. τί δέ; ἄδικός τε καὶ παντάπασι κακὸς ἄρ' οὐ

40a

S: And what about an unjust and utterly bad man? Isn't he in the opposite case?

40a

PR: He must be.

40a

S: Now, every man, as we said earlier, is full of many hopes.

40a

PR: How could he avoid it?

40a

S: Then there are accounts in each of us which we call hopes.

40a

PR: Yes.

40a

S: And what is more, there are the painted images, and a person may often see himself acquiring a huge quantity of gold and a great deal of pleasure on that account. And in this picture he sees himself absolutely delighted with himself.

τούναντίον ἐκείνῳ; ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. πολλῶν μὲν ἐλπίδων, ὡς ἐλέγομεν ἄρτι, πᾶς ἄνθρωπος γέμει; ΠΡΩ. τί δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. λόγοι μὲν εἰσιν ἐν ἐκάστοις ἡμῶν, ἃς ἐλπίδας ὀνομάζομεν; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. καὶ δὴ καὶ τὰ φαντάσματα ἐζωγραφημένα· καὶ τις ὅρᾳ πολλάκις ἑαυτῷ χρυσὸν γιγνόμενον ἄφθονον καὶ ἐπ' αὐτῷ πολλὰς ἡδονὰς· καὶ δὴ καὶ ἐνεζωγραφημένον αὐτὸν ἐφ' αὐτῷ χαίροντα σφόδρα καθορᾷ.

40b

PR: Inevitably.

40b

S: Now, should we say that the pictures presented to the good people are generally true, due to the divine favour, while the opposite sort are generally presented to the bad people? Should we say this or not?

40b

PR: We certainly should say this.

40b

S: Therefore, the bad people also have just as many pleasures depicted within, but presumably the pleasures are false.

40b

PR: Of course.

ΠΡΩ. τί δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. τούτων οὖν πότερα φῶμεν τοῖς μὲν ἀγαθοῖς ὡς τὸ πολὺ τὰ γεγραμμένα παρατίθεσθαι ἀληθῆ διὰ τὸ θεοφιλεῖς εἶναι, τοῖς δὲ κακοῖς ὡς αὖ τὸ πολὺ τούναντίον, ἢ μὴ φῶμεν; ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα φατέον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τοῖς κακοῖς ἡδοναί γε οὐδὲν ἥττον πάρεισιν ἐζωγραφημένα, ψευδεῖς δὲ αὐταῖ που. ΠΡΩ. τί μὲν;

40c

S: So the bad people delight for the most part in false pleasures, while the good people delight in the true.

40c

PR: What you say is most compelling.

40c

S: Then, based upon the present argument, there are false pleasures in people's souls, though they imitate the true pleasures in a ridiculous manner, and the same also applies to pains.

40c

PR: There are.

40c

S: Now, it was shown that it is always possible for someone who forms any opinion actually to form that opinion even though it is sometimes based neither upon the present, the past or the future.

40c

PR: Very much so.

ΣΩ. ψευδέσιν ἄρα ἡδοναῖς τὰ πολλὰ οἱ πονηροὶ χαίρουσιν, οἱ δ' ἀγαθοὶ τῶν ἀνθρώπων ἀληθέσιν. ΠΡΩ. ἀναγκαιότατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. εἰσὶν δὴ κατὰ τοὺς νῦν λόγους ψευδεῖς ἐν ταῖς τῶν ἀνθρώπων ψυχαῖς ἡδοναί, μεμιμημέναι μέντοι τὰς ἀληθεῖς ἐπὶ τὰ γελοιότερα, καὶ λῦπαι δὲ ὡσαύτως. ΠΡΩ. εἰσὶν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἦν δοξάζειν μὲν ὄντως ἀεὶ τῷ τὸ παράπαν δοξάζοντι, μὴ ἐπ' οὓσι δὲ μὴδ' ἐπὶ γεγονόσι μὴδὲ ἐπ' ἐσομένοις ἐνίοτε. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ γε.

40d

S: And these were, I believe, responsible for false opinions and their formation. Is this so?

40d

PR: Yes.

40d

S: Well now, shouldn't we also assign to pleasure and pain a condition corresponding to these?

40d

PR: In what way?

40d

S: In the sense that it is always possible for someone who enjoys any pleasure, however unreasonable, to have actual enjoyment, even though it sometimes has no basis in the present or the past, and often – yes, perhaps most often – has no basis in anything that will ever happen.

ΣΩ. καὶ ταῦτά γε ἦν οἶμαι τὰ ἀπεργαζόμενα δόξαν ψευδῇ τότε καὶ τὸ ψευδῶς δοξάζειν. ἦ γάρ; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; οὐκ ἀνταποδοτέον ταῖς λύπαις τε καὶ ἡδοναῖς τὴν τούτων ἀντίστροφον ἔξιν ἐν ἐκείνοις; ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ὥς ἦν μὲν χαίρειν ὄντως ἀεὶ τῷ τὸ παράπαν ὅπως οὖν καὶ εἰκῇ χαίροντι, μὴ μέντοι ἐπὶ τοῖς οὓσι μὴδ' ἐπὶ τοῖς γεγονόσιν ἐνίστε, πολλάκις δὲ καὶ ἴσως πλειστάκις ἐπὶ τοῖς μὴδὲ μέλλουσί ποτε γενήσεσθαι.

40e

PR: Yes, Socrates, that's also the way it must be.

40e

S: Wouldn't the same argument apply to fear and anger, and everything of that sort, that all such responses are sometimes false?

40e

PR: Very much so.

40e

S: What about this? Can we say whether opinions are bad or good unless we refer to their falsehood?

40e

PR: There is no other way.

40e

S: And we realise, I presume, that there is no other way for pleasures to be bad except by being false.

ΠΡΩ. καὶ ταῦθ' οὕτως ἀναγκαῖον, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἔχειν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὁ αὐτὸς λόγος ἂν εἴη περὶ φόβων τε καὶ θυμῶν καὶ πάντων τῶν

τοιούτων, ὥς ἔστι καὶ ψευδῇ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα ἐνίστε; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. τί δέ; πονηρὰς δόξας καὶ χρηστὰς ἄλλως ἢ ψευδεῖς γιγνομένας ἔχομεν εἰπεῖν; ΠΡΩ. οὐκ ἄλλως. ΣΩ. οὐδ' ἡδονὰς γ' οἶμαι κατανοοῦμεν ὥς ἄλλον τινὰ τρόπον εἰσὶν πονηραὶ πλήν τῷ ψευδεῖς εἶναι.

41a

PR: No, Socrates, the precise opposite is the case. Indeed, hardly anyone would suggest that pleasures and pains are bad on account of falsity. No, it is due to the occurrence of a different badness which is extensive and varied.

41a

S: Well, we shall discuss bad pleasures, and those which are as they are through badness, a little later if we both see fit. But we should now discuss, in a different way, the numerous false pleasures which are so often present and arising within us. For perhaps we may find this useful in making our decision.

ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν τούναντίον, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἵρηκας. σχεδὸν γὰρ τῷ ψεύδει μὲν οὐ πάνυ πονηρὰς ἄν τις λύπας τε καὶ ἡδονὰς θείη, μεγάλη δὲ ἄλλη καὶ πολλῇ συμπιπτούσας πονηρίᾳ. ΣΩ. τὰς μὲν τοίνυν πονηρὰς ἡδονὰς καὶ διὰ πονηρίαν οὔσας τοιαύτας ὀλίγον ὕστερον ἐροῦμεν, ἂν ἔτι δοκῇ νῶν· τὰς δὲ ψευδεῖς κατ' ἄλλον τρόπον ἐν ἡμῖν πολλὰς καὶ πολλάκις

41b

PR: Yes. It must be helpful, but only if there are, in fact, pleasures like this.

41b

S: But, Protarchus, in my opinion anyway there are such pleasures. And now that we have raised the issue, this view cannot be left unexamined.

41b

PR: Very well.

41b

S: Then just like athletes, let's take up our positions in relation to this additional argument.

41b

PR: Let's proceed.

ἐνούσας τε καὶ ἐγγιγνομένας λεκτέον. τούτῳ γὰρ ἴσως χρῆσόμεθα πρὸς τὰς κρίσεις. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐκ; εἴπερ γε εἰσὶν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ', ὦ Πρώταρχε, εἰσὶν κατὰ γε τὴν ἐμὴν. τοῦτο δὲ τὸ δόγμα ἕως ἂν κέηται παρ' ἡμῖν, ἀδύνατον ἀνέλεγκτον δήπου γίνεσθαι. ΠΡΩ. καλῶς. ΣΩ. περιστρώμεθα δὴ καθάπερ ἀθληταὶ πρὸς τοῦτον αὖ τὸν λόγον. ΠΡΩ. ἴωμεν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν εἴπομεν, εἴπερ μεμνήμεθα, ὀλίγον ἐν

41c

S: Well, we said a little earlier, if my memory serves me well, that whenever there are so-called desires in us, the body and the soul are then separated, and divided in relation to their experiences.

41c

PR: I do remember, and that is what was said.

41c

S: Wasn't it soul that desired conditions opposite to the condition of the body, while the body for its part, through its experience, furnished the pain or some pleasure?

41c

PR: Yes, that's how it was described.

41c

S: Now, work out what is happening in these circumstances.

41c

PR: Please tell me.

τοῖς πρόσθεν, ὡς ὅταν αἱ λεγόμεναι ἐπιθυμίαι ἐν ἡμῖν ᾧσι, δίχα ἄρα τότε τὸ σῶμα καὶ χωρὶς τῆς ψυχῆς τοῖς παθήμασι διείληπται. ΠΡΩ. μεμνήμεθα καὶ προερρήθη ταῦτα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ μὲν ἐπιθυμοῦν ἦν ἡ ψυχὴ τῶν τοῦ σώματος ἐναντίων ἕξεων, τὸ δὲ τὴν ἀληθδόναν ἢ τινα διὰ πάθος ἡδονὴν τὸ σῶμα ἦν τὸ παρεχόμενον; ΠΡΩ. ἦν γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. συλλογίζου δὴ τὸ γινόμενον ἐν τούτοις. ΠΡΩ. λέγε.

41d

S: What happens is this. In this situation, pleasure and pain are present at the same time, and although they are opposite to one another, the perception of them occurs simultaneously, as we have shown just now.

41d

PR: Yes, we did.

41d

S: Now, was there something said and agreed upon by us earlier?

41d

PR: What?

41d

S: That both pleasure and pain admit of greater and lesser, and both are in the class of the limitless.

41d

PR: We did say that. What of it?

41d

S: What means are there of judging them correctly?

ΣΩ. γίγνεται τοίνυν, ὅποταν ἢ ταῦτα, ἅμα παρακεῖσθαι λύπας τε καὶ ἡδονάς, καὶ τούτων αἰσθήσεις ἅμα παρ' ἀλλήλας ἐναντίων οὐσῶν γίγνεσθαι, ὃ καὶ νυνδὴ ἐφάνη. ΠΡΩ. φαίνεται γοῦν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τόδε εἴρηται καὶ συνωμολογημένον ἡμῖν ἔμπροσθε κεῖται; ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὥς τὸ μᾶλλον τε καὶ ἥττον ἄμφω τούτῳ δέχεσθον, λύπη τε καὶ ἡδονή, καὶ ὅτι τῶν ἀπείρων εἴτην. ΠΡΩ. εἴρηται. τί μήν; ΣΩ. τίς οὖν μηχανὴ ταῦτ' ὀρθῶς κρίνεσθαι;

41e

PR: What sort of judgement? About what?

41e

S: The aim of our judgement about them in such situations is to decide on any occasion if one is greater or lesser than the other, or more numerous or more intense, by comparing pain to pleasure, pain to pain, and pleasure to pleasure.

41e

PR: Yes, this is so. And these are the sorts of things our judgement aims at.

ΠΡΩ. πῇ δὴ καὶ πῶς; ΣΩ. εἰ τὸ βούλημα ἡμῖν τῆς κρίσεως τούτων ἐν τοιούτοις τισὶ διαγνῶναι βούλεται ἐκάστοτε τίς τούτων πρὸς ἀλλήλας μείζων καὶ τίς ἐλάττων καὶ τίς μᾶλλον καὶ τίς σφοδρότερα, λύπη τε πρὸς ἡδονὴν καὶ λύπη πρὸς λύπην καὶ ἡδονὴ πρὸς ἡδονήν. ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' ἔστι ταῦτά τε τοιαῦτα καὶ ἡ βούλησις τῆς κρίσεως αὕτη. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ἐν μὲν ὄψει τὸ πόρρωθεν καὶ ἐγγύθεν ὁρᾶν

42a

S: What about this? In the case of sight, seeing the sizes of objects from afar and from close up misrepresents the truth, and gives rise to false opinion. However, does the same thing happen in the case of pain and pleasure?

42a

PR: Yes, to an even greater extent, Socrates.

42a

S: Well, this conclusion turns out to be the opposite of the earlier one.

42a

PR: In what way do you mean?

42a

S: In the previous case, the opinions themselves were true or false, and they simultaneously infected the pleasures and pains with their own characteristics.

τὰ μεγέθη τὴν ἀλήθειαν ἀφανίζει καὶ ψευδῇ ποιεῖ δοξάζειν, ἐν λύπαις δ' ἄρα καὶ ἡδοναῖς οὐκ ἔστι ταῦτόν τοῦτο γιγνόμενον; ΠΡΩ. πολὺ μὲν οὖν μᾶλλον, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἐναντίον δὴ τὸ νῦν τῷ σμικρὸν ἔμπροσθε γέγονεν. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον λέγεις; ΣΩ. τότε μὲν αἱ δόξαι ψευδεῖς τε καὶ ἀληθεῖς αὗται γιγνόμεναι τὰς λύπας τε καὶ ἡδονὰς ἅμα τοῦ παρ' αὐταῖς παθήματος ἀνεπίμπλασαν.

42b

PR: Very true.

42b

S: But now they change because they are viewed from near or far, as the case may be. And once they are compared with one another, the pleasures appear greater and more intense compared to the pains, and the pains in turn seem smaller in comparison with the pleasures.

42b

PR: This sort of thing must occur under these circumstances.

42b

S: Now, each appears greater or lesser than it actually is, and if you sever this ‘appearing but not being’ from either of them, you will never propose that its appearance is correct, nor would you ever dare to assert that anything associated with this portion of pleasure and pain is ever correct and true.

ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. νῦν δέ γε αὐταὶ διὰ τὸ πόρρωθέν τε καὶ ἐγγύθεν ἐκάστοτε μεταβαλλόμεναι θεωρεῖσθαι, καὶ ἅμα τιθέμεναι παρ’ ἀλλήλας, αἱ μὲν ἡδοναὶ παρὰ τὸ λυπηρὸν μείζους φαίνονται καὶ σφοδρότεραι, λῦπαι δ’ αὖ διὰ τὸ παρ’ ἡδονὰς τοῦναντίον ἐκείναις. ΠΡΩ. ἀνάγκη γίγνεσθαι τὰ τοιαῦτα διὰ ταῦτα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὅσῳ μείζους τῶν οὐσῶν ἐκάτεροι καὶ ἐλάττους φαίνονται, τοῦτο ἀποτεμόμενος ἐκατέρων τὸ φαινόμενον

42c

PR: Not at all.

42c

S: Then, in addition to these, we shall see whether there is a way in which we may find even more false pleasures and pains than these in living creatures, both actually and apparently.

42c

PR: But what are they like? And how shall we find them?

42c

S: It has been said quite often that when the nature of any creature is disrupted by agglomerations, separations, replenishments, depletions, and certain growths and withering, what follows is pain, suffering, distress, and whatever else goes under such names.

ἀλλ' οὐκ ὄν, οὔτε αὐτὸ ὀρθῶς φαινόμενον ἐρεῖς, οὐδ' αὖ ποτε τὸ ἐπὶ τούτῳ μέρος τῆς ἡδονῆς καὶ λύπης γιγνόμενον ὀρθόν τε καὶ ἀληθές τολμήσεις λέγειν. ΠΡΩ. οὐ γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. τούτων τοίνυν ἐξῆς ὁψόμεθα ἔαν τῇδε ἀπαντῶμεν ἡδονὰς καὶ λύπας ψευδεῖς ἔτι μᾶλλον ἢ ταύτας φαινομένας τε καὶ οὐσας ἐν τοῖς ζώοις. ΠΡΩ. ποίας δὴ καὶ πῶς λέγεις; ΣΩ. εἴρηταί που πολλάκις ὅτι τῆς φύσεως ἐκάστων διαφθειρομένης μὲν συγκρίσεις καὶ διακρίσεις καὶ πληρώσεις

42d

PR: Yes, that has often been said.

42d

S: However, once it is restored to its own nature, we agreed among ourselves that this restoration is pleasure.

42d

PR: Correct.

42d

S: But what about the situation in which neither of these processes is happening to our bodies?

42d

PR: But when would that ever happen, Socrates?

καὶ κενώσεις καὶ τισιν αὐξαις καὶ φθίσεις λυπαί τε καὶ ἀλγηδόνες καὶ ὀδύνη καὶ πάνθ' ὅποσα τοιαῦτ' ὀνόματα ἔχει συμβαίνει γιγνόμενα. ΠΡΩ. ναί, ταῦτα εἴρηται πολλάκις. ΣΩ. εἰς δέ γε τὴν αὐτῶν φύσιν ὅταν καθιστῇται, ταύτην αὖ τὴν κατάστασιν ἡδονὴν ἀπεδεξάμεθα παρ' ἡμῶν αὐτῶν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΣΩ. τί δ' ὅταν περὶ τὸ σῶμα μηδὲν τούτων γιγνόμενον ἡμῶν ᾗ; ΠΡΩ. πότε δὲ τοῦτ' ἂν γένοιτο, ὦ Σώκρατες;

42e

S: The question you just asked is not to the point, Protarchus.

42e

PR: Why is that?

42e

S: Because there is nothing to prevent me putting my original question to you once more.

42e

PR: In what way?

42e

S: I shall say, Protarchus, if something like this may not happen, what must the consequences of this be for ourselves?

42e

PR: Are you referring to the consequences of there being no movement of the body by either process?

42e

S: Just so.

42e

PR: Well, one thing is obvious anyway, Socrates. In such a situation, neither pleasure nor any pain would ever arise.

ΣΩ. οὐδὲν πρὸς λόγον ἐστίν, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ὃ σὺ νῦν ἤρου τὸ ἐρώτημα. ΠΡΩ. τί δή; ΣΩ. διότι τὴν ἐμὴν ἐρώτησιν οὐ κωλύεις με διερέσθαι σε πάλιν. ΠΡΩ. ποίαν; ΣΩ. εἰ δ' οὖν μὴ γίγνοιτο, ὦ Πρώταρχε, φήσω, τὸ τοιοῦτον, τί ποτε ἀναγκαῖον ἐξ αὐτοῦ συμβαίνειν ἡμῖν; ΠΡΩ. μὴ κινουμένου τοῦ σώματος ἐφ' ἑκάτερα φής; ΣΩ. οὕτως. ΠΡΩ. δῆλον δὴ τοῦτό γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὡς οὔτε ἡδονὴ γίγνοιτ' ἂν ἐν τῷ τοιοῦτῳ ποτὲ οὔτ' ἂν τις λύπη.

43a

S: Well said. And yet I think you mean that we are always experiencing one or other of these processes, for as the wise say, everything is constantly flowing back and forth.

43a

PR: Yes, that is what they say. And it seems quite important.

43a

S: Well it would be, wouldn't it, since the men themselves are quite important? However, I wish to evade this impending argument, so I intend to get away from it in this way, and you should escape with me.

43a

PR: Tell me how.

ΣΩ. κάλλιστ' εἶπες. ἀλλὰ γὰρ οἶμαι τόδε λέγεις, ὥς αἰί τι τούτων ἀναγκαῖον ἡμῖν συμβαίνειν, ὥς οἱ σοφοί φασιν· αἰί γὰρ ἅπαντα ἄνω τε καὶ κάτω ρεῖ. ΠΡΩ. λέγουσι γὰρ οὖν, καὶ δοκοῦσί γε οὐ φαύλως λέγειν. ΣΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν, μὴ φαῦλοί γε ὄντες; ἀλλὰ γὰρ ὑπεκστῆναι τὸν λόγον ἐπιφερόμενον τοῦτον βούλομαι. τῇδ' οὖν διανοοῦμαι φεύγειν, καὶ σύ μοι σύμφευγε. ΠΡΩ. λέγε ὅπη. ΣΩ. ταῦτα μὲν τοίνυν οὕτως ἔστω, φῶμεν πρὸς τούτους·

43b

S: We should tell them that we accept what they say. However, you should tell me whether all living beings always notice everything that happens to them, so that we are not unaware even that we ourselves are growing, or being affected in that sort of way at all. Is that the case, or is it the very opposite?

43b

PR: Obviously it is the very opposite, for we are hardly aware of that sort of thing at all.

43b

S: Then, what we said just now was not well formulated – that the occurrence of changes ‘back and forth’ brings about pleasure and pain.

43b

PR: Of course not.

σὸ δ' ἀπόκριναι πότερον αἰί πάντα, ὅποσα πάσχει τι τῶν ἐμψύχων, ταῦτ' αἰσθάνεται τὸ πάσχον, καὶ οὗτ' ἀυξανόμενοι λανθάνομεν ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς οὔτε τι τῶν τοιούτων οὐδὲν πάσχοντες, ἢ πᾶν τοῦναντίον. ΠΡΩ. ἅπαν δήπου τοῦναντίον· ὀλίγου γὰρ τά γε τοιαῦτα ἐλήθε πάνθ' ἡμᾶς. ΣΩ. οὐ τοίνυν καλῶς ἡμῖν εἴρηται τὸ νυνδὴ ρηθέν, ὥς αἰ μεταβολαὶ κάτω τε καὶ ἄνω γιγνόμεναι λύπας τε καὶ ἡδονὰς ἀπεργάζονται. ΠΡΩ. τί μήν;

43c

S: There is a better formulation, which will be less open to criticism.

43c

PR: How should we put it?

43c

S: That significant changes cause pleasure and pain in us, while, on the other hand, moderate minor changes produce neither of them at all.

43c

PR: That is a more correct formulation than the other one, Socrates.

43c

S: Well, if that is the case, then the life we were discussing earlier is making a reappearance.

43c

PR: What sort of life?

43c

S: The one which we said was devoid of pain and without enjoyment.

43c

PR: Yes, that is very true.

ΣΩ. ὥδ' ἔσται κάλλιον καὶ ἀνεπιληπτότερον τὸ λεγόμενον. ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ὥς αἱ μὲν μεγάλαι μεταβολαὶ λύπας τε καὶ ἡδονὰς ποιοῦσιν ἡμῖν, αἱ δ' αὖ μέτριά τε καὶ σμικραὶ τὸ παράπαν οὐδέτερα τούτων. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότερον οὕτως ἢ 'κείνως, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ ταῦτα οὕτω, πάλιν ὁ νυνδὴ ῥηθεὶς βίος ἂν ἦκοι. ΠΡΩ. ποῖος; ΣΩ. ὃν ἄλυπόν τε καὶ ἄνευ χαρμονῶν ἔφαμεν εἶναι. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. ἐκ δὴ τούτων τιθῶμεν τριττοὺς ἡμῖν βίους, ἕνα

43d

S: So, on this basis, we may propose three lives, one pleasant, another painful, and one which is neither. Or what would you say about them?

43d

PR: I would not say anything different. There are three lives.

43d

S: In that case, not experiencing pain could never be the same as experiencing enjoyment.

43d

PR: No, how could it?

43d

S: So when you hear someone say that to live one's entire life painlessly is the most pleasant thing of all, what do you suppose that he means?

43d

PR: It seems to me that he is saying that pleasure consists in not experiencing pain.

μὲν ἡδύν, τὸν δ' αὖ λυπηρόν, τὸν δ' ἓνα μηδέτερα. ἢ πῶς ἂν φαίης σὺ περὶ τούτων; ΠΡΩ. οὐκ ἄλλως ἔγωγε ἢ ταύτη, τρεῖς εἶναι τοὺς βίους. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οὐκ ἂν εἴη τὸ μὴ λυπεῖσθαι ποτε ταῦτόν τῳ χαίρειν; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΣΩ. ὁπόταν οὖν ἀκούσης ὡς ἡδιστον πάντων ἐστὶν ἀλύπως διατελεῖν τὸν βίον ἅπαντα, τί τόθ' ὑπολαμβάνεις λέγειν τὸν τοιοῦτον; ΠΡΩ. ἡδὺ λέγειν φαίνεται ἔμοιγε οὗτος τὸ μὴ λυπεῖσθαι.

43e

S: Now, select any three entities you wish, say gold and silver and a third which is neither, just to give them more attractive titles.

43e

PR: Done.

43e

S: Well, is there any way that the one which is neither of these could become either gold or silver?

43e

PR: No, how could it?

43e

S: So, based upon a proper account, the middle life may never be correctly regarded as pleasant or painful. And if someone were to think so, it would not be right to think so; and if someone were to say so, it would not be right to say so.

43e

PR: It would not.

ΣΩ. τριῶν ὄντων οὖν ἡμῖν, ὧντινων βούλει, τίθει, καλλίσιον ἵνα ὀνόμασι χρώμεθα, τὸ μὲν χρυσόν, τὸ δ' ἄργυρον, τρίτον δὲ τὸ μηδέτερα τούτων. ΠΡΩ. κεῖται. ΣΩ. τὸ δὴ μηδέτερα τούτων ἔσθ' ἡμῖν ὅπως θάτερα

γένοιτο ἄν, χρυσὸς ἢ ἄργυρος; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πῶς ἄν; ΣΩ. οὐδ' ἄρα ὁ μέσος βίος ἡδὺς ἢ λυπηρὸς λεγόμενος ὀρθῶς ἄν ποτε οὗτ' εἰ δοξάζοι τις, δοξάζοιτο, οὗτ' εἰ λέγοι, λεχθείη, κατὰ γε τὸν ὀρθὸν λόγον. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν;

44a

S: And yet, my friend, we are aware of people who say this and think this.

44a

PR: Very much so.

44a

S: In that case, do they think they are experiencing pleasure when they experience no pain?

44a

PR: So they say, anyway.

44a

S: Then they believe they are experiencing pleasure at that time, or else they would not have said so I presume.

44a

PR: Quite likely.

44a

S: Well then, they are forming a false opinion about pleasure, if in fact experiencing no pain is, by nature, distinct from experiencing pleasure.

44a

PR: And they certainly are distinct.

ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν, ὦ ἑταῖρε, λεγόντων γε ταῦτα καὶ δοξαζόντων αἰσθανόμεθα. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν καὶ χαίρειν οἶονται τότε ὅταν μὴ λυπῶνται; ΠΡΩ. φασὶ γοῦν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οἶονται τότε χαίρειν οὐ γὰρ ἄν ἔλεγόν που. ΠΡΩ. κινδυνεύει. ΣΩ. ψευδῇ γε μὴν δοξάζουσι περὶ τοῦ χαίρειν, εἴπερ χωρὶς τοῦ μὴ λυπεῖσθαι καὶ τοῦ χαίρειν ἡ φύσις ἐκατέρου. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μὴν χωρὶς γε ἦν. ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν αἰρώμεθα παρ' ἡμῖν ταῦτ' εἶναι, καθάπερ

44b

S: Now, we should decide for ourselves whether there are three lives, as we said just now, or only two – pain, which is bad for people, and freedom from pain, which in itself is good and should be called pleasure.

44b

PR: But why are we asking ourselves this question now, Socrates? I don't really understand.

44b

S: Then, Protarchus, you do not really understand who Philebus' enemies are.

44b

PR: To which enemies are you referring?

44b

S: Men who give very brilliant accounts of natural phenomena, and who deny that pleasures have any being at all.

44b

PR: In what way?

ἄρτι, τρία, ἢ δύο μόνα, λύπην μὲν κακὸν τοῖς ἀνθρώποις, τὴν δ' ἀπαλλαγὴν τῶν λυπῶν, αὐτὸ τοῦτο ἀγαθὸν ὄν, ἥδὺ προσαγορεύεσθαι; ΠΡΩ. πῶς δὴ νῦν τοῦτο, ὃ Σώκρατες, ἐρωτώμεθα ὑφ' ἡμῶν αὐτῶν; οὐ γὰρ μανθάνω. ΣΩ. ὅντως γὰρ τοὺς πολεμίους Φιλῆβου τοῦδε, ὃ Πρώταρχε, οὐ μανθάνεις; ΠΡΩ. λέγεις δὲ αὐτοὺς τίνας; ΣΩ. καὶ μάλα δεινοὺς λεγομένους τὰ περὶ φύσιν, οἳ τὸ παράπαν ἡδονὰς οὐ φασιν εἶναι. ΠΡΩ. τί μήν;

44c

S: They say that whatever Philebus here and his circle now call pleasures are all escapes from pains.

44c

PR: And do you recommend that we believe them? Or what do you suggest, Socrates?

44c

S: No. But we should make use of them, as if they were prophets prophesying without skill but with a certain harshness of nature which is not devoid of nobility. They have developed a strong hatred of the power of pleasure, and have come to regard it as unsound to such an extent that even its very attractiveness is beguilement, not pleasure. Now, you may make use of these doctrines on these issues once you have also given further consideration to their other harsh judgements. Then, after that, you will hear what pleasures seem to me to be true, so that having considered both arguments, we may come to a decision about the power of pleasure.

ΣΩ. λυπῶν ταύτας εἶναι πάσας ἀποφυγὰς, ἃς νῦν οἱ περὶ Φίληβον ἡδονὰς ἐπονομάζουσιν. ΠΡΩ. τούτοις οὖν ἡμᾶς πότερα πείθεσθαι συμβουλευεῖς, ἢ πῶς, ὃ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. οὐκ, ἀλλ' ὥσπερ μάντεσι προσχρῆσθαί τισι, μαντευομένοις οὐ τέχνη ἀλλὰ τινι δυσχερεῖα φύσεως οὐκ ἀγεννοῦς λίαν μεμισηκότων τὴν τῆς ἡδονῆς δύναμιν καὶ νενομικῶτων οὐδὲν ὑγίης, ὥστε καὶ αὐτὸ τοῦτο αὐτῆς τὸ ἐπαγωγὸν γοήτευμα,

44d

PR: That is a good suggestion.

44d

S: Well, let us follow them just as if they were allies, relying on the footprints of their harshness. For I believe they say something like this, beginning with a basic question. If we wished to discern the nature of any form at all, such as the nature of hardness, for instance, would we recognise it better by referring to the very hardest things or those with the most minute degrees of hardness? Now, Protarchus, you must reply to these harsh fellows just as you reply to me.

οὐχ ἡδονήν, εἶναι. τούτοις μὲν οὖν ταῦτα ἂν προσχρήσαιο, σκεψάμενος ἔτι καὶ τὰ ἄλλα αὐτῶν δυσχεράσματα· μετὰ δὲ ταῦτα αἱ γέ μοι δοκοῦσιν ἡδοναὶ ἀληθεῖς εἶναι πύσι, ἵνα ἐξ ἀμφοῖν τοῖν λόγοις σκεψάμενοι τὴν δύναμιν αὐτῆς παραθώμεθα πρὸς τὴν κρίσιν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς λέγεις. ΣΩ. μεταδιδώκωμεν δὴ τούτους, ὥσπερ συμμάχους, κατὰ τὸ τῆς δυσχερείας

αὐτῶν ἵχνος. οἶμαι γὰρ τοιόνδε τι λέγειν αὐτούς, ἀρχομένους ποθὲν ἄνωθεν, ὥς εἰ βουληθεῖμεν ὁτουοῦν

44e

PR: Yes, certainly. And I say to them that we should refer to the highest standard.

44e

S: Therefore, if we wish to discern the precise nature which belongs to the class of pleasure, we must not refer to minute degrees of pleasure, but to those regarded as most extreme and intense.

εἶδους τὴν φύσιν ἰδεῖν, οἶον τὴν τοῦ σκληροῦ, πότερον εἰς τὰ σκληρότατα ἀποβλέποντες οὕτως ἂν μᾶλλον συννοήσαιμεν ἢ πρὸς τὰ πολλοστὰ σκληρότητι; δεῖ δὴ σε, ὦ Πρώταρχε, καθάπερ ἐμοί, καὶ τούτοις τοῖς δυσχερέσιν ἀποκρίνεσθαι. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν, καὶ λέγω γε αὐτοῖς ὅτι πρὸς τὰ πρῶτα μεγέθει. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ καὶ τὸ τῆς ἡδονῆς γένος ἰδεῖν ἥντινά ποτ' ἔχει φύσιν βουληθεῖμεν, οὐκ εἰς τὰς πολλοστὰς ἡδονὰς

45a

PR: Everyone nowadays would agree with you on that point.

45a

S: Now, do we usually say that the commonest and, indeed, greatest pleasures are those associated with the body?

45a

PR: Yes, of course.

45a

S: Now, are the pleasures greater, and do they become greater, in the case of people suffering diseases or in the case of the healthy people? And let's be careful lest we trip ourselves up by answering in haste. Indeed, we might perhaps say that it is in the case of the healthy people.

ἀποβλεπτέον, ἀλλ' εἰς τὰς ἀκροτάτας καὶ σφοδροτάτας λεγομένας. ΠΡΩ. πᾶς ἂν σοι ταύτη συγχωροίῃ τὰ νῦν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν, αἱ πρόχειροί γε αἶπερ καὶ μέγιστα τῶν ἡδονῶν, ὃ λέγομεν πολλάκις, αἱ περὶ τὸ σῶμά εἰσιν

αὐται; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. πότερον οὖν καὶ μείζους εἰσὶ καὶ γίνονται
περὶ τοὺς κάμνοντας ἐν ταῖς νόσοις ἢ περὶ ὑγιαίνοντας; εὐλαβηθῶμεν
δὲ μὴ προπετῶς ἀποκρινόμενοι πταίσωμένῃ. τάχα γὰρ

45b

PR: Quite likely.

45b

S: What about this? Aren't the most overpowering of pleasures those which are preceded by the greatest desires?

45b

PR: Yes, that's true.

45b

S: But don't people with fever, and who have similar diseases, experience thirst and cold and everything else which they normally suffer through the body, to a greater extent? And as they are more acquainted with deprivation, won't they derive greater pleasure from the replenishment? Or shall we deny that this is true?

45b

PR: Well, now that you have said it, it certainly appears to be true.

ἴσως φαίμεν ἂν περὶ ὑγιαίνοντας. ΠΡΩ. εἰκός γε. ΣΩ. τί δ'; οὐχ αὐταὶ
τῶν ἡδονῶν ὑπερβάλλουσιν, ὧν ἂν καὶ ἐπιθυμίας μέγισται
προγίγνωνται; ΠΡΩ. τοῦτο μὲν ἀληθές. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐχ οἱ πυρέττοντες καὶ
ἐν τοιούτοις νοσήμασιν ἐχόμενοι μᾶλλον διψῶσι καὶ ριγοῦσι καὶ πάντα
ὀπόσα διὰ τοῦ σώματος εἰώθασιν πάσχειν, μᾶλλον τ' ἐνδεία
συγγίγνωνται καὶ ἀποπληρουμένων μείζους ἡδονὰς ἴσχουσιν; ἢ τοῦτο
οὐ φήσομεν ἀληθές εἶναι; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν νῦν ῥηθὲν φαίνεται.

45c

S: What about this? Are we actually right in saying that someone who wishes to see the pleasures that are greatest must turn his consideration not to health but to disease? And take care not to assume that my intention is to ask you if extremely sick people experience more pleasure than the healthy. No, assume that I am interested in the magnitude of pleasure and the occasions in which the extreme of such

magnitude arises. For we are saying that it is necessary to understand its nature and what those people mean when they state that pleasure does not have any being.

ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ὀρθῶς ἂν φαινοίμεθα λέγοντες ὥς εἴ τις τὰς μεγίστας ἡδονὰς ἰδεῖν βούλοιοτο, οὐκ εἰς ὑγίειαν ἀλλ' εἰς νόσον ἰόντας δεῖ σκοπεῖν; ὅρα δὲ μή με ἡγῇ διανοούμενον ἐρωτᾶν σε εἰ πλείω χαίρουσιν οἱ σφόδρα νοσοῦντες τῶν ὑγιαίνοντων, ἀλλ' οἷου μέγεθός με ζητεῖν ἡδονῆς, καὶ τὸ σφόδρα περὶ τοῦ τοιούτου ποῦ ποτε γίγνεται ἐκάστοτε. νοῆσαι γὰρ δεῖ φαμεν ἥντινα φύσιν ἔχει καὶ τίνα λέγουσιν οἱ φάσκοντες μὴδ' εἶναι τὸ παράπαν αὐτήν.

45d

PR: I am following your argument fairly well.

45d

S: And you will actually prove that quite soon, Protarchus, for you are going to answer a question. Can you recognise greater pleasures in a wanton life than in a sound-minded one? Now, I do not mean a greater number of pleasures, but a greater intensity and extent. Think about this, and answer me.

45d

PR: Yes, I understand what you are asking, and I see a significant distinction. The proverbial maxim, “Nothing in excess”, constantly restrains the sound-minded, and they are convinced by it. However, the intense pleasure possesses the uncontrolled and wanton people to the point of insanity, and renders them notorious.

ΠΡΩ. ἀλλὰ σχεδὸν ἔπομαι τῷ λόγῳ σου. ΣΩ. τάχα, ὦ Πρώταρχε, οὐχ ἦττον δείξεις. ἀποκρίναι γάρ· ἐν ὕβρει μείζους ἡδονάς—οὐ πλείους λέγω, τῷ σφόδρα δὲ καὶ τῷ μᾶλλον ὑπερεχούσας—ὀρᾶς ἢ ἐν τῷ σώφρονι βίῳ; λέγε δὲ προσέχων τὸν νοῦν. ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' ἔμαθον ὃ λέγεις, καὶ πολὺ τὸ διαφέρον ὀρῶ. τοὺς μὲν γὰρ σώφρονάς που καὶ ὁ παροιμιαζόμενος

45e

S: Very good. And if this is the case, it is obvious that the greatest pleasures, and indeed the greatest pains, arise from a certain degeneracy of soul and body, but not from their excellence.

45e

PR: Yes, certainly.

45e

S: Then we should select some of these pleasures, and consider what precise characteristic they possess which made us say they are the greatest.

ἐπίσχει λόγος ἐκάστοτε, ὁ τὸ μηδὲν ἄγαν παρακελευόμενος, ὥς πείθονται· τὸ δὲ τῶν ἀφρόνων τε καὶ ὑβριστῶν μέχρι μανίας ἢ σφοδρὰ ἡδονὴ κατέχουσα περιβοήτους ἀπεργάζεται. ΣΩ. καλῶς· καὶ εἴ γε τοῦθ' οὕτως ἔχει, δῆλον ὡς ἐν τινι πονηρίᾳ ψυχῆς καὶ τοῦ σώματος, ἀλλ' οὐκ ἐν ἀρετῇ μέγισται μὲν ἡδοναί, μέγισται δὲ καὶ λύπαι γίνονται. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τούτων τινὰς προελόμενον δεῖ σκοπεῖσθαι τίνα ποτὲ τρόπον ἐχούσας ἐλέγομεν αὐτὰς εἶναι μεγίστας.

46a

PR: We must.

46a

S: Then let us consider the pleasures associated with diseases of a certain sort, and what precise characteristic they possess.

46a

PR: Diseases of what sort?

46a

S: Of an unseemly sort, which the men we called harsh utterly detest.

46a

PR: Such as?

46a

S: Like the relief of an itch and other such ailments by scratching, as they require no other remedy. By the gods, whatever should we call this condition when it arises in us? Is it pleasure or pain?

46a

PR: Well, Socrates, it seems to constitute a mixture, something bad.

ΠΡΩ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. σκόπει δὴ τὰς τῶν τοιῶνδε νοσημάτων ἡδονάς, τίνα ποτὲ ἔχουσι τρόπον. ΠΡΩ. ποίων; ΣΩ. τὰς τῶν ἀσχημόνων, αἷς οὐς εἵπομεν δυσχερεῖς μισοῦσι παντελῶς. ΠΡΩ. ποίας; ΣΩ. οἷον τὰς τῆς ψώρας ἰάσεις τῷ τρίβειν καὶ ὅσα τοιαῦτα, οὐκ ἄλλης δεόμενα φαρμάξεως· τοῦτο γὰρ δὴ τὸ πάθος ἡμῖν, ὃ πρὸς θεῶν, τί ποτε φῶμεν ἐγγίγνεσθαι; πότερον ἡδονὴν ἢ λύπην; ΠΡΩ. σύμμεικτον τοῦτό γ' ἄρ', ὃ Σώκρατες, ἔοικε γίγνεσθαι τι κακόν.

46b

S: Now, I was not actually thinking of Philebus when I offered that example. Yet we would not really be able ever to come to a decision on the current issue, Protarchus, without reviewing these pleasures and those that follow them.

46b

PR: In that case, we should proceed to the pleasures which are related to these.

46b

S: You mean the pleasures which involve admixture?

46b

PR: Yes, certainly.

ΣΩ. οὐ μὲν δὴ Φιλήβου γε ἔνεκα παρεθέμην τὸν λόγον· ἀλλ' ἄνευ τούτων, ὃ Πρώταρχε, τῶν ἡδονῶν καὶ τῶν ταύταις ἐπομένων, ἂν μὴ κατοφθῶσι, σχεδὸν οὐκ ἂν ποτε δυναίμεθα διακρίνασθαι τὸ νῦν ζητούμενον. ΠΡΩ. οὐκοῦν ἰτέον ἐπὶ τὰς τούτων συγγενεῖς. ΣΩ. τὰς ἐν τῇ μείξει κοινωνούσας λέγεις; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. εἰσὶ τοίνυν μείξεις αἱ μὲν κατὰ τὸ σῶμα ἐν αὐτοῖς

46c

S: Well there are mixtures which are physical, residing in the bodies themselves, while others belong to the soul itself, and are in the soul. Then again, we shall find pains of the body and of the soul which are mixed with pleasures, and the combinations are sometimes called pleasures and sometimes pains.

46c

PR: How so?

46c

S: Whenever a condition is being established or is abating, and the person experiences the opposite effects and is warmed as he is cooling down or cooled whilst warming up, I believe he will try to attain the one condition and be free of the other; while if this so-called bittersweet mixture is persistent, it produces irritation and leads on to a violent state.

τοῖς σώμασιν, αἱ δ' αὐτῆς τῆς ψυχῆς ἐν τῇ ψυχῇ τὰς δ' αὖ τῆς ψυχῆς καὶ τοῦ σώματος ἀνευρήσομεν λύπας ἡδοναῖς μειχθείσας τοτὲ μὲν ἡδονὰς τὰ συναμφοτέρα, τοτὲ δὲ λύπας ἐπικαλουμένας. ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. ὁπόταν ἐν τῇ καταστάσει τις ἢ τῇ διαφθορᾷ τάναντία ἅμα πάθη πάσχη, ποτὲ ῥιγῶν θέρηται καὶ θερμαινόμενος ἐνίοτε ψύχεται, ζητῶν οἶμαι τὸ μὲν ἔχειν, τοῦ δὲ ἀπαλλάττεσθαι, τὸ δὲ λεγόμενον πικρῷ γλυκὺ μεμειγμένον, μετὰ

46d

PR: Yes, what you say is very true.

46d

S: Don't these mixtures sometimes have a balance of pleasure and pain, and sometimes more of one than the other?

46d

PR: Yes, they must.

46d

S: Now, say that more pain than pleasure arises in the case of a tickle or the itch we just mentioned. When the seething and inflammation is internal, and one does not reach it by scratching and rubbing, only the superficial symptom is dissipated. In such circumstances, the application of fire to the external parts changes the pain to the opposite place by means of the externally applied heat, and sometimes produces enormous pleasure. At other times, however, the opposition of internal to external combines pleasure with pain, either of which may be dominant. The outcome is a violent dispersal of what has been

accumulated, and an aggregation of what has been dispersed, yielding pleasure and pain alike.

δυσάπαλλακτίας παρόν, ἀγανάκτησιν καὶ ὕστερον σύντασιν ἀγρίαν ποιεῖ. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα ἀληθὲς τὸ νῦν λεγόμενον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν αἱ τοιαῦται μείξεις αἱ μὲν ἐξ ἴσων εἰσὶ λυπῶν τε καὶ ἡδονῶν, αἱ δ' ἐκ τῶν ἐτέρων πλειόνων; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. λέγε δὴ τὰς μέν, ὅταν πλείους λῦπαι τῶν ἡδονῶν γίνωνται—τὰς τῆς ψώρας λεγομένης νυνδὴ ταύτας εἶναι καὶ τὰς τῶν γαργαλισμῶν—ὁπόταν ἐν τοῖς ἐντὸς τὸ ζέον ἦ καὶ τὸ φλεγμαῖνον, τῇ τρίψει δὲ καὶ τῇ κνήσει μὴ ἐφικνῇταί τις, τὸ δ' ἐπιπολῆς μόνον διαχέῃ, τοτὲ φέροντες εἰς πῦρ αὐτὰ καὶ εἰς τοῦναντίον πυρίαις μεταβάλλοντες ἐνίστε ἀμηχάνους ἡδονάς, τοτὲ δὲ τοῦναντίον τοῖς ἐντὸς πρὸς τὰ τῶν ἔξω, λύπας ἡδοναῖς συγκερασθείσας, εἰς ὅποτερ' ἂν ῥέψῃ, παρέσχοντο τῷ τὰ συγκεκριμένα βίᾳ διαχεῖν ἢ τὰ διακεκριμένα συγχεῖν

47a

PR: Very true.

47a

S: When more pleasure is included in such mixtures, the reduced admixture of pain causes tickling and a mild irritation, while a much greater influx of pleasure for its part brings tension, and sometimes makes the heart jump. Producing all sorts of complexions, and a variety of physical distortions and irregularities of breath, it induces complete insanity and mindless ranting.

—καὶ ὁμοῦ λύπας ἡδοναῖς παρατιθέναι. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὁπόταν αὖ πλείων ἡδονὴ κατὰ τὰ τοιαῦτα πάντα συμμειχθῇ, τὸ μὲν ὑπομειγμένον τῆς λύπης γαργαλίζει τε καὶ ἡρέμα ἀγανακτεῖν ποιεῖ, τὸ δ' αὖ τῆς ἡδονῆς πολὺ πλεον ἐγκεχυμένον συντείνει τε καὶ ἐνίστε πηδᾶν ποιεῖ, καὶ παντοῖα μὲν χρώματα, παντοῖα δὲ σχήματα, παντοῖα δὲ πνεύματα ἀπεργαζόμενον πᾶσαν ἔκπληξιν καὶ βοὰς μετὰ ἀφροσύνης ἐνεργάζεται;

47b

PR: That's exactly what happens.

47b

S: Yes, my friend, and this condition makes others and the man himself say that he is almost dying of enjoyment of these pleasures. Indeed, the more intemperate and mindless he becomes, the more comprehensively does he pursue them. And he actually calls these the greatest pleasures, and he accounts the man who lives as much as possible in their enjoyment the happiest of all.

47b

PR: Socrates, you have described adequately the entire predicament of most of humanity.

ΠΡΩ. μάλα γε. ΣΩ. καὶ λέγειν τε, ὃ ἑταῖρε, αὐτόν τε περὶ ἑαυτοῦ ποιεῖ καὶ ἄλλον ὥς ταύταις ταῖς ἡδοναῖς τερπόμενος οἷον ἀποθνήσκει καὶ ταύτας γε δὴ παντάπασιν ἀεὶ μεταδιώκει τοσοῦτω μᾶλλον ὅσω ἂν ἀκολαστότερός τε καὶ ἀφρονέστερος ὢν τυγχάνῃ, καὶ καλεῖ δὴ μεγίστας ταύτας, καὶ τὸν ἐν αὐταῖς ὅτι μάλιστ' ἀεὶ ζῶντα εὐδαιμονέστατον καταριθμεῖται. ΠΡΩ. πάντα, ὃ Σώκρατες, τὰ συμβαίνοντα πρὸς τῶν πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων εἰς δόξαν διεπέραντας.

47c

S: Yes, at least in relation to the pleasures from the common experiences of the body itself when internal and external are combined. However, when the soul's contribution is the opposite of the body's, pain is concurrent with pleasure or pleasure with pain, and the pair constitutes a single combination. We described these situations earlier, that when the body is depleted the soul desires satisfaction, and is pleased by the expectation but pained by being depleted. But, at the time, we did not explain this aspect. But now we are stating that in all these countless diverse experiences, where soul is at odds with body, a single mixture of both pain and pleasure is the result.

ΣΩ. περί γε τῶν ἡδονῶν, ὃ Πρώταρχε, τῶν ἐν τοῖς κοινοῖς παθήμασιν αὐτοῦ τοῦ σώματος τῶν ἐπιπολῆς τε καὶ ἐντὸς κερασθέντων· περὶ δέ γ' ὧν ψυχὴ σώματι τάναντία συμβάλλεται, λύπην τε ἅμα πρὸς ἡδονὴν καὶ ἡδονὴν πρὸς λύπην, ὥστ' εἰς μίαν ἀμφοτέρα κρᾶσιν ἵέναι, ταῦτα

ἔμπροσθε μὲν διήλθομεν, ὥς, ὁπόταν αὐτὸ κενῶται, πληρώσεως ἐπιθυμεῖ, καὶ ἐλπίζων μὲν χαίρει, κενούμενος δὲ ἀλγεῖ, ταῦτα δὲ τότε

47d

PR: I suspect you are absolutely right.

47d

S: But there is one of the mixtures of pleasure and pain still left.

47d

PR: Will you tell me what it is?

47d

S: A combination, which we said the soul often acquires by itself.

47d

PR: Yes, but what do we actually mean by this?

μὲν οὐκ ἔμαρτυράμεθα, νῦν δὲ λέγομεν ὥς ψυχῆς πρὸς σῶμα διαφορομένης ἐν πᾶσι τούτοις πλήθει ἀμηχάνοις οὔσι μεῖζις μία λύπης τε καὶ ἡδονῆς συμπίπτει γενομένη. ΠΡΩ. κινδυνεύεις ὀρθότατα λέγειν. ΣΩ. ἔτι τοίνυν ἡμῖν τῶν μείξεων λύπης τε καὶ ἡδονῆς λοιπὴ μία. ΠΡΩ. ποία, φῆς; ΣΩ. ἦν αὐτὴν τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτῇ πολλάκις λαμβάνειν σύγκρασιν ἔφαμεν. ΠΡΩ. πῶς οὖν δὴ τοῦτ' αὐτὸ λέγομεν;

47e

S: Don't you include anger, fear, longing, sadness, love, ambition, envy, and the like, among the pains of the soul itself?

47e

PR: Yes, I do.

47e

S: Won't we find them full of extraordinary pleasures, or need we be reminded about desire and anger?

*Wrath that spurs on the wisest man to rage
Sweeter by far than stream of flowing honey.*³

And of the pleasures which are mixed with the pains, in the case of sadness and longing?

ΣΩ. ὀργὴν καὶ φόβον καὶ πόθον καὶ θρήνον καὶ ἔρωτα καὶ ζῆλον καὶ φθόνον καὶ ὅσα τοιαῦτα, ἅρ' οὐκ αὐτῆς τῆς ψυχῆς τίθεται ταύτας λύπας τινάς; ΠΡΩ. ἔγωγε. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν αὐτὰς ἡδονῶν μεστὰς εὐρήσομεν ἀμηχάνων; ἢ δεόμεθα ὑπομιμνήσκεσθαι τὸ ἐν τοῖς θυμοῖς καὶ ταῖς ὀργαῖς, τὸ ὅς τ' ἐφέηκε πολύφρονά περ χαλεπῆναι ὅς τε πολὺ γλυκίων μέλιτος καταλειβομένοιο,

48a

PR: No, this is what happens in these cases.

48a

S: Remember too that the audiences at tragedies are experiencing pleasure and are weeping at the same time.

48a

PR: Of course.

48a

S: And do you realise that the condition of our souls at a comedy would also involve a mixture of pleasure and pain?

48a

PR: I don't really understand.

καὶ τὰς ἐν τοῖς θρήνοις καὶ πόθοις ἡδονὰς ἐν λύπαις οὔσας ἀναμειγμένας; ΠΡΩ. οὐκ, ἀλλ' οὕτω ταῦτά γε καὶ οὐκ ἄλλως ἂν συμβαίνοι γιγνόμενα. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ τὰς γε τραγικὰς θεωρήσεις, ὅταν ἅμα χαίροντες κλάωσι, μέμνησαι; ΠΡΩ. τί δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. τὴν δ' ἐν ταῖς κωμωδίαις διάθεσιν ἡμῶν τῆς ψυχῆς, ἅρ' οἶσθ' ὥς ἔστι κὰν τούτοις μεῖζις λύπης τε καὶ ἡδονῆς; ΠΡΩ. οὐ πάνυ κατανοῶ.

48b

S: Indeed, Protarchus, it is not at all easy to recognise this sort of experience in that situation.

48b

PR: It doesn't seem easy for me, anyway.

48b

S: All the more reason to take this example as it is more obscure and will enable us to appreciate this mixing of pleasure and pain more

easily in other instances.

48b

PR: Please explain.

48b

S: Would you count envy, which we mentioned just now, as a pain of the soul or not?

48b

PR: I would.

48b

S: And, indeed, an envious person will be manifestly pleased by the misfortunes of his neighbours.

48b

PR: Very much so.

ΣΩ. παντάπασι γὰρ οὐ ῥάδιον, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἐν τούτῳ συννοεῖν τὸ τοιοῦτον ἐκάστοτε πάθος. ΠΡΩ. οὐκ οὖν ὥς γ' ἔοικεν ἐμοί. ΣΩ. λάβωμέν γε μὴν αὐτὸ τοσούτῳ μᾶλλον ὅσῳ σκοτεινότερόν ἐστιν, ἵνα καὶ ἐν ἄλλοις ῥᾶον καταμαθεῖν τις οἶός τ' ἢ μεῖζιν λύπης τε καὶ ἡδονῆς. ΠΡΩ. λέγοις ἄν. ΣΩ. τό τοι νυνδὴ ῥηθὲν ὄνομα φθόνου πότερα λύπην τινὰ ψυχῆς θήσεις, ἢ πῶς; ΠΡΩ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν ὁ φθονῶν γε ἐπὶ κακοῖς τοῖς τῶν πέλας ἡδόμενος ἀναφανήσεται.

48c

S: Now, ignorance is a misfortune which constitutes what we call a stupid disposition.

48c

PR: Of course.

48c

S: Well, on this basis, behold what the nature of the comical is.

48c

PR: Please explain.

48c

S: It is, in short, a degeneracy named after a particular disposition. And what's more, this degeneracy, more than any other, has characteristics

opposed to what is enjoined by the Delphic inscription.

48c

PR: Do you mean ‘Know Thyself’, Socrates?

ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. κακὸν μὴν ἄγνοια καὶ ἦν δὴ λέγομεν ἀβελτέραν ἔξιν. ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. ἐκ δὴ τούτων ἰδὲ τὸ γελοῖον ἦντινα φύσιν ἔχει. ΠΡΩ. λέγε μόνον. ΣΩ. ἔστιν δὴ πονηρία μὲν τις τὸ κεφάλαιον, ἔξεώς τινος ἐπίκλην λεγομένη· τῆς δ’ αὖ πάσης πονηρίας ἐστὶ τοῦναντίον πάθος ἔχον ἢ τὸ λεγόμενον ὑπὸ τῶν ἐν Δελφοῖς γραμμάτων. ΠΡΩ. τὸ γνῶθι σαυτὸν λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες;

48d

S: I do. And the opposite of this would obviously be not to know yourself at all, as enjoined by the inscription.

48d

PR: Of course.

48d

S: Now, Protarchus, try to make a threefold division of this.

48d

PR: In what way? I am unable to do this.

48d

S: Are you saying that I have to make this division now?

48d

PR: I am saying so. And what’s more, I am asking you to do this.

48d

S: Mustn’t anyone who does not know himself experience this condition in one of three ways?

48d

PR: How so?

ΣΩ. ἔγωγε. τοῦναντίον μὴν ἐκείνω δῆλον ὅτι τὸ μηδαμῇ γιγνώσκειν αὐτὸν λεγόμενον ὑπὸ τοῦ γράμματος ἂν εἴη. ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. ὦ Πρώταρχε, πειρῶ δὲ αὐτὸ τοῦτο τριχῇ τέμνειν. ΠΡΩ. πῇ φής; οὐ γὰρ μὴ δυνατὸς ὦ. ΣΩ. λέγεις δὴ δεῖν ἐμὲ τοῦτο διελέσθαι τὰ νῦν; ΠΡΩ. λέγω,

καὶ δέομαί γε πρὸς τῷ λέγειν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ τῶν ἀγνοούντων αὐτοὺς κατὰ τρία ἀνάγκη τοῦτο τὸ πάθος πάσχειν ἕκαστον; ΠΡΩ. πῶς;

48e

S: Well, the first is financial, when they think they are wealthier than they actually are.

48e

PR: Yes, there are many people in that sort of situation.

48e

S: But there are even more who believe that they are greater and fairer, and superior in all such physical qualities, than in truth they are.

48e

PR: Very much so.

48e

S: But I think the greatest number by far have made a serious error about the third form, at the level of soul, by thinking themselves superior in excellence when they are not.

48e

PR: Most definitely. ----- 3 Iliad xviii.108-109, Hackforth.

ΣΩ. πρῶτον μὲν κατὰ χρήματα, δοξάζειν εἶναι πλουσιώτερον ἢ κατὰ τὴν αὐτῶν οὐσίαν. ΠΡΩ. πολλοὶ γοῦν εἰσὶν τὸ τοιοῦτον πάθος ἔχοντες. ΣΩ. πλείους δέ γε οἱ μείζους καὶ καλλίους αὐτοὺς δοξάζουσι, καὶ πάντα ὅσα κατὰ τὸ σῶμα εἶναι διαφερόντως τῆς οὐσης αὐτοῖς ἀληθείας. ΠΡΩ. πάννυ γε. ΣΩ. πολὺ δὲ πλεῖστοί γε οἶμαι περὶ τὸ τρίτον εἶδος τὸ τῶν ἐν ταῖς ψυχαῖς διημαρτήκασιν, ἀρετῇ δοξάζοντες βελτίους ἑαυτούς, οὐκ ὄντες. ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα μὲν οὖν.

49a

S: And when it comes to excellence, don't most people lay unreserved claim to wisdom, being full of contentiousness and false imagined wisdom?

49a

PR: Certainly.

49a

S: And, indeed, it would be right to refer to every such condition as bad.

49a

PR: Definitely.

49a

S: Then we must make a further twofold division, Protarchus, if we are to appreciate this strange mixture of pleasure and pain which we discern in playful envy. “How do we make the twofold split?” you may ask. All those, who unreasonably hold this false opinion about themselves, really must be categorised just like all other human beings – some are strong and powerful, while others are in the opposite case.

ΣΩ. τῶν ἀρετῶν δ' ἄρ' οὐ σοφίας περί τὸ πλῆθος πάντως ἀντεχόμενον μεστὸν ἐρίδων καὶ δοξοσοφίας ἐστὶ ψευδοῦς; ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. κακὸν μὲν δὴ πᾶν ἂν τις τὸ τοιοῦτον εἰπὼν ὀρθῶς ἂν εἴποι πάθος. ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. τοῦτο τοίνυν ἔτι διαιρετέον, ὃ Πρώταρχε, δίχα, εἰ μέλλομεν τὸν παιδικὸν ἰδόντες φθόνον ἄτοπον ἡδονῆς καὶ λύπης ὀφείσθαι μεῖζιν. πῶς οὖν τέμνομεν δίχα, λέγεις;

49b

PR: They must.

49b

S: Then divide them like that. And you may, in truth, refer to those among them as comical who are unable to retaliate when they are laughed at, due to their weakness, while you will provide yourself with the most accurate description of those who are able to retaliate, by referring to them as powerful, frightening and hostile. Indeed, in the case of powerful men, ignorance is hostile and base for it is harmful to anyone close at hand, whether in fictional representations or in actuality. However, in the case of the weak, ignorance has been allotted the nature and status of comedy.

πάντες ὅποσοι ταύτην τὴν ψευδῇ δόξαν περὶ ἑαυτῶν ἀνοήτως δοξάζουσι, καθάπερ ἀπάντων ἀνθρώπων, καὶ τούτων ἀναγκαιότατον

ἔπεσθαι τοῖς μὲν ῥώμην αὐτῶν καὶ δύναμιν, τοῖς δὲ οἶμαι τούναντίον. ΠΡΩ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. ταύτη τοίνυν δίελε, καὶ ὅσοι μὲν αὐτῶν εἰσι μετ' ἀσθενείας τοιοῦτοι καὶ ἀδύνατοι καταγελῶμενοι τιμωρεῖσθαι, γελοίους τούτους φάσκων εἶναι τάληθ' ἠφθέρῃ· τοὺς δὲ δυνατοὺς τιμωρεῖσθαι καὶ ἰσχυροὺς φοβεροὺς καὶ ἔχθροὺς

49c

PR: What you say is absolutely correct, but the admixture of pleasure and pain in these cases is not yet obvious to me.

49c

S: Well, first take the power of envy.

49c

PR: Please explain.

προσαγορεύων ὀρθότατον τούτων σαυτῷ λόγον ἀποδώσεις. ἄγνοια γὰρ ἢ μὲν τῶν ἰσχυρῶν ἐχθρά τε καὶ αἰσχροί— βλαβερὰ γὰρ καὶ τοῖς πέλας αὐτῇ τε καὶ ὅσαι εἰκόνες αὐτῆς εἰσιν—ἢ δ' ἀσθενῆς ἡμῖν τὴν τῶν γελοίων εἴληχε τάξιν τε καὶ φύσιν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα λέγεις. ἀλλὰ γὰρ ἢ τῶν ἡδονῶν καὶ λυπῶν μεῖζις ἐν τούτοις οὕτω μοι καταφανής. ΣΩ. τὴν τοίνυν τοῦ φθόνου λαβὴν δύναμιν πρῶτον. ΠΡΩ. λέγε μόνον.

49d

S: Is it somehow an unjust pain and also a pleasure?

49d

PR: Yes, it must be.

49d

S: Now, delight in the misfortunes of enemies is neither injustice nor envy, is it?

49d

PR: Of course not.

49d

S: But is it just to be pleased, rather than pained, if you ever see the misfortunes of your friends?

49d

PR: No, how could it be?

49d

S: And didn't we say that ignorance is a misfortune for everyone?

49d

PR: Correct.

49d

S: Now, take the imagined wisdom of friends, or their imagined beauty, and any other fancies described just now, saying there were three forms which were comical in the case of the weak, but detestable in the case of the strong. Shouldn't we repeat what we said earlier, that this condition is comical when it is evidenced by one of our friends, and is harmless to others?

ΣΩ. λύπη τις ἄδικός ἐστί που καὶ ἡδονή; ΠΡΩ. τοῦτο μὲν ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἐπὶ μὲν τοῖς τῶν ἐχθρῶν κακοῖς οὐτ' ἄδικον οὔτε φθονερὸν ἐστί τὸ χαίρειν; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; ΣΩ. τὰ δέ γε τῶν φίλων ὀρῶντας ἔστιν ὅτε κακὰ μὴ λυπεῖσθαι, χαίρειν δέ, ἄρα οὐκ ἄδικόν ἐστιν; ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ' οὔ; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὴν ἄγνοιαν εἶπομεν ὅτι κακὸν πᾶσιν; ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΣΩ. τὴν οὖν τῶν φίλων δοξοσοφίαν καὶ δοξοκαλίαν καὶ

49e

PR: Yes, certainly.

49e

S: But do we not agree that this is bad since it is ignorance?

49e

PR: Definitely.

49e

S: But are we pleased or pained whenever we are amused by it?

ὅσα νυνδὴ διήλθομεν, ἐν τρισὶν λέγοντες εἶδειςιν γίγνεσθαι, γελοῖα μὲν ὅποσα ἀσθενῇ, μισητὰ δ' ὅποσα ἐρρωμένα, φῶμεν ἢ μὴ φῶμεν ὅπερ εἶπον ἄρτι, τὴν τῶν φίλων ἔξιν ταύτην ὅταν ἔχη τις τὴν ἀβλαβῇ τοῖς ἄλλοις, γελοῖαν εἶναι; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. κακὸν δ' οὐχ ὁμολογοῦμεν αὐτὴν ἄγνοιάν γε οὔσαν εἶναι; ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. χαίρομεν δὲ ἢ λυπούμεθα, ὅταν ἐπ' αὐτῇ γελῶμεν;

50a

PR: Obviously we are pleased.

50a

S: And did we not say that envy is what produces this pleasure at the misfortunes of friends?

50a

PR: It must be.

50a

S: So, the argument states that when we are amused at the ridiculousness of friends, by mixing pleasure with envy, we are combining pleasure with pain. For we agreed some time ago that envy was a pain of the soul, but amusement was a pleasure, yet both arise at the same time in such situations as these.

50a

PR: True.

ΠΡΩ. δῆλον ὅτι χαίρομεν. ΣΩ. ἡδονὴν δὲ ἐπὶ τοῖς τῶν φίλων κακοῖς, οὐ φθόνον ἔφαμεν εἶναι τὸν τοῦτ' ἀπεργαζόμενον; ΠΡΩ. ἀνάγκη. ΣΩ. γελῶντας ἄρα ἡμᾶς ἐπὶ τοῖς τῶν φίλων γελοίοις φησὶν ὁ λόγος, κεραννύντας ἡδονὴν αὖ φθόνῳ, λύπη τὴν ἡδονὴν συγκεραννύναι· τὸν γὰρ φθόνον ὡμολογῆσθαι λύπην ψυχῆς ἡμῖν πάλαι, τὸ δὲ γελᾶν ἡδονὴν, ἅμα γίγνεσθαι δὲ τούτῳ ἐν τούτοις τοῖς χρόνοις. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθῆ.

50b

S: Indeed, our current argument indicates that in laments, tragedies and comedies, not only on stage but in the entire tragedy and comedy of life, pains and pleasures are also mixed together on countless occasions.

50b

PR: It is impossible to disagree with that, Socrates, even if someone had a great passion for winning arguments against opponents.

ΣΩ. μηνύει δὴ νῦν ὁ λόγος ἡμῖν ἐν θρήνοις τε καὶ ἐν τραγωδίαις καὶ κωμωδίαις, μὴ τοῖς δράμασι μόνον ἀλλὰ καὶ τῇ τοῦ βίου συμπᾶσῃ τραγωδίᾳ καὶ κωμωδίᾳ, λύπας ἡδοναῖς ἅμα κεράννυσθαι, καὶ ἐν ἄλλοις δὴ μυρίοις. ΠΡΩ. ἀδύνατον μὴ ὁμολογεῖν ταῦτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰ καὶ τις

φιλονικοῖ πάνυ πρὸς τάναντία. ΣΩ. ὀργὴν μὴν καὶ πόθον καὶ θρῆνον καὶ φόβον καὶ

50c

S: Indeed, we proposed anger, longing, sadness, fear, love, ambition and envy, and the like, as cases where we shall encounter these mixtures which we keep referring to now. Is this so?

50c

PR: Yes.

50c

S: Now, do we appreciate that everything we have just concluded applies to sadness, envy and anger?

50c

PR: Yes, how could we fail to appreciate that?

50c

S: So, are there many cases still left?

50c

PR: Yes, very many.

50c

S: Well, why exactly do you think I showed you this admixture in the case of comedy? Wasn't I trying to persuade you that the mixing is easier to demonstrate in fear and love, and those other instances? I was hoping that once you had accepted this for yourself, you would release me from the obligation to make the discussion even longer by dealing with the other cases. I thought you would simply accept that the experiences of body without soul, soul without body, or their communion with one another are full of pleasure combined with pain. So, tell me now whether you will release me or keep us here till midnight. I think you are going to release me if I say a little more. Indeed, I am prepared to give you an account of all the instances tomorrow, but now I want to turn to the remaining matters involved in deciding the issue raised by Philebus.

ἔρωτα καὶ ζῆλον καὶ φθόνον προυθέμεθα καὶ ὅποσα τοιαῦτα, ἐν οἷς ἔφαμεν εὐρήσειν μειγνύμενα τὰ νῦν πολλάκις λεγόμενα. ἦ γάρ; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. μανθάνομεν οὖν ὅτι θρήνου πέρι καὶ φθόνου καὶ ὀργῆς πάντα ἐστὶ τὰ νυνδὴ διαπερανθέντα; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ μανθάνομεν; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν πολλὰ ἔτι τὰ λοιπά; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. διὰ δὴ τί μάλισθ' ὑπολαμβάνεις με δεῖξαι σοι τὴν ἐν τῇ κωμῳδίᾳ μεῖζιν; ἄρ' οὐ πίστεως χάριν, ὅτι τὴν γε ἐν τοῖς φόβοις καὶ ἔρωσι καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ῥάδιον κρᾶσιν ἐπιδείξαι· λαβόντα δὲ τοῦτο παρὰ σαυτῷ ἀφεῖναι με μηκέτι ἐπ' ἐκεῖνα ἰόντα δεῖν μηκύνειν τοὺς λόγους, ἀλλ' ἀπλῶς λαβεῖν τοῦτο, ὅτι καὶ σῶμα ἄνευ ψυχῆς καὶ ψυχὴ ἄνευ σώματος καὶ κοινῇ μετ' ἀλλήλων ἐν τοῖς παθήμασι μεστά ἐστὶ συγκεκραμένης ἡδονῆς λύπαις; νῦν οὖν λέγε πότερα ἀφίης με ἢ μέσας ποιήσεις νύκτας; εἰπὼν δὲ σμικρὰ οἶμαι σου τεύξεσθαι μεθεῖναι με· τούτων γὰρ ἀπάντων αὔριον

50e

PR: Well said, Socrates. Work through the remaining matters in any way you please.

50e

S: It is natural then to move on to the unmixed pleasures in turn after the mixed ones. In fact it is essential, and there is some need to do so.

ἐθελήσω σοι λόγον δοῦναι, τὰ νῦν δὲ ἐπὶ τὰ λοιπὰ βούλομαι στέλλεσθαι πρὸς τὴν κρίσιν ἣν Φίληβος ἐπιτάττει. ΠΡΩ. καλῶς εἶπες, ὦ Σώκρατες· ἀλλ' ὅσα λοιπὰ ἡμῖν διέξελθε ὅπῃ σοι φίλον. ΣΩ. κατὰ φύσιν τοίνυν μετὰ τὰς μειχθείσας ἡδονὰς ὑπὸ δὴ τινος ἀνάγκης ἐπὶ τὰς ἀμείκτους πορευοίμεθ' ἂν ἐν τῷ μέρει.

51a

PR: Excellent.

51a

S: Then, I shall turn to these and try to point them out to us. For some reason I am not entirely persuaded by those who assert that all pleasures are the cessation of pain, but, as I said, they do bear witness to the fact that some pleasures are imagined and not genuine at all. Others give the appearance of being numerous and extensive, but in

fact they are compounded with pains and with the cessation of extreme suffering involved in distress of both body and soul.

ΠΡΩ. κάλλιστ' εἶπες. ΣΩ. ἐγὼ δὴ πειράσομαι μεταβαλὼν σημαίνειν ἡμῖν αὐτάς. τοῖς γὰρ φάσκουσι λυπῶν εἶναι παῦλαν πάσας τὰς ἡδονὰς οὐ πάνυ πως πείθομαι, ἀλλ' ὅπερ εἶπον, μάρτυσι καταχρῶμαι πρὸς τὸ τινὰς ἡδονὰς εἶναι δοκούσας, οὔσας δ' οὐδαμῶς, καὶ μεγάλας ἑτέρας τινὰς ἅμα καὶ πολλὰς φαντασθείσας, εἶναι δ' αὐτάς συμπεφυρμένας ὁμοῦ λύπαις τε καὶ ἀναπαύσεσιν ὁδυνῶν τῶν μεγίστων περὶ τε σώματος καὶ ψυχῆς ἀπορίας.

51b

PR: But Socrates, which pleasures may properly be regarded as true?

51b

S: Those which involve colours which we call beautiful; also shapes, most smells, pleasant sounds, and any pleasures where the deficiency is painless and unnoticed, while the replenishment they provide is perceptible, pleasant and devoid of pain.

51b

PR: Socrates, how do these examples relate to what we are discussing?

ΠΡΩ. ἀληθεῖς δ' αὖ τίνες, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὑπολαμβάνων ὀρθῶς τις διανοοῖτ' ἄν; ΣΩ. τὰς περὶ τε τὰ καλὰ λεγόμενα χρώματα καὶ περὶ τὰ σχήματα καὶ τῶν ὁσμῶν τὰς πλείστας καὶ τὰς τῶν φθόγγων καὶ ὅσα τὰς ἐνδείας ἀναισθήτους ἔχοντα καὶ ἀλύπους τὰς πληρώσεις αἰσθητὰς καὶ ἡδεῖας καθαρὰς λυπῶν παραδίδωσιν. ΠΡΩ. πῶς δὴ ταῦτα, ὦ Σώκρατες, αὖ λέγομεν οὕτω; ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν οὐκ εὐθὺς δηλὰ ἐστὶν ἃ λέγω, πειρατέον

51c

S: Well, the point I am making is certainly not immediately obvious, so I should try to clarify it. Indeed, I am not now trying to discuss the beauty of the shapes which most people may understand, belonging either to living beings or drawings of them. No. What I mean, says the argument, is something straight or round, and the flat or solid shapes produced from these by means of the lathe, ruler and set square, if you

understand me. For I mean that these are not beautiful relative to something else, as other objects are. Instead, they are always naturally beautiful by themselves, and they possess certain intrinsic pleasures which bear no comparison with the pleasures of scratching. Now, colours also possess this type of beauty and pleasure. Do you follow? What do you say?

μὴν δηλοῦν. σχημάτων τε γὰρ κάλλος οὐχ ὅπερ ἂν ὑπολάβοιεν οἱ πολλοὶ πειρῶμαι νῦν λέγειν, ἢ ζώων ἢ τινων ζωγραφημάτων, ἀλλ' εὐθύ τι λέγω, φησὶν ὁ λόγος, καὶ περιφερὲς καὶ ἀπὸ τούτων δὴ τά τε τοῖς τόρνοις γιγνόμενα ἐπίπεδά τε καὶ στερεὰ καὶ τὰ τοῖς κανόσι καὶ γωνίαις, εἴ μου μανθάνεις. ταῦτα γὰρ οὐκ εἶναι πρὸς τι καλὰ λέγω, καθάπερ ἄλλα, ἀλλ' αἰεὶ καλὰ καθ' αὐτὰ πεφυκέναι καὶ τινας

51d

PR: Well, I am trying, Socrates. So you should also try to explain this a bit more clearly.

51d

S: Yes. I mean that sounds which are smooth and clear and send out a single pure note are not beautiful relative to something else, but are beautiful just by themselves, and the pleasures which follow are natural to them.

51d

PR: Yes, this is also the case.

ἡδονὰς οἰκείας ἔχειν, οὐδὲν ταῖς τῶν κινήσεων προσφερεῖς· καὶ χρώματα δὴ τοῦτον τὸν τύπον ἔχοντα καλὰ καὶ ἡδονὰς ἀλλ' ἄρα μανθάνομεν, ἢ πῶς; ΠΡΩ. πειρῶμαι μὲν, ὦ Σώκρατες· πειράσθῃτι δὲ καὶ σὺ σαφέστερον ἔτι λέγειν. ΣΩ. λέγω δὴ ἡχὰς τῶν φθόγγων τὰς λείας καὶ λαμπράς, τὰς ἔν τι καθαρὸν εἰσας μέλος, οὐ πρὸς ἕτερον καλὰς ἀλλ' αὐτὰς καθ' αὐτὰς εἶναι, καὶ τούτων συμφύτους ἡδονὰς ἐπομένας. ΠΡΩ. ἔστι γὰρ οὗν καὶ τοῦτο.

51e

S: But the class of pleasures based upon scents is less divine than that of sounds. Yet, because they do not have pain inevitably mixed in with

them, and due to their location and the way that they arise in us, I regard them as a total counterpart to the previous pleasures. Then, if you can follow, these are two forms of the pleasures we are discussing.

51e

PR: I follow.

ΣΩ. τὸ δὲ περὶ τὰς ὁσμάς ἤττον μὲν τούτων θεῖον γένος ἡδονῶν τὸ δὲ μὴ συμμεμεῖχθαι ἐν αὐταῖς ἀναγκαίους λύπας, καὶ ὅπη τοῦτο καὶ ἐν ὧ τῳ τυγχάνει γεγονὸς ἡμῖν, τοῦτ' ἐκείνοις τίθημι ἀντίστροφον ἅπαν. ἀλλ', εἰ κατανοεῖς, ταῦτα εἶδη δύο ὧν λέγομεν ἡδονῶν. ΠΡΩ. κατανοῶ. ΣΩ. ἔτι δὴ τοίνυν τούτοις προσθῶμεν τὰς περὶ τὰ

52a

S: Well then, we should also include the pleasures associated with learning among these if they seem to us not to involve a longing for learning, and no pains owe their origin to such longing.

52a

PR: Well, I agree with that.

52a

S: What about this? If someone who has been filled with knowledge loses it later through forgetfulness, can you envisage any pain at the loss?

μαθήματα ἡδονάς, εἰ ἄρα δοκοῦσιν ἡμῖν αὐταὶ πείνας μὲν μὴ ἔχειν τοῦ μανθάνειν μηδὲ διὰ μαθημάτων πείνην ἀλγηδónας ἐξ ἀρχῆς γιγνομένης. ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' οὕτω συνδοκεῖ. ΣΩ. τί δέ; μαθημάτων πληρωθεῖσιν ἐὰν ὕστερον ἀποβολαὶ διὰ τῆς λήθης γίνωνται, καθορᾶς τινος ἐν αὐταῖς ἀλγηδónας; ΠΡΩ. οὐ τι φύσει γε, ἀλλ' ἔν τισι λογισμοῖς τοῦ

52b

PR: No, not naturally anyway. But in reflecting on what has happened, someone who has been deprived of the knowledge may be pained by its absence.

52b

S: Well, bless you! And yet at the moment we are describing only the natural responses themselves, devoid of any reflection upon them.

52b

PR: Then what you say is true, and, in the case of learning, we experience no pain when forgetfulness sets in.

52b

S: Then, we should state that these pleasures of learning are not mixed with pain, and that they are not in the possession of humanity in general, but of a select few.

52b

PR: Yes, what else could we say?

παθήματος, ὅταν τις στερηθῇς λυπηθῇ διὰ τὴν χρείαν. ΣΩ. καὶ μήν, ὦ μακάριε, νῦν γε ἡμεῖς αὐτὰ τὰ τῆς φύσεως μόνον παθήματα χωρὶς τοῦ λογισμοῦ διαπεραίνομεν. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθῇ τοίνυν λέγεις ὅτι χωρὶς λύπης ἡμῖν λήθη γίγνεται ἐκάστοτε ἐν τοῖς μαθήμασιν. ΣΩ. ταύτας τοίνυν τὰς τῶν μαθημάτων ἡδονὰς ἀμείκτους τε εἶναι λύπαις ῥητέον καὶ οὐδαμῶς τῶν πολλῶν ἀνθρώπων ἀλλὰ τῶν σφόδρα ὀλίγων. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ ῥητέον;

52c

S: Well, since we have now made a measured distinction between the pure pleasures and those which may properly be described as somewhat impure, we should add the further statement that the intense pleasures are unmeasured, while those which are not intense are by contrast measured. And those which involve intensity and strength, whether such pleasure arises frequently or seldom, we may include in that limitless class, the more and the less, which pervades both body and soul. However, those which do not involve intensity and strength belong to the class of things which are measured.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὅτε μετρίως ἤδη διακεκρίμεθα χωρὶς τὰς τε καθαρὰς ἡδονὰς καὶ τὰς σχεδὸν ἀκαθάρτους ὀρθῶς ἂν λεχθείσας, προσθῶμεν τῷ λόγῳ ταῖς μὲν σφοδραῖς ἡδοναῖς ἀμετρίαν, ταῖς δὲ μὴ τοῦναντίον ἐμμετρίαν καὶ τὰς τὸ μέγα καὶ τὸ σφοδρὸν αὖ δεχομένας, καὶ πολλάκις

καὶ ὀλιγάκις γιγνομένας τοιαύτας, τῆς τοῦ ἀπείρου γε ἐκείνου καὶ ἦττον καὶ μᾶλλον διὰ τε σώματος καὶ ψυχῆς φερομένου

52d

PR: You are perfectly right, Socrates.

52d

S: Then, there is one further aspect of them we must examine.

52d

PR: What is that?

52d

S: We should state precisely how they relate to truth. How do we rank the pure and simple, the intense and extreme, or the strong and vigorous?

52d

PR: What exactly do you have in mind, Socrates, when you ask that question?

προσθῶμεν αὐτὰς εἶναι γένους, τὰς δὲ μὴ τῶν ἐμμέτρων. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα λέγεις, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ἔτι τοίνυν πρὸς τούτοις μετὰ ταῦτα τόδε αὐτῶν διαθεατέον. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. τί ποτε χρή φάναι πρὸς ἀλήθειαν εἶναι; τὸ καθαρὸν τε καὶ εἰλικρινὲς ἢ τὸ σφόδρα τε καὶ τὸ πολὺ καὶ τὸ μέγα καὶ τὸ ἰταμόν; ΠΡΩ. τί ποτ' ἄρα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐρωτᾷς βουλόμενος; ΣΩ. μηδέν, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἐπιλείπειν ἐλέγχων ἡδονῆς

52e

S: Protarchus, I want to omit nothing as I scrutinise both pleasure and knowledge. And if there is a pure form of either of them and an impure form too, I want to make the decision easier, for you and me and everyone here, by making the decision about that pure form.

52e

PR: Very appropriate.

52e

S: Come on then, let us think about these so-called pure classes in this way. We could select one of them first and consider it.

τε καὶ ἐπιστήμης, εἰ τὸ μὲν ἄρ' αὐτῶν ἑκατέρου καθαρὸν ἐστὶ, τὸ δ' οὐ καθαρὸν, ἵνα καθαρὸν ἑκάτερον ἰὸν εἰς τὴν κρίσιν ἐμοὶ καὶ σοὶ καὶ συνάπασι τοῖσδε ῥᾶω παρέχῃ τὴν κρίσιν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ, περὶ πάντων, ὅσα καθαρὰ γένη λέγομεν, οὕτως διανοηθῶμεν προελόμενοι πρῶτον αὐτῶν ἓν τι σκοπῶμεν.

53a

PR: Which should we select?

53a

S: We could look at white as a class first, if you wish.

53a

PR: Yes, certainly.

53a

S: Now, can we have purity of whiteness? And what would that purity be? Does it consist in its extreme magnitude and extent, or in the total absence of admixture of any other colours at all?

53a

PR: Obviously it is the total purity.

ΠΡΩ. τί οὖν προελώμεθα; ΣΩ. τὸ λευκὸν ἐν τοῖς πρῶτον, εἰ βούλει, θεασώμεθα γένος. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. πῶς οὖν ἂν λευκοῦ καὶ τίς καθαρότης ἡμῖν εἴη; πότερα τὸ μέγιστόν τε καὶ πλεῖστον ἢ τὸ ἀκρατέστατον, ἐν ᾧ χρώματος μηδεμία μοῖρα ἄλλη μηδενὸς ἐνείη; ΠΡΩ. δῆλον ὅτι τὸ μάλιστ' εἰλικρινὲς ὄν. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ τοῦτο ἀληθέστατον, ᾧ Πρώταρχε,

53b

S: Correct. And, Protarchus, won't we also suggest that this, and not the most extensive and numerous, is the truest, and also of course the most beautiful, of all whites?

53b

PR: Yes, that is perfectly right.

53b

S: So, a little pure white is whiter and also more beautiful and truer than a great deal of mixed white. If we were to say this, would we be

entirely correct in saying so?

53b

PR: Yes, perfectly correct.

53b

S: Well now, we do not really need many examples of this kind for our discussion about pleasure. It is sufficient that we realise from this instance that any small, insignificant pleasure which has been purified of pain would be more pleasant, true and beautiful than a great and extensive pleasure.

καὶ ἅμα δὴ κάλλιστον τῶν λευκῶν πάντων θήσομεν, ἀλλ' οὐ τὸ πλεῖστον οὐδὲ τὸ μέγιστον; ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατά γε. ΣΩ. σμικρὸν ἄρα καθαρὸν λευκὸν μεμειγμένου πολλοῦ λευκοῦ λευκότερον ἅμα καὶ κάλλιον καὶ ἀληθέστερον ἐὰν φῶμεν γίνεσθαι, παντάπασιν ἐροῦμεν ὀρθῶς. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; οὐ δήπου πολλῶν δεησόμεθα παραδειγμάτων τοιούτων ἐπὶ τὸν τῆς ἡδονῆς περί λόγον, ἀλλ' ἄρκεϊ νοεῖν ἡμῖν αὐτόθεν ὡς ἄρα καὶ σύμπασα ἡδονὴ σμικρὰ

53c

PR: Very much so. Yes, this example is sufficient.

53c

S: But what about the following point? Haven't we heard that pleasure is always a process of becoming, and that there is no being whatsoever of pleasure? Yes, indeed, some subtle thinkers try to explain this argument to us, and we should be grateful to them.

53c

PR: What do you mean?

μεγάλης καὶ ὀλίγη πολλῆς, καθαρὰ λύπης, ἡδίων καὶ ἀληθεστέρα καὶ καλλίων γίγνεται ἅν. ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα μὲν οὖν, καὶ τό γε παράδειγμα ἱκανόν. ΣΩ. τί δὲ τὸ τοιόνδε; ἄρα περὶ ἡδονῆς οὐκ ἀκηκόαμεν ὡς αἰὲ γένεσις ἐστίν, οὐσία δὲ οὐκ ἔστι τὸ παράπαν ἡδονῆς; κομποὶ γὰρ δὴ τινες αὖ τοῦτον τὸν λόγον ἐπιχειροῦσι μηνύειν ἡμῖν, οἷς δεῖ χάριν ἔχειν. ΠΡΩ. τί δή; ΣΩ. διαπερανοῦμαί σοι τοῦτ' αὐτὸ ἐπανερωτῶν, ὦ

53d

S: Protarchus, my friend, I shall explain this particular point to you by asking more questions.

53d

PR: Explain it, then. Ask the questions.

53d

S: Well, there is a duality, and one aspect is just what it is, while the other is always aiming at something else.

53d

PR: How are there two? What do you mean?

53d

S: One is by nature always utterly sacred, while the other is deficient in that respect.

53d

PR: Please explain even more clearly.

53d

S: Presumably we have observed handsome and excellent young men, and also their courageous lovers.

53d

PR: Definitely.

Πρώταρχε φίλε. ΠΡΩ. λέγε καὶ ἐρώτα μόνον. ΣΩ. ἐστὸν δὴ τινε δύο, τὸ μὲν αὐτὸ καθ' αὐτό, τὸ δ' αἰεὶ ἐφιέμενον ἄλλου. ΠΡΩ. πῶς τούτῳ καὶ τίνε λέγεις; ΣΩ. τὸ μὲν σεμνότατον αἰεὶ πεφυκός, τὸ δ' ἑλλιπὲς ἐκείνου. ΠΡΩ. λέγ' ἔτι σαφέστερον. ΣΩ. παιδικὰ που καλὰ καὶ ἀγαθὰ τεθεωρήκαμεν ἅμα καὶ ἐραστὰς ἀνδρείους αὐτῶν. ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα γε. ΣΩ. τούτοις τοίνυν ἔοικότα δυοῖν οὔσι δύο ἄλλα ζήτει

53e

S: Search throughout everything that we say there is for another pair which resembles these two.

53e

PR: I ask you for the third time, Socrates, please explain what you are saying more clearly.

53e

S: It is not anything complicated, Protarchus. No, the argument is teasing us by saying that things that are, in one case, are always for the sake of something else; but in the other case are that on account of which, that which arises for the sake of something else, always arises when it does arise.

53e

PR: I am understanding you gradually, because of the constant repetition.

κατὰ πάνθ' ὅσα λέγομεν εἶναι. ΠΡΩ. τὸ τρίτον ἔτ' ἐρῶ; λέγε σαφέστερον, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅτι λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐδέν τι ποικίλον, ὦ Πρωταρχε· ἀλλ' ὁ λόγος ἐρεσχηλεῖ νῶν, λέγει δ' ὅτι τὸ μὲν ἔνεκά του τῶν ὄντων ἔστ' αἰεὶ, τὸ δ' οὐ χάριν ἐκάστοτε τὸ τινὸς ἔνεκα γιγνόμενον αἰεὶ γίγνεται. ΠΡΩ. μόγισ ἔμαθον διὰ τὸ πολλάκις λεχθῆναι. ΣΩ. τάχα δ' ἴσως, ὦ παῖ, μᾶλλον μαθησόμεθα προελθόντος

54a

S: And, my boy, it is quite likely that we shall understand more as the argument unfolds.

54a

PR: Undoubtedly.

54a

S: Now, let us take another pair.

54a

PR: Of what sort?

54a

S: One is the becoming of all things, and the other one is their being.

54a

PR: I agree with you. There are these two, being and becoming.

54a

S: Quite right. Now, which of them occurs for the sake of which? Should we say that becoming is for the sake of being, or being is for the sake of becoming?

54a

PR: Do you want to know if that which is called being is what it is for the sake of becoming?

54a

S: Apparently.

τοῦ λόγου. ΠΡΩ. τί γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. δύο δὴ τάδε ἕτερα λάβωμεν. ΠΡΩ. ποῖα; ΣΩ. ἓν μὲν τι γένεσιν πάντων, τὴν δὲ οὐσίαν ἕτερον ἓν. ΠΡΩ. δύο ἀποδέχομαί σου ταῦτα, οὐσίαν καὶ γένεσιν. ΣΩ. ὁρθότατα. πότερον οὖν τούτων ἕνεκα ποτέρου, τὴν γένεσιν οὐσίας ἕνεκα φῶμεν ἢ τὴν οὐσίαν εἶναι γενέσεως ἕνεκα; ΠΡΩ. τοῦτο ὃ προσαγορεύεται οὐσία εἰ γενέσεως ἕνεκα τοῦτ' ἔστιν ὅπερ ἐστί, νῦν πυνθάνη; ΣΩ. φαίνομαι.

54b

PR: By the gods, this is like asking me, “Protarchus, tell me whether you would say that shipbuilding arises for the sake of ships, rather than ships for the sake of shipbuilding?” and other questions like that.

54b

S: I mean just that, Protarchus.

54b

PR: Then why not answer the question yourself, Socrates?

54b

S: There is no reason why not, except that you should also participate in the discussion.

54b

PR: Very good.

ΠΡΩ. πρὸς θεῶν ἄρ' ἂν ἐπανερωτᾷς με τοιόνδε τι; λέγ', ὦ Πρώταρχε, μοί, πότερα πλοίων ναυπηγίαν ἕνεκα φῆς γίγνεσθαι μᾶλλον ἢ πλοῖα ἕνεκα ναυπηγίας, καὶ πάνθ' ὁπόσα τοιαῦτ' ἐστίν; ΣΩ. λέγω τοῦτ' αὐτό, ὦ Πρώταρχε. ΠΡΩ. τί οὖν οὐκ αὐτὸς ἀπεκρίνω σαυτῷ, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. οὐδὲν ὅτι οὐ σὺ μέντοι τοῦ λόγου συμμετέχε. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν.

54c

S: Now, I am saying that medicine, and all tools and raw materials, are applied to anything for the sake of becoming, but that each process of

becoming, for its part, arises for the sake of some particular being, and that becoming in general arises for the sake of being in general.

54c

PR: Yes, that could not be clearer.

54c

S: Therefore, if in fact pleasure is a process of becoming, it would necessarily arise for the sake of some being.

54c

PR: Of course.

54c

S: Well, that for the sake of which anything which comes to be, for the sake of something else, always arises, that belongs to the rank of the good. However, my excellent friend, anything which arises for the sake of something else should be assigned a different rank.

54c

PR: Absolutely necessary.

ΣΩ. φημί δὴ γενέσεως μὲν ἕνεκα φάρμακά τε καὶ πάντα ὄργανα καὶ πᾶσαν ὕλην παρατίθεσθαι πᾶσιν, ἐκάστην δὲ γένεσιν ἄλλην ἄλλης οὐσίας τινὸς ἐκάστης ἕνεκα γίγνεσθαι, σύμπασαν δὲ γένεσιν οὐσίας ἕνεκα γίγνεσθαι συμπάσης. ΠΡΩ. σαφέστατα μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἡδονὴ γε, εἴπερ γένεσίς ἐστιν, ἕνεκά τινος οὐσίας ἐξ ἀνάγκης γίγνοιτ' ἄν. ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. τό γε μὴν οὐδ' ἕνεκά τὸ ἕνεκά του γιγνόμενον ἀεὶ γίγνοιτ' ἄν, ἐν τῇ τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ μοίρᾳ ἐκεῖνό ἐστι· τὸ δὲ τινὸς ἕνεκα γιγνόμενον εἰς ἄλλην, ὧ ἄριστε, μοῖραν θετέον. ΠΡΩ. ἀναγκαιότατον.

54d

S: Now, if pleasure is in fact a process of becoming, would we be assigning it correctly if we allocated it a rank other than the rank of the good?

54d

PR: Yes, that would be perfectly correct.

54d

S: Therefore, as I actually said at the beginning of this discussion, we should be grateful to whoever declared that pleasure is a process of becoming which has no being whatsoever. For it is obvious that this person makes a laughing stock of those who assert that pleasure is good.

54d

PR: Definitely.

ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἡδονή γε εἴπερ γένεσις ἐστίν, εἰς ἄλλην ἢ τὴν τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ μοῖραν αὐτὴν τιθέντες ὀρθῶς θήσομεν; ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὅπερ ἀρχόμενος εἶπον τούτου τοῦ λόγου, τῷ μηνύσαντι τῆς ἡδονῆς περὶ τὸ γένεσιν μὲν, οὐσίαν δὲ μὴδ' ἡντινοῦν αὐτῆς εἶναι, χάριν ἔχειν δεῖ· δηλὸν γὰρ ὅτι οὗτος τῶν φασκόντων ἡδονὴν ἀγαθὸν εἶναι καταγελά. ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα γε.

54e

S: And, indeed, this same person will also make a laughing stock of those whose objective consists in processes of becoming.

54e

PR: In what way? And what sort of people are you referring to?

54e

S: I am referring to all who obtain relief from hunger and thirst, or anything of that sort, which may be relieved by a process of becoming, and are delighted by the process, as it is itself a pleasure. They say that life would be unbearable without the experiences of thirst and hunger, and all the others which may be said to follow upon such conditions.

ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν αὐτὸς οὗτος ἐκάστοτε καὶ τῶν ἐν ταῖς γενέσεσιν ἀποτελουμένων καταγελάσεται. ΠΡΩ. πῶς δὴ καὶ ποίων λέγεις; ΣΩ. τῶν ὅσοι ἐξιώμενοι ἢ πείνην ἢ δίψαν ἢ τι τῶν τοιούτων, ὅσα γένεσις ἐξιᾶται, χαίρουσι διὰ τὴν γένεσιν ἅτε ἡδονῆς οὐσης αὐτῆς, καὶ φασὶ ζῆν οὐκ ἂν δέξασθαι μὴ διψῶντές τε καὶ πεινῶντες καὶ τᾶλλα ἃ τις ἂν εἴποι πάντα τὰ ἐπόμενα τοῖς τοιούτοις παθήμασι μὴ πάσχοντες.

55a

PR: Well, they seem to believe that anyway.

55a

S: Now, I presume we would all agree that perishing is the opposite of coming into being.

55a

PR: It must be.

55a

S: If someone were to choose a life based upon coming into being and perishing, he would not be choosing that third kind of life, in which there is neither pleasure nor pain, but only the purest possible understanding.

55a

PR: It seems, Socrates, that a lot of unreasonable consequences follow, once anyone proposes to us that pleasure is good.

55a

S: A lot. And there is even more to be said.

55a

PR: In what way?

ΠΡΩ. εοίκασι γοῦν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τῷ γίγνεσθαι γε τοῦναντίον ἅπαντες τὸ φθειρεσθαι φαῖμεν ἄν. ΠΡΩ. ἀναγκαῖον. ΣΩ. τὴν δὲ φθορὰν καὶ γένεσιν αἰροῖτ' ἄν τις τοῦθ' αἰρούμενος, ἀλλ' οὐ τὸν τρίτον ἐκεῖνον βίον, τὸν ἐν ᾧ μήτε χαίρειν μήτε λυπεῖσθαι, φρονεῖν δ' ἦν δυνατόν ὡς οἶόν τε καθαρώτατα. ΠΡΩ. πολλή τις, ὡς ἔοικεν, ᾧ Σώκρατες, ἀλογία συμβαίνει γίγνεσθαι, ἐάν τις τὴν ἡδονὴν ὡς ἀγαθὸν ἡμῖν τιθῇται. ΣΩ. πολλή, ἐπεὶ καὶ τῇδε ἔτι λέγωμεν. ΠΡΩ. πῃ;

55b

S: How can it be reasonable that there is nothing good or fair, in body or in anything else, except in soul? And that the good in the soul should be pleasure alone, while courage and self-control and reason, and the other goods which the soul contains, are neither good nor fair? What is more, must we refer to a man who is not experiencing pleasure but is in pain as bad, once he is in pain, even if he is the most excellent of men? And what's more, must we refer to the man who

experiences pleasure as distinguished in excellence, to the extent that he experiences more pleasure when he is pleased?

ΣΩ. πῶς οὐκ ἄλογόν ἐστι μηδὲν ἀγαθὸν εἶναι μηδὲ καλὸν μήτε ἐν σώμασι μήτ' ἐν πολλοῖς ἄλλοις πλὴν ἐν ψυχῇ, καὶ ἐνταῦθα ἡδονὴν μόνον, ἀνδρείαν δὲ ἢ σωφροσύνην ἢ νοῦν ἢ τι τῶν ἄλλων ὅσα ἀγαθὰ εἴληχε ψυχὴ, μηδὲν τοιοῦτον εἶναι; πρὸς τούτοις δὲ ἔτι τὸν μὴ χαίροντα, ἀλγοῦντα δέ, ἀναγκάζεσθαι φάναι κακὸν εἶναι τότε ὅταν ἀλγῇ, καὶ ἢ ἄριστος πάντων, καὶ τὸν χαίροντα αὖ, ὅσῳ μᾶλλον χαίρει,

55c

PR: All these conclusions are as unreasonable as can be, Socrates.

55c

S: Then, we should not be trying our utmost to conduct a comprehensive review of pleasure whilst showing scant regard for reason and knowledge. Let us make bold, and test these thoroughly for any unsoundness, so that we may discern what is naturally purest in them, and then make our joint decision by referring to what is truest in these two and in pleasure.

55c

PR: Right.

τότε ὅταν χαίρη, τοσούτῳ διαφέρειν πρὸς ἀρετήν. ΠΡΩ. πάντ' ἐστὶ ταῦτα, ὧ Σώκρατες, ὡς δυνατόν ἀλογώτατα. ΣΩ. μὴ τοίνυν ἡδονῆς μὲν πάντως ἐξέτασιν πᾶσαν ἐπιχειρῶμεν ποιήσασθαι, νοῦ δὲ καὶ ἐπιστήμης οἷον φειδόμενοι σφόδρα φανῶμεν· γενναίως δέ, εἴ πῃ τι σαθρὸν ἔχει, πᾶν περικρούωμεν, ὡς ὅτι καθαρώτατόν ἐστ' αὐτῶν φύσει, τοῦτο κατιδόντες εἰς τὴν κρίσιν χρώμεθα τὴν κοινὴν τοῖς τε τούτων καὶ τοῖς τῆς ἡδονῆς μέρεσιν ἀληθεστάτοις. ΠΡΩ. ὁρθῶς.

55d

S: Well then, I believe that the knowledge involved in learning relates either to a skill or to education and nurture. Is this so?

55d

PR: It is so.

55d

S: Now, in the case of manual skills, let us consider firstly whether some of them involve more knowledge, while others involve less, and whether we should regard the former as entirely pure, and the latter as less pure.

55d

PR: Yes, we must do this.

55d

S: Then, should we deal with the chief skills separately in each case?

55d

PR: What are they, and how should we deal with them?

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἡμῖν τὸ μὲν οἶμαι δημιουργικόν ἐστι τῆς περὶ τὰ μαθήματα ἐπιστήμης, τὸ δὲ περὶ παιδείαν καὶ τροφήν. ἢ πῶς; ΠΡΩ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἐν δὴ ταῖς χειροτεχνικαῖς διανοηθῶμεν πρῶτα εἰ τὸ μὲν ἐπιστήμης αὐτῶν μᾶλλον ἐχόμενον, τὸ δ' ἦττον ἔνι, καὶ δεῖ τὰ μὲν ὡς καθαρῶτα νομίζειν, τὰ δ' ὡς ἀκαθαρότερα. ΠΡΩ. οὐκοῦν χρή. ΣΩ. τὰς τοίνυν ἡγεμονικὰς διαληπτέον ἐκάστων αὐτῶν χωρίς; ΠΡΩ. ποίας καὶ πῶς;

55e

S: For instance, if someone were to remove counting, measuring and weighing from all of the skills, what was left of each would, so to speak, be worthless.

55e

PR: Yes, worthless indeed.

55e

S: Anyway, after that, what is left would be estimation, and the exercise of the senses through experience and habit, and recourse to the powers of guesswork, which many call skills, since this ability is developed through study and hard work.

ΣΩ. οἷον πασῶν που τεχνῶν ἄν τις ἀριθμητικὴν χωρίζη καὶ μετρητικὴν καὶ στατικὴν, ὡς ἔπος εἰπεῖν φαῦλον τὸ καταλειπόμενον ἐκάστης ἂν γίγνοιτο. ΠΡΩ. φαῦλον μὲν δή. ΣΩ. τὸ γοῦν μετὰ ταῦτ' εἰκάζειν λείποιτ' ἂν καὶ τὰς αἰσθήσεις καταμελετᾶν ἐμπειρίᾳ καὶ τινι τριβῇ, ταῖς τῆς στοχαστικῆς προσχρωμένους δυνάμεσιν ἃς πολλοὶ τέχνας

56a

PR: What you are saying is undeniable.

56a

S: Now, in the first place, music is presumably full of this as it harmonises the sounds, not through measurement but by inference based on experience. Flute-playing, in general, seeks out the measure of each note by inference, and so to a large extent it involves an absence of clarity, combined with little certainty.

56a

PR: Very true.

ἐπονομάζουσι, μελέτη καὶ πόνῳ τὴν ῥώμην ἀπειργασμένας. ΠΡΩ. ἀναγκαιότατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν μεστή μὲν που μουσικὴ πρῶτον, τὸ σύμφωνον ἀρμόττουσα οὐ μέτρῳ ἀλλὰ μελέτης στοχασμῷ, καὶ σύμπασα αὐτῆς αὐλητικὴ, τὸ μέτρον ἐκάστης χορδῆς τῷ στοχάζεσθαι φερομένης θηρεύουσα, ὥστε πολὺ μεμειγμένον ἔχειν τὸ μὴ σαφές, σμικρὸν δὲ τὸ βέβαιον. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα.

56b

S: And we shall find that the same applies to medicine, farming, navigation and military strategy.

56b

PR: Yes, certainly.

56b

S: But building, I believe, uses far more measurements and instruments, and these provide it with much precision, and render it the most skilful of the various branches of knowledge.

56b

PR: In what way?

56b

S: On the basis that both shipbuilding and house-building, along with numerous other skills, involve woodworking. For this skill, I believe, uses the ruler, the compass, lathe, chalk-line and an ingenious kind of set square.

ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἰατρικὴν τε καὶ γεωργίαν καὶ κυβερνητικὴν καὶ στρατηγικὴν ὡσαύτως εὐρήσομεν ἐχούσας. ΠΡΩ. καὶ πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. τεκτονικὴν δέ γε οἶμαι πλείστοις μέτροις τε καὶ ὀργάνοις χρωμένην τὰ πολλὴν ἀκρίβειαν αὐτῇ πορίζοντα τεχνικωτέραν τῶν πολλῶν ἐπιστημῶν παρέχεται. ΠΡΩ. πῆ; ΣΩ. κατὰ τε ναυπηγίαν καὶ κατ' οἰκοδομίαν καὶ ἐν πολλοῖς ἄλλοις τῆς ξυλουργικῆς. κανόνι γὰρ οἶμαι καὶ

56c

PR: Very much so, Socrates. What you are saying is correct.

56c

S: Then, let us divide these so-called skills in two – those corresponding to music, which involve less precision in their activities, and those corresponding to building, which are more precise.

56c

PR: Let's do that.

56c

S: And the most precise of these are the skills which we just said are primary.

56c

PR: You appear to me to be referring to arithmetic, and whatever skills you mentioned along with it a moment ago.

τόρνω χρήται καὶ διαβήτη καὶ στάθμη καὶ τινι προσαγωγίῳ κεκομψευμένῳ. ΠΡΩ. καὶ πάνυ γε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὀρθῶς λέγεις. ΣΩ. θῶμεν τοίνυν διχῇ τὰς λεγομένας τέχνας, τὰς μὲν μουσικῇ συνεπομένας ἐν τοῖς ἔργοις ἐλάττονος ἀκριβείας μετισχούσας, τὰς δὲ τεκτονικῇ πλείονος. ΠΡΩ. κείσθω. ΣΩ. τούτων δὲ ταύτας ἀκριβεστάτας εἶναι τέχνας, ἃς νυνδὴ πρῶτας εἵπομεν. ΠΡΩ. ἀριθμητικὴν φαίνει μοι λέγειν καὶ ὅσας μετὰ ταύτης τέχνας ἐφθέγξω νυνδὴ.

56d

S: Yes, certainly. But, Protarchus, should we also say that these subjects in turn are also twofold? What do you think?

56d

PR: What two aspects are you referring to?

56d

S: Shouldn't we point out first that the arithmetic of the multitude is one thing, while the arithmetic of those who engage in philosophy is something else again?

56d

PR: How could anyone ever propose a distinction between one kind of arithmetic and another?

56d

S: This is no minor distinction, Protarchus. Indeed, there are people who enumerate units which are somehow unequal, such as two armies, or oxen, or two of the smallest or largest possible entities. But there are others who would never go along with this, unless someone was to propose that each of the units does not differ at all from any of the countless other units.

ΣΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ἀλλ', ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἄρ' οὐ διττὰς αὖ καὶ ταύτας λεκτέον; ἢ πῶς; ΠΡΩ. ποίας δὴ λέγεις; ΣΩ. ἀριθμητικὴν πρῶτον ἄρ' οὐκ ἄλλην μὲν τινα τὴν τῶν πολλῶν φατέον, ἄλλην δ' αὖ τὴν τῶν φιλοσοφούντων; ΠΡΩ. πῇ ποτε διορισάμενος οὖν ἄλλην, τὴν δὲ ἄλλην θείῃ τις ἂν ἀριθμητικὴν; ΣΩ. οὐ μικρὸς ὅρος, ὦ Πρώταρχε. οἱ μὲν γάρ που μονάδας ἀνίσους καταριθμοῦνται τῶν περὶ ἀριθμόν, οἷον στρατόπεδα δύο καὶ βοῦς δύο καὶ δύο τὰ μικρότατα ἢ καὶ

56e

PR: Then you are quite right to say that the difference between people who deal with numbers is not minor, so it makes sense that there are two types.

56e

S: What about calculation and measurement used in building or trading, compared to the geometry and calculation associated with philosophy? Should we say that each subject is one, or should we propose that there are two?

τὰ πάντων μέγιστα οἱ δ' οὐκ ἂν ποτε αὐτοῖς συνακολουθήσειαν, εἰ μὴ μονάδα μονάδος ἐκάστης τῶν μυρίων μηδεμίαν ἄλλην ἄλλης διαφέρουσάν τις θήσει. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα εὖ λέγεις οὐ σμικρὰν διαφορὰν τῶν περὶ ἀριθμὸν τευταζόντων, ὥστε λόγον ἔχειν δὴ αὐτὰς εἶναι. ΣΩ. τί δέ; λογιστική καὶ μετρητική ἢ κατὰ τεκτονικὴν καὶ κατ' ἐμπορικὴν τῆς κατὰ φιλοσοφίαν γεωμετρίας τε καὶ

57a

PR: Following what was said before, according to my vote there would be two types of each subject.

57a

S: Correct. But do you appreciate why we have introduced these issues into the discussion?

57a

PR: Possibly, but I would like you to reply to the question which has just been asked.

57a

S: Well, it seems to me anyway that this discussion – no less than when we first commenced it, in looking for a counterpart to pleasures – has gone on from there to investigate whether one kind of knowledge is purer than another kind of knowledge, just as one pleasure was purer than another.

λογισμῶν καταμελετωμένων—πότερον ὡς μία ἐκατέρα λεκτέον ἢ δύο τιθῶμεν; ΠΡΩ. τῇ πρόσθεν ἐπόμενος ἔγωγ' ἂν δύο κατὰ τὴν ἐμὴν ψῆφον τιθείην ἐκατέραν τούτων. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. οὗ δ' ἔνεκα ταῦτα προηνεγκάμεθα εἰς τὸ μέσον, ἄρα ἐννοεῖς; ΠΡΩ. ἴσως, ἀλλὰ σὲ βουλοίμην ἂν ἀποφήνασθαι τὸ νῦν ἐρωτώμενον. ΣΩ. δοκεῖ τοίνυν ἔμοιγε οὗτος ὁ λόγος, οὐχ ἥττον ἢ ὅτε λέγειν αὐτὸν ἡρχόμεθα, ταῖς ἡδοναῖς ζητῶν ἀντίστροφον ἐνταῦθα προβεβληκέναι σκοπῶν ἄρ' ἐστὶ τις ἐτέρας

57b

PR: Yes, and it is quite clear that that is the reason why these topics were introduced.

57b

S: What now? Did we not discover previously that there is a skill applicable to various subjects, which may be more definite or less definite in one case than another?

57b

PR: Yes, certainly.

57b

S: Yet, in these cases, did we not refer to a particular skill with a single name, giving the impression that it was one thing? Then again, are we now behaving as if this definite and pure skill is itself two things, when we ask whether the skill of the philosophic or the nonphilosophic people is more precise?

ἄλλη καθαρωτέρα ἐπιστήμης ἐπιστήμη, καθάπερ ἡδονῆς ἡδονή. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα σαφὲς τοῦτό γε, ὅτι ταῦθ' ἔνεκα τούτων ἐπικεχείρηκεν. ΣΩ. τί οὖν; ἄρ' οὐκ ἐν μὲν τοῖς ἔμπροσθεν ἐπ' ἄλλοις ἄλλην τέχνην οὖσαν ἀνηυρήκειν σαφεστέραν καὶ ἀσαφεστέραν ἄλλην ἄλλης; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἐν τούτοις δὲ ἄρ' οὐ τίνα τέχνην ὡς ὁμώνυμον φθεγζάμενος, εἰς δύο καταστήσας ὡς μιᾶς, πάλιν ὡς

57c

PR: Yes, it certainly seems to me that this question does arise.

57c

S: Well, what answer do we give, Protarchus?

57c

PR: Socrates! We have arrived at an amazingly significant distinction in relation to the clarity of various types of knowledge.

57c

S: Doesn't that make it easier for us to reply?

57c

PR: Of course. And we should state that these pure skills are far superior to the others, and any of them which are concerned with the endeavour of genuinely philosophic people are immeasurably superior, in precision and truth, in relation both to measure and to number.

δυοῖν ἐπανερωτᾷ τούτοις αὐτοῖς τὸ σαφές καὶ τὸ καθαρὸν περὶ ταῦτα πότερον ἢ τῶν φιλοσοφούντων ἢ μὴ φιλοσοφούντων ἀκριβέστερον ἔχει; ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα δοκεῖ μοι τοῦτο διερωτᾶν. ΣΩ. τίς οὖν, ὦ Πρώταρχε, αὐτῷ δίδομεν ἀπόκρισιν; ΠΡΩ. ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰς θαυμαστὸν διαφορᾶς μέγεθος εἰς σαφήνειαν προεληλύθαμεν ἐπιστημῶν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ἀποκρινόμεθα ῥᾶον; ΠΡΩ. τί μήν; καὶ εἰρήσθω γε ὅτι πολὺ μὲν αὐταὶ τῶν ἄλλων τεχνῶν διαφέρουσι, τούτων δ' αὐτῶν αἱ περὶ τὴν

57d

S: Let us accept what you say, and placing our trust in you we can reply boldly to those who are so clever at dragging words about.

57d

PR: What sort of reply should we give?

57d

S: That there are two arithmetical and two metrical skills, and countless other similar skills associated with them, which possess this twofold aspect though they share one common name.

τῶν ὄντως φιλοσοφούντων ὁρμὴν ἀμήχανον ἀκριβεῖα καὶ ἀληθεία περὶ μέτρα τε καὶ ἀριθμοὺς διαφέρουσιν. ΣΩ. ἔστω ταῦτα κατὰ σέ, καὶ σοὶ δὴ πιστεύοντες θαρροῦντες ἀποκρινόμεθα τοῖς δεινοῖς περὶ λόγων ὀλκήν — ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὡς εἰσὶ δύο ἀριθμητικαὶ καὶ δύο μετρητικαὶ καὶ ταύταις ἄλλαι τοιαῦται συνεπόμεναι συχναί, τὴν διδυμότητα ἔχουσαι ταύτην, ὀνόματος δὲ ἐνὸς κεκοινωμέναι.

57e

PR: Let's give this answer, Socrates, along with our best wishes to these men whom you say are clever.

57e

S: Are we saying, then, that these are the most precise forms of knowledge?

57e

PR: Very much so.

57e

S: But, Protarchus, the power of dialectic would disown us should we decide that some other skill is preferable to it.

57e

PR: Should we explain again what dialectic is?

ΠΡΩ. διδῶμεν τύχη ἀγαθῇ τούτοις οὓς φῆς δεινοὺς εἶναι ταύτην τὴν ἀπόκρισιν, ὦ Σώκρατες. ΣΩ. ταύτας οὖν λέγομεν ἐπιστήμας ἀκριβεῖς μάλιστ' εἶναι; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἡμᾶς, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἀναίνοιτ' ἂν ἡ τοῦ διαλέγεσθαι δύναμις, εἴ τινα πρὸ αὐτῆς ἄλλην κρίναιμεν. ΠΡΩ. τίνα δὲ ταύτην αὖ δεῖ λέγειν;

58a

S: Obviously it is the skill which understands every skill we are now discussing, at least.⁴ For I believe that anyone who is endowed with even a little reason regards the understanding of being and reality and that which is always entirely the same by nature as the truest knowledge by far. But what about you? How would you decide the issue, Protarchus?

58a

PR: Well, Socrates, I heard consistently and repeatedly from Gorgias that skill in persuasion is greatly superior to all other skills, for everyone is enslaved by it, not by force, but willingly, so it is by far the best skill of all. And now I do not wish to take up a position opposed either to you or to him.

ΣΩ. δῆλον ὅτι ἡ πᾶς ἂν τὴν γε νῦν λεγομένην γνοίῃ τὴν γὰρ περὶ τὸ ὄν καὶ τὸ ὄντως καὶ τὸ κατὰ ταῦτόν ἀεὶ πεφυκὸς πάντως ἔγωγε οἶμαι ἡγεῖσθαι σύμπαντας ὅσοις νοῦ καὶ σμικρὸν προσήρηται μακρῷ ἀληθεστάτην εἶναι γινῶσιν. σὺ δὲ τί; πῶς τοῦτο, ὦ Πρώταρχε, διακρίνοις ἂν; ΠΡΩ. ἤκουον μὲν ἔγωγε, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐκάστοτε Γοργίου πολλάκις ὡς ἡ τοῦ πείθειν πολὺ διαφέρει πασῶν τεχνῶν

58b

S: I think you wanted to say “take up arms”, but you dropped that wording out of politeness.

58b

PR: Let it be so then, if you think it so.

58b

S: Well, in that case, am I responsible for your inadequate understanding?

58b

PR: In what way?

—πάντα γὰρ ὑφ’ αὐτῇ δοῦλα δι’ ἐκόντων ἀλλ’ οὐ διὰ βίας ποιοῖτο, καὶ μακρῷ ἀρίστη πασῶν εἴη τῶν τεχνῶν—νῦν δ’ οὔτε σοὶ οὔτε δὴ ἐκείνῳ βουλοίμην ἂν ἐναντία τίθεσθαι. ΣΩ. τὰ ὅπλα μοι δοκεῖς βουλευθεῖς εἰπεῖν αἰσχυνθεῖς ἀπολιπεῖν. ΠΡΩ. ἔστω νῦν ταῦτα ταύτῃ ὅπῃ σοι δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. ἄρ’ οὖν αἴτιος ἐγὼ τοῦ μὴ καλῶς ὑπολαβεῖν σε; ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. οὐκ, ὦ φίλε Πρώταρχε, τοῦτο ἔγωγε ἐζήτουν πω,

58c

S: Protarchus, my friend, I was not yet asking what skill or knowledge exceeds all in magnitude, excellence, and the extent of its benefit to us. No, the skill which pursues what is clear and precise and perfectly true, even if it is minor and of little benefit, is what we are searching for now. But look, you will not become an enemy of Gorgias if you grant that his own skill is supreme in relation to its benefit to humanity, while this process we are discussing is the very truest. It is just like the example of whiteness I gave earlier, where even a little pure colour is superior to a lot of colour which is not pure. And now, after intense thought and proper discussion, we should look neither to the benefits of any branch of knowledge, nor to its reputation, but only to whether there is a certain natural capacity in our souls to love the truth and perform all actions for its sake. We should declare that this power deserves close attention, and we should state whether this is most likely to possess pure reason and understanding, or whether we should look for something else which is better.

τίς τέχνη ἢ τίς ἐπιστήμη πασῶν διαφέρει τῷ μεγίστῃ καὶ ἀρίστῃ καὶ πλεῖστα ὠφελοῦσα ἡμᾶς, ἀλλὰ τίς ποτε τὸ σαφές καὶ τὰκριβές καὶ τὸ ἀληθέστατον ἐπισκοπεῖ, κἂν εἰ σμικρὰ καὶ σμικρὰ ὀνινᾶσα, τοῦτ’ ἔστιν ὃ

νῦν δὴ ζητοῦμεν. ἀλλ' ὅρα—οὐδὲ γὰρ ἀπεχθήσῃ Γοργία, τῇ μὲν ἐκείνου ὑπάρχειν τέχνη διδοὺς πρὸς χρεῖαν τοῖς ἀνθρώποις κρατεῖν, ἧ δ' εἶπον ἐγὼ νῦν πραγματεία, καθάπερ τοῦ λευκοῦ πέρι τότε ἔλεγον, κἂν εἰ σμικρόν, καθαρὸν δ' εἴη, τοῦ πολλοῦ καὶ μὴ τοιούτου διαφέρειν, τούτῳ γ' αὐτῷ τῷ ἀληθεστάτῳ, καὶ νῦν δὴ σφόδρα διανοηθέντες καὶ ἱκανῶς διαλογισάμενοι, μήτ' εἷς τινὰς ὠφελίας ἐπιστημῶν βλέψαντες μήτε τινὰς εὐδοκίμιας, ἀλλ' εἷς τις πέφυκε τῆς ψυχῆς ἡμῶν δύναμις ἐρᾶν τε τοῦ ἀληθοῦς καὶ πάντα ἔνεκα τούτου πράττειν, ταύτην εἰπῶμεν διεξερευνησάμενοι—τὸ καθαρὸν νοῦ τε καὶ φρονήσεως εἰ ταύτην μάλιστα ἐκ τῶν εἰκότων ἐκτῆσθαι φαῖμεν ἂν ἢ τινὰ ἐτέραν ταύτης κυριωτέραν ἡμῖν ζητητέον.

58e

PR: Well, I am considering this, and I think it is hard to accept that any other skill or knowledge adheres more closely to truth than this one.

58e

S: Now, are you saying what you have just said because you realise that the various skills, and those who work at them, in the first place make use of opinions and are earnestly investigating matters of opinion? And even if they think they are enquiring into nature, you must understand that they are, in fact, spending their lives investigating this universe, how it has arisen, what happens to it, and how it behaves? Is this what we would say? Or how would we express it?

ΠΡΩ. ἀλλὰ σκοπῶ, καὶ χαλεπὸν οἶμαι συγχωρῆσαί τινα ἄλλην ἐπιστήμην ἢ τέχνην τῆς ἀληθείας ἀντέχεσθαι μᾶλλον ἢ ταύτην. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἐννοήσας τὸ τοιόνδε εἴρηκας ὃ λέγεις νῦν, ὥς αἱ πολλαὶ τέχναι, καὶ ὅσοι περὶ ταῦτα πεπόνηνται,

59a

PR: In this way.

59a

S: So, a person like this is not taking on the task of enquiring into things that always are, but into things that are becoming, will become, and have become.

59a

PR: Very true.

πρῶτον μὲν δόξαις χρῶνται καὶ τὰ περὶ δόξαν ζητοῦσι συντεταμένως; εἴ τε καὶ περὶ φύσεως ἡγεῖται τις ζητεῖν, οἷσθ' ὅτι τὰ περὶ τὸν κόσμον τόνδε, ὅπη τε γέγονεν καὶ ὅπη πάσχει τι καὶ ὅπη ποιεῖ, ταῦτα ζητεῖ διὰ βίου; φαῖμεν ἂν ταῦτα, ἢ πῶς; ΠΡΩ. οὕτως. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν οὐ περὶ τὰ ὄντα ἀεὶ, περὶ δὲ τὰ γιγνόμενα καὶ γενησόμενα καὶ γεγονότα ἡμῶν ὁ τοιοῦτος ἀνήρηται τὸν πόνον; ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. τούτων οὖν τι σαφὲς ἂν φαῖμεν τῇ ἀκριβεστάτῃ

59b

S: Now, would we say, in strictest truth, that anything clear arises from these when they have never ever remained the same, never will, and are not so at present?

59b

PR: No, how could we?

59b

S: Well, how could we ever achieve any certainty at all about matters which have never attained any certainty whatsoever? ----- 4
Following Bury's text here.

59b

PR: I do not think it is possible at all.

59b

S: So, there is no reasoning or any knowledge about them which is perfectly true.

59b

PR: No, that is not likely.

59b

S: Well then, we should bid a final farewell to you and me, Gorgias and Philebus, and instead use the argument to make the following case.

ἀληθείᾳ γίνεσθαι, ὧν μήτε ἔσχε μηδὲν πώποτε κατὰ ταῦτα μήθ' ἔξει μήτε εἰς τὸ νῦν παρὸν ἔχει; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πῶς; ΣΩ. περὶ οὖν τὰ μὴ κεκτημένα βεβαιότητα μηδ' ἡγνινοῦν πῶς ἂν ποτε βέβαιον γίγνοιθ' ἡμῖν καὶ

ὅτιοῦν; ΠΡΩ. οἶμαι μὲν οὐδαμῶς. ΣΩ. οὐδ' ἄρα νοῦς οὐδέ τις ἐπιστήμη περὶ αὐτὰ ἐστὶν τὸ ἀληθέστατον ἔχουσα. ΠΡΩ. οὐκ οὐκ εἰκός γε. ΣΩ. τὸν μὲν δὴ σὲ καὶ ἐμὲ καὶ Γοργίαν καὶ Φίληβον χρηρὴ συχνὰ χαίρειν ἔαν, τόδε δὲ διαμαρτύρασθαι τῷ λόγῳ.

59c

PR: What case?

59c

S: That we shall attain the certain, the pure, the true, and what we call absolute, among what is ever the same, unchanging and unmixed, or among whatever is most akin to these. All else should be declared to be secondary or inferior.

59c

PR: What you say is very true.

59c

S: And wouldn't it be most appropriate to assign the most beautiful names for such entities to whatever is most beautiful?

59c

PR: That sounds reasonable anyway.

ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὡς ἢ περὶ ἐκεῖνα ἔσθ' ἡμῖν τό τε βέβαιον καὶ τὸ καθαρὸν καὶ ἀληθές καὶ ὃ δὴ λέγομεν εἰλικρινές, περὶ τὰ αἰετὰ κατὰ τὰ αὐτὰ ὡσαύτως ἀμεικτότατα ἔχοντα, ἢ δεύτερος ἐκείνων ὅτι μάλιστά ἐστι συγγενές· τὰ δ' ἄλλα πάντα δευτέρὰ τε καὶ ὕστερα λεκτέον. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. τὰ δὴ τῶν ὀνομάτων περὶ τὰ τοιαῦτα κάλλιστα ἄρ' οὐ τοῖς καλλίστοις δικαιοτάτον ἀπονέμειν; ΠΡΩ. εἰκός γε.

59d

S: Are not reason and understanding the names which would be most honoured?

59d

PR: Yes.

59d

S: So, these terms are properly applicable, in their most precise sense, to reflections upon what actually is.

59d

PR: Yes, certainly.

59d

S: And these are the very terms I presented for our adjudication earlier.

59d

PR: Of course, Socrates.

59d

S: Very well. Now, if someone were to say that this process of mixing understanding with pleasure turns us into craftsmen, with the materials or constituents for manufacturing something spread before us, he would be making a very good analogy.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν νοῦς ἐστὶ καὶ φρόνησις ἃ γ' ἂν τις τιμήσειε μάλιστα ὀνόματα; ΠΡΩ. ναί. ΣΩ. ταῦτ' ἄρα ἐν ταῖς περὶ τὸ ὄντως ἐννοίαις ἐστὶν ἀπηκριβωμένα ὀρθῶς κείμενα καλεῖσθαι. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἃ γε εἰς τὴν κρίσιν ἐγὼ τότε παρεσχόμην οὐκ ἄλλ' ἐστὶν ἢ ταῦτα τὰ ὀνόματα. ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν, ὦ Σώκρατες; ΣΩ. εἶεν. τὸ μὲν δὴ φρονήσεώς τε καὶ ἡδονῆς πέρι

59e

PR: Very much so.

59e

S: Then the next thing we should do is set about mixing them.

59e

PR: Of course.

59e

S: Well, would it be appropriate to set out some principles and reminders for ourselves?

59e

PR: Of what kind?

πρὸς τὴν ἀλλήλων μεῖξιν εἴ τις φαίη καθαπερὶ δημιουργοῖς ἡμῖν ἐξ ὧν ἢ ἐν οἷς δεῖ δημιουργεῖν τι παρακεῖσθαι, καλῶς ἂν τῷ λόγῳ ἀπεικάζοι. ΠΡΩ. καὶ μάλα. ΣΩ. τὸ δὴ μετὰ ταῦτα ἄρ' οὐ μειγνύναι ἐπιχειρητέον; ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τάδε προειποῦσι καὶ ἀναμνήσασιν ἡμᾶς αὐτοὺς

ὀρθότερον ἂν ἔχοι; ΠΡΩ. τὰ ποῖα; ΣΩ. ἃ καὶ πρότερον ἐμνήσθημεν· εὖ δ' ἢ παροιμία

60a

S: We were also reminded of these before, but I think the proverb puts it nicely, that “a good point may be repeated twice or even thrice in a speech”.

60a

PR: Of course.

60a

S: Then, by Zeus, let's proceed, for I believe that what was said then amounts to something like this.

60a

PR: Something like what?

60a

S: Philebus says that pleasure is the right objective for every creature, and they should all aim for this, and this in itself constitutes the good for all of them. And these two names, good and pleasant, have been correctly assigned to one entity which possesses a single nature. But Socrates denies that these two are one – they are two, just as the names are, and the good and pleasant have different natures from one another – and that understanding involves a greater portion of good than pleasure does. Is that how things stand, Protarchus? And is that what was said before?

δοκεῖ ἔχειν, τὸ καὶ δις καὶ τρίς τό γε καλῶς ἔχον ἐπαναπολεῖν τῷ λόγῳ δεῖν. ΠΡΩ. τί μὴν; ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ πρὸς Διός· οἶμαι γὰρ οὕτως ὡς τὰ τότε λεχθέντα ῥηθῆναι. ΠΡΩ. πῶς; ΣΩ. Φίληβός φησι τὴν ἡδονὴν σκοπὸν ὀρθὸν πᾶσι ζώοις γεγονέναι καὶ δεῖν πάντας τούτου στοχάζεσθαι, καὶ δὴ καὶ τάγαθόν τοῦτ' αὐτὸ εἶναι σύμπασιν, καὶ δύο ὀνόματα, ἀγαθὸν καὶ ἡδύ, ἐνί τινι καὶ φύσει μιᾷ τούτῳ ὀρθῶς

60b

PR: Yes, definitely.

60b

S: Isn't there a further point we agreed about before, and could still agree about now?

60b

PR: What is it?

60b

S: That the nature of the good differs from everything else in a particular way.

τεθέντ' ἔχειν· Σωκράτης δ' ἐν μὲν οὗ φησι τοῦτ' εἶναι, δύο δὲ καθάπερ τὰ ὀνόματα, καὶ τό τε ἀγαθὸν καὶ ἡδὺ διάφορον ἀλλήλων φύσιν ἔχειν, μᾶλλον δὲ μέτοχον εἶναι τῆς τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ μοίρας τὴν φρόνησιν ἢ τὴν ἡδονήν. οὐ ταῦτ' ἔστιν τε καὶ ἦν τὰ τότε λεγόμενα, ὧ Πρώταρχε; ΠΡΩ. σφόδρα μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ τόδε καὶ τότε καὶ νῦν ἡμῖν ἂν συνομολογοῖτο; ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. τὴν τἀγαθοῦ διαφέρειν φύσιν τῷδε τῶν ἄλλων.

60c

PR: Which is?

60c

S: Any creature which possessed it permanently, entirely, and in every way, would not ever stand in need of anything else, and would be completely self-sufficient. Is this so?

60c

PR: It is so, indeed.

60c

S: Didn't we attempt in the discussion to assign a distinct life to each of them, one a life of pleasure unmixed with understanding, and the other in like manner a life of understanding without the least portion of pleasure?

60c

PR: That was it.

60c

S: Now, did we think at the time that either of these lives was adequate for anyone?

ΠΡΩ. τίνι; ΣΩ. ὦι παρείη τοῦτ' ἀεὶ τῶν ζώων διὰ τέλους πάντως καὶ πάντη, μηδενὸς ἑτέρου ποτὲ ἔτι προσδεῖσθαι, τὸ δὲ ἱκανὸν τελεώτατον ἔχειν. οὐχ οὕτως; ΠΡΩ. οὕτω μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τῷ λόγῳ ἐπειράθημεν χωρὶς ἑκάτερον ἑκατέρου θέντες εἰς τὸν βίον ἐκάστων, ἄμεικτον μὲν ἡδονὴν φρονήσει, φρόνησιν δὲ ὡσαύτως ἡδονῆς μηδὲ τὸ σμικρότατον ἔχουσιν; ΠΡΩ. ἦν ταῦτα. ΣΩ. μὴν οὖν ἡμῖν αὐτῶν τότε πότερον ἱκανὸν ἔδοξεν

60d

PR: No, how could we?

60d

S: And yet, if we went somewhat astray at the time, anyone may now revise it and state it more correctly. He should assign memory, understanding, knowledge and right opinion to the same class, and consider whether anyone would agree to possess or acquire anything whatsoever in the absence of these. Would he accept the most extensive and intense pleasure without the true opinion that he was enjoying it, without any knowledge at all of the experience he was undergoing, or any memory of the experience, for any period of time? And he should also ask the same question about understanding. Would anyone accept the possession of understanding without any pleasure, even the slightest, rather than having it along with some pleasures? Or would he accept all the pleasure without any understanding, rather than having it in turn along with some understanding?

εἶναί τω; ΠΡΩ. καὶ πῶς; ΣΩ. εἰ δέ γε παρηνέχθημέν τι τότε, νῦν ὅστις οὖν ἐπαναλαβὼν ὀρθότερον εἰπάτω, μνήμην καὶ φρόνησιν καὶ ἐπιστήμην καὶ ἀληθῆ δόξαν τῆς αὐτῆς ιδέας τιθέμενος καὶ σκοπῶν εἴ τις ἄνευ τούτων δέξαιτ' ἂν οἱ καὶ ὅτι οὖν εἶναι ἢ καὶ γίγνεσθαι, μὴ ὅτι δή γε ἡδονὴν εἶθ' ὥς πλείστην εἶθ' ὥς σφοδροτάτην, ἦν μήτε ἀληθῶς δοξάζοι χαίρειν μήτε τὸ παράπαν γινώσκοι τί ποτε πέπονθε πάθος μήτ' αὖ

60e

PR: No one would accept it, Socrates, and there is no need to ask these questions so often.

μνήμην τοῦ πάθους μηδ' ὄντινοῦν χρόνον ἔχοι. ταῦτά δὲ λεγέτω καὶ περὶ φρονήσεως, εἴ τις ἄνευ πάσης ἡδονῆς καὶ τῆς βραχυτάτης δέξαιτ' ἂν φρόνησιν ἔχειν μᾶλλον ἢ μετὰ τινων ἡδονῶν ἢ πάσας ἡδονὰς χωρὶς φρονήσεως μᾶλλον ἢ μετὰ φρονήσεως αὐτίνος. ΠΡΩ. οὐκ ἔστιν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἀλλ' οὐδὲν δεῖ ταῦτά γε πολλάκις ἐπερωτᾶν.

61a

S: In that case, would the perfect, the supreme good which everyone desires, be either of these two?

61a

PR: How could it be?

61a

S: Then we need to understand the good, either in its clarity or in outline, so that as we said we may decide how to award second place.

61a

PR: Correct.

61a

S: Well, haven't we found a sort of pathway towards the good?

61a

PR: What is it?

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τό γε τέλεον καὶ πᾶσιν αἰρετόν καὶ τὸ παντάπασιν ἀγαθὸν οὐδέτερον ἂν τούτων εἴη; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἄν; ΣΩ. τὸ τοίνυν ἀγαθὸν ἥτοι σαφῶς ἢ καὶ τίνα τύπον αὐτοῦ ληπτέον, ἵν', ὅπερ ἐλέγομεν, δευτερεῖα ὅτῳ δώσομεν ἔχωμεν. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν ὁδὸν μὲν τίνα ἐπὶ τὰγαθὸν εἰλήφαμεν; ΠΡΩ. τίνα; ΣΩ. καθάπερ εἴ τίς τίνα ἀνθρωπον ζητῶν τὴν οἴκησιν

61b

S: It is as if you were looking for a particular person and you first found out exactly where he lived. Surely that would be a significant step in the search for the person.

61b

PR: Of course.

61b

S: And, indeed, a certain argument has now advised us, as it did at the start of our discussion, not to seek the good in the unmixed life, but in the mixed life.

61b

PR: Certainly.

61b

S: In that case, is there greater hope that the good will be more evident in a life which has been beautifully mixed, than in a life which has not?

61b

PR: Much greater.

πρῶτον ὀρθῶς ἴν' οἰκεῖ πύθοιτο αὐτοῦ, μέγα τι δήπου πρὸς τὴν εὐρεσιν ἂν ἔχοι τοῦ ζητουμένου. ΠΡΩ. πῶς δ' οὐ; ΣΩ. καὶ νῦν δὴ τις λόγος ἐμήνυσεν ἡμῖν, ὥσπερ καὶ κατ' ἀρχάς, μὴ ζητεῖν ἐν τῷ ἀμείκτῳ βίῳ τὰγαθὸν ἀλλ' ἐν τῷ μεικτῷ. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ γε. ΣΩ. ἐλπίς μὴν πλείων ἐν τῷ μειχθέντι καλῶς τὸ ζητούμενον ἔσεσθαι φανερώτερον ἢ ἐν τῷ μῇ; ΠΡΩ. πολὺ γε. ΣΩ. τοῖς δὲ θεοῖς, ὧς Πρώταρχε, εὐχόμενοι κεραννύμεν,

61c

S: Then, let us set about mixing them, and pray to the gods, either Dionysus or Hephaestus, or whichever god has been allotted the honour of conducting the blending.

61c

PR: Yes, certainly.

61c

S: And, indeed, we have fountains set before us, just as if we were wine-bearers. The fountain of pleasure may be likened to honey, while the sobering, unintoxicating fountain of understanding is like unsweetened healthy water. And we must endeavour to mix these two as beautifully as we can.

61c

PR: So we must.

εἴτε Διόνυσος εἴτε Ἥφαιστος εἴθ' ὅστις θεῶν ταύτην τὴν τιμὴν εἴληχε τῆς συγκράσεως. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καθάπερ ἡμῖν

οἶνοχόοις τισὶ παρεστᾶσι κρῆναι—μέλιτος μὲν ἂν ἀπεικάζοι τις τὴν τῆς ἡδονῆς, τὴν δὲ τῆς φρονήσεως νηφαντικὴν καὶ ἄοινον αὐστηροῦ καὶ ὑγιεινοῦ τινος ὕδατος—ἅς προθυμητέον ὥς κάλλιστα συμμειγνύναι. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ;

61d

S: Now, the first question is, would we best achieve a beautiful mixture by combining all pleasure with all understanding?

61d

PR: Perhaps.

61d

S: But this is not safe. I think I have an idea that would enable us to carry out the mixing with less risk.

61d

PR: Tell me what it is.

61d

S: Did we find, so we thought, that one pleasure was more truly a pleasure than another, and indeed that one skill was also more precise than another skill?

61d

PR: They must be.

61d

S: And knowledge actually excels over knowledge, as in one case it was concerned with whatever comes into being and perishes, and in the other with things that neither come to be nor perish, but are always exactly the same as they are. Reflecting on these, on the basis of truth, we regarded the second as truer than the first.

ΣΩ. φέρε δὴ πρότερον· ἄρα πᾶσαν ἡδονὴν πάσῃ φρονήσῃ μειγνύντες τοῦ καλῶς ἂν μάλιστα ἐπιτύχοιμεν; ΠΡΩ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. ἀλλ' οὐκ ἀσφαλές. ἢ δὲ ἀκινδυνότερον ἂν μειγνύοιμεν, δόξαν μοι δοκῶ τινα ἀποφύνασθαι ἂν. ΠΡΩ. λέγε τίνα. ΣΩ. ἦν ἡμῖν ἡδονὴ τε ἀληθῶς, ὥς οἰόμεθα, μᾶλλον ἐτέρας ἄλλῃ καὶ δὴ καὶ τέχνη τέχνης ἀκριβεστέρα; ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. καὶ ἐπιστήμη δὴ ἐπιστήμης διάφορος, ἡ μὲν ἐπὶ

61e

PR: Yes, and rightly so.

61e

S: Now, if we were to look at the truest portions of these two, and mix them together first, would these mixtures be sufficient to provide us with the most prized life? Or would we still need portions which are not like these?

τὰ γιγνόμενα καὶ ἀπολλύμενα ἀποβλέπουσα, ἡ δ' ἐπὶ τὰ μήτε γιγνόμενα μήτε ἀπολλύμενα, κατὰ ταῦτά δὲ καὶ ὡσαύτως ὄντα ἀεί. ταύτην εἰς τὸ ἀληθὲς ἐπισκοπούμενοι ἡγησάμεθα ἐκείνης ἀληθεστέραν εἶναι. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν ὀρθῶς. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ τὰ ληθέστατα τμήματα ἐκατέρας ἴδοιμεν πρῶτον συμμερίζαντες, ἄρα ἱκανὰ ταῦτα συγκεκραμένα τὸν ἀγαπητότατον βίον ἀπεργασάμενα παρέχειν ἡμῖν, ἢ τινος ἔτι προσδεόμεθα καὶ τῶν μὴ τοιούτων;

62a

PR: It seems to me anyway that we should do as you suggest.

62a

S: Let us suppose that there is a man among us with an understanding about what justice is, who can give an account accordant with reason, and who also appreciates everything else there is in the very same way.

62a

PR: Very well, let's do that.

62a

S: Now then, will such a man have sufficient knowledge if he can give an account of the sphere itself and circle itself, which are divine, but is ignorant of this sphere and that circle of the human realm, even when using straight edges and circles in house building and other similar activities?

ΠΡΩ. ἐμοὶ γοῦν δοκεῖ δρᾶν οὕτως. ΣΩ. ἔστω δὴ τις ἡμῖν φρονῶν ἄνθρωπος αὐτῆς περὶ δικαιοσύνης ὅτι ἔστιν, καὶ λόγον ἔχων ἐπόμενον τῷ νοεῖν, καὶ δὴ καὶ περὶ τῶν ἄλλων πάντων τῶν ὄντων ὡσαύτως διανοούμενος. ΠΡΩ. ἔστω γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὗτος ἱκανῶς ἐπιστήμης

ἔξει, κύκλου μὲν καὶ σφαίρας αὐτῆς τῆς θείας τὸν λόγον ἔχων, τὴν δὲ ἀνθρωπίνην ταύτην σφαῖραν καὶ τοὺς κύκλους τούτους ἀγνοῶν,

62b

PR: If knowledge consists of only divine knowledge, Socrates, then we are in a ridiculous predicament.

62b

S: Are you saying that we should put the uncertain and impure skill associated with the false straight edge and circle into the mixture with the others?

62b

PR: Yes, we must, if any of us is even going to find his own way home every day.

καὶ χρώμενος ἐν οἰκοδομίᾳ καὶ τοῖς ἄλλοις ὁμοίως κανόσι καὶ τοῖς κύκλοις; ΠΡΩ. γελοίαν διάθεσιν ἡμῶν, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἐν ταῖς θεαῖς οὐσαν μόνον ἐπιστήμῃς λέγομεν. ΣΩ. πῶς φῆς; ἢ τοῦ ψευδοῦς κανόνος ἅμα καὶ τοῦ κύκλου τὴν οὐ βέβαιον οὐδὲ καθαρὰν τέχνην ἐμβλητέον κοινῇ καὶ συγκρατέον; ΠΡΩ. ἀναγκαῖον γάρ, εἰ μέλλει τις ἡμῶν καὶ τὴν ὁδὸν ἐκάστοτε ἐξευρήσειν οἴκαδε.

62c

S: And what about music? We said a little earlier that it is full of conjecture and imitation, and therefore lacks purity. So, should we add this to the mixture?

62c

PR: It appears to me that we must, if we are to have a life which is any kind of life at all.

62c

S: In that case, do you want me to surrender, like a doorkeeper who is pushed and pressed by a crowd and lets the doors fly open, so that every kind of knowledge floods in, and the pure mixes alike with the deficient?

ΣΩ. ἢ καὶ μουσικὴν, ἣν ὀλίγον ἔμπροσθεν ἔφαμεν στοχάσεώς τε καὶ μιμήσεως μεστήν οὐσαν καθαρότητος ἐνδεῖν; ΠΡΩ. ἀναγκαῖον φαίνεται

ἔμοιγε, εἵπερ γε ἡμῶν ὁ βίος ἔσται καὶ ὅπως οὖν ποτε βίος. ΣΩ. βούλει δῆτα, ὥσπερ θυρωρὸς ὑπ' ὄχλου τις ὠθούμενος καὶ βιαζόμενος, ἠττηθεὶς ἀναπετάσας τὰς θύρας ἀφῶ πάσας τὰς ἐπιστήμας εἰσερεῖν καὶ μείγνυσθαι ὁμοῦ καθαρχὴ τὴν ἐνδεεστέραν;

62d

PR: Socrates, I do not know what harm it would do to admit all the other kinds of knowledge once we had the primary kinds.

62d

S: So, shall I let all of them flood into the receptacle, the valley, which Homer so poetically describes?⁵

62d

PR: Yes, certainly.

62d

S: They have all been admitted. And now we must go once more to the fountain of pleasures. Indeed, we have not carried out our intention of mixing the true portions of the pleasures first. Instead, due to our indiscriminate desire for all knowledge, we have allowed it all in at once even before the pleasures.

ΠΡΩ. οὐκ οὖν ἔγωγε οἶδα, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὅτι τις ἂν βλάπτοιο πάσας λαβὼν τὰς ἄλλας ἐπιστήμας, ἔχων τὰς πρώτας. ΣΩ. μεθιῶ δὴ τὰς συμπάσας ρεῖν εἰς τὴν τῆς Ὀμήρου καὶ μάλα ποιητικῆς μισγαγκείας ὑποδοχήν; ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. μεθεῖνται καὶ πάλιν ἐπὶ τὴν τῶν ἡδονῶν πηγὴν ἰτέον. ὥς γὰρ διενεώθημεν αὐτὰς μειγνύναι, τὰ τῶν ἀληθῶν μόρια πρῶτον, οὐκ ἐξεγένεθ' ἡμῖν, ἀλλὰ διὰ τὸ πᾶσαν ἀγαπᾶν ἐπιστήμην εἰς ταῦτόν μεθεῖμεν ἀθρόας καὶ πρόσθεν

62e

PR: Very true.

62e

S: Then it is time for us to decide also whether all these pleasures should be allowed in together, or we should first admit only those which are true.

62e

PR: It makes a significant difference in terms of safety to let the true pleasures in first.

62e

S: Let them in, then! And what is the next question? If there are some necessary pleasures, as in the other case, should we also add these to the mix?

62e

PR: Why not? Surely the necessary ones should be added.

τῶν ἡδονῶν. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα λέγεις. ΣΩ. ὦρα δὴ βουλευέσθαι νῶν καὶ περὶ τῶν ἡδονῶν, πότερα καὶ ταύτας πάσας ἀθρόας ἀφετέον ἢ καὶ τούτων πρώτας μεθετέον ἡμῖν ὅσαι ἀληθεῖς. ΠΡΩ. πολὺ τι διαφέρει πρὸς γε ἀσφάλειαν πρώτας τὰς ἀληθεῖς ἀφεῖναι. ΣΩ. μεθείσθων δὴ. τί δὲ μετὰ ταῦτα; ἄρ' οὐκ εἰ μὲν τινες ἀναγκαῖαι, καθάπερ ἐκεῖ, συμμεικτέον καὶ ταύτας; ΠΡΩ. τί δ' οὐ; τὰς γε ἀναγκαίας δῆπουθεν.

63a

S: And yet we said it was useful, and not harmful, to have knowledge of all skills throughout our lives. Well, if we now say the same thing about pleasures, that it is of benefit to us and not harmful to anyone to enjoy all pleasures throughout life, they should all be included in the mix.

63a

PR: In that case, what should we say about the pleasures themselves? And what should we do?

63a

S: It is not us who should be questioned, Protarchus, but there is a certain question we may put to the pleasures themselves, and to the instances of understanding, in relation to one another.

ΣΩ. εἰ δέ γε καί, καθάπερ τὰς τέχνας πάσας ἀβλαβές τε καὶ ὠφέλιμον ἦν ἐπίστασθαι διὰ βίου, καὶ νῦν δὴ ταῦτὰ λέγομεν περὶ τῶν ἡδονῶν, εἴπερ πάσας ἡδονὰς ἥδεσθαι διὰ βίου συμφέρον τε ἡμῖν ἐστι καὶ ἀβλαβές ἅπασι, πάσας συγκρατέον. ΠΡΩ. πῶς οὖν δὴ περὶ αὐτῶν τούτων λέγωμεν; καὶ πῶς ποιῶμεν; ΣΩ. οὐχ ἡμᾶς, ὦ Πρώταρχε, διερωτᾶν χρή,

τὰς ἡδονὰς δὲ αὐτὰς καὶ τὰς φρονήσεις διαπυνθανομένους τὸ τοιόνδε ἀλλήλων πέρι.

63b

PR: What sort of question?

63b

S: “My friends, be ye called pleasures or any other name,⁶ would you prefer to live in the presence of all understanding, or in the absence of understanding?” I believe there is a particular response which they must give here.

63b

PR: What sort of response?

ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὦ φίλοι, εἴτε ἡδονὰς ὑμᾶς χρή προσαγορεύειν εἴτε ἄλλω ὁτῶ οὖν ὀνόματι, μῶν οὐκ ἂν δέξαισθε οἰκεῖν μετὰ φρονήσεως πάσης ἢ χωρὶς τοῦ φρονεῖν; οἶμαι μὲν πρὸς ταῦτα τόδ’ αὐτὰς ἀναγκαιότατον εἶναι λέγειν. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὅτι καθάπερ ἔμπροσθεν ἐρρήθη, τὸ μόνον καὶ ἔρημον εἰλικρινὲς εἶναί τι γένος οὔτε πάνυ τι δυνατόν οὔτ’

63c

S: Exactly what was said before. “It is not really possible or useful for any class to be single, solitary and absolute. Indeed, we believe, comparing one with another, that in the case of all these classes it is best for us to live in the company of knowledge of all the others, and as complete a knowledge as possible of each one of us.”

63c

PR: “Yes, what you have just said is excellent,” will be our reply.

63c

S: And rightly so. Now, we must put our question once more, this time to understanding and reason. “Would you like to include any pleasures in the mixture?” Yes, that is what we would say in questioning reason and understanding. And they would probably reply, “Pleasures of what kind?”

63c

PR: Quite likely.

ὠφέλιμον· πάντων γε μὴν ἡγούμεθα γενῶν ἄριστον ἐν ἀνθ' ἐνός συνοικεῖν ἡμῖν τὸ τοῦ γιγνώσκειν τᾷλλά τε πάντα καὶ αὖ τὴν αὐτὴν ἡμῶν τελέως εἰς δύναμιν ἐκάστην. ΠΡΩ. καὶ καλῶς γε εἰρήκατε τὰ νῦν, φήσομεν. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. πάλιν τοίνυν μετὰ τοῦτο τὴν φρόνησιν καὶ τὸν νοῦν ἀνερωτητέον· ἄρ' ἡδονῶν τι προσδεῖσθε ἐν τῇ συγκράσει; φαῖμεν ἂν αὖ τὸν νοῦν τε καὶ τὴν φρόνησιν ἀνερωτῶντες. ποίῳν, φαῖεν ἂν ἴσως, ἡδονῶν; ΠΡΩ. εἰκός.

63d

S: Well anyway, our conversation continues as follows. We shall ask, “In addition to those true pleasures, do you still feel a need for the company of the greatest and most intense pleasures?” And they would probably say, “How could we, Socrates, when they present countless impediments to us, disturbing the souls in which we reside with insane pleasures, and not allowing us to come into being in the first place? Indeed, in most cases, they totally destroy whatever offspring we bring to birth by engendering forgetfulness through inattention. But please regard those true and pure pleasures you mentioned as our near kindred, along with any others which involve health and sound-mindedness, and indeed any pleasures which attend upon the totality of excellence, and follow that everywhere as if it were a god. These you may add to the mix. “But surely it would be quite irrational for someone, who wishes to see a mixture and blend which is as beautiful and as free from strife as possible, to put the pleasures which involve thoughtlessness and all sorts of depravity into the mix with reason, especially if he is trying to understand from this what precisely is good by nature in man and in the universe, and to divine its precise form.” Well, shall we not say that reason has responded sensibly and in accord with itself when it says all this on behalf of itself, memory, and right opinion?

ΣΩ. ὁ δέ γ' ἡμέτερος λόγος μετὰ τοῦτ' ἐστὶν ὅδε. πρὸς ταῖς ἀληθέσιν ἐκείναις ἡδοναῖς, φήσομεν, ἄρ' ἔτι προσδεῖσθ' ὑμῖν τὰς μεγίστας

ἡδονὰς συνοίκους εἶναι καὶ τὰς σφοδροτάτας; καὶ πῶς, ὦ Σώκρατες, ἴσως φαῖεν ἄν, αἷ γ' ἐμποδίσματά τε μυρία ἡμῖν ἔχουσι, τὰς ψυχὰς ἐν αἷς οἰκοῦμεν ταράττουσαι διὰ μανίας ἡδονάς, καὶ γίγνεσθαι τε ἡμᾶς τὴν ἀρχὴν οὐκ ἔωσι, τὰ τε γιγνόμενα ἡμῶν τέκνα ὡς τὸ πολὺ, δι' ἀμέλειαν λήθην ἐμποιοῦσαι, παντάπασι διαφθείρουσιν; ΣΩ. ἀλλ' ἄς τε ἡδονὰς ἀληθεῖς καὶ καθαρὰς ἃς εἴπεις, σχεδὸν οἰκείας ἡμῖν νόμιζε, καὶ πρὸς ταύταις τὰς μεθ' ὑγιείας καὶ τοῦ σωφρονεῖν, καὶ δὴ καὶ συμπάσης ἀρετῆς ὅποσαι καθάπερ θεοῦ ὁπαδοὶ γιγνόμεναι αὐτῇ συνακολουθοῦσι πάντῃ, ταύτας μείγνυ· τὰς δ' αἰεὶ μετ' ἀφροσύνης καὶ τῆς ἄλλης κακίας ἐπομένας πολλή που ἀλογία τῷ νῷ μειγνύναι τὸν βουλούμενον ὅτι καλλίστην ἰδόντα καὶ ἀστασιαστοτάτην μεῖξιν

64a

PR: Entirely so.

64a

S: Yes, but something else is needed, otherwise nothing at all would ever have come into being.

καὶ κρᾶσιν, ἐν ταύτῃ μαθεῖν πειρᾶσθαι τί ποτε ἔν τ' ἀνθρώπῳ καὶ τῷ παντὶ πέφυκεν ἀγαθὸν καὶ τίνα ἰδέαν αὐτὴν εἶναί ποτε μαντευτέον. ἄρ' οὐκ ἐμφρόνως ταῦτα καὶ ἐχόντως ἑαυτὸν τὸν νοῦν φήσομεν ὑπὲρ τε αὐτοῦ καὶ μνήμης καὶ δόξης ὀρθῆς ἀποκρίνασθαι τὰ νῦν ῥηθέντα; ΠΡΩ. παντάπασι μὲν οὔν. ΣΩ. ἀλλὰ μὴν καὶ τόδε γε ἀναγκαῖον, καὶ οὐκ ἄλλως ἄν ποτε γένοιτο οὐδ' ἂν ἔν.

64b

PR: What is it? ----- 5 Iliad iv.452. 6 See 11b.

64b

S: Anything which we do not combine with truth would not ever truly come into being, nor would it 'be' once it had come into being.

64b

PR: No, how could it?

64b

S: It simply could not. Now, if anything else is still lacking in this admixture, you and Philebus should say what it is. For it does appear to

me that the present account is complete. It is a non-physical order which presides beautifully over an ensouled body.

64b

PR: Well, on that basis, Socrates, you may say that I accept the account.

ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὥι μὴ μείζομεν ἀλήθειαν, οὐκ ἂν ποτε τοῦτο ἀληθῶς γίγνοιτο οὐδ' ἂν γενόμενον εἴη. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ ἂν; ΣΩ. οὐδαμῶς. ἀλλ' εἴ τινος ἔτι προσδεῖ τῇ συγκράσει ταύτη, λέγετε σὺ καὶ Φίληβος. ἐμοὶ μὲν γὰρ καθαπερὶ κόσμος τις ἀσώματος ἄρξων καλῶς ἐμψύχου σώματος ὁ νῦν λόγος ἀπειργάσθαι φαίνεται. ΠΡΩ. καὶ ἐμοὶ τοίνυν, ὦ Σώκρατες, οὕτω λέγε δεδόχθαι.

64c

S: And would we be right in saying that in a sense we are standing before the portals of the good, and the dwelling place of its kindred?

64c

PR: So it seems to me, anyway.

64c

S: What, then, would we say is most valuable in this admixture, and at the same time most responsible for such an arrangement being attractive to everyone? For once we have seen this, we can go on to consider whether it stands in closer natural kinship with pleasure, or with reason, in the overall scheme.

ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν ἐπὶ μὲν τοῖς τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ νῦν ἤδη προθύροις καὶ τῆς οἰκίσεως ἐφεστάναι τῆς τοῦ τοιοῦτου λέγοντες ἴσως ὀρθῶς ἂν τινα τρόπον φαῖμεν; ΠΡΩ. ἐμοὶ γοῦν δοκεῖ. ΣΩ. τί δῆτα ἐν τῇ συμμείξει τιμιώτατον ἅμα καὶ μάλιστ' αἴτιον εἶναι δόξειεν ἂν ἡμῖν τοῦ πᾶσιν γεγενέσθαι προσφιλεῖ τὴν τοιαύτην διάθεσιν; τοῦτο γὰρ ἰδόντες μετὰ τοῦτ' ἐπισκεψόμεθα εἴθ' ἡδονῇ εἴτε τῷ νῷ προσφυέστερον καὶ οἰκειότερον ἐν τῷ παντὶ συνέστηκεν.

64d

PR: And rightly so, for this is of the utmost significance for the decision before us.

64d

S: And, indeed, it is not difficult to discern the cause whereby any mixture at all becomes either extremely valuable or entirely worthless.

64d

PR: What are you referring to?

64d

S: I believe there is no man who is ignorant of this.

64d

PR: Of what?

64d

S: That any mixture which does not somehow involve some measure – and the nature – of symmetry must destroy its own components and, first and foremost, itself. For something like this is not even a mixture, but is truly a jumble which has been thrown together – in fact, a constant affliction to those who have acquired it.

ΠΡΩ. ὀρθῶς· τοῦτο γὰρ εἰς τὴν κρίσιν ἡμῖν ἐστι συμφορώτατον. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν καὶ συμπάσης γε μείξεως οὐ χαλεπὸν ἰδεῖν τὴν αἰτίαν, δι' ἣν ἡ παντὸς ἀξία γίγνεται ἡτισοῦν ἢ τὸ παράπαν οὐδενός. ΠΡΩ. πῶς λέγεις; ΣΩ. οὐδεὶς που τοῦτο ἀνθρώπων ἀγνοεῖ. ΠΡΩ. τὸ ποῖον; ΣΩ. ὅτι μέτρου καὶ τῆς συμμέτρου φύσεως μὴ τυχοῦσα ἡτισοῦν καὶ ὅπως οὖν σύγκρασις πᾶσα ἐξ ἀνάγκης ἀπόλλυσι τὰ τε κεραννύμενα καὶ πρῶτην αὐτήν· οὐδὲ

64e

PR: Very true.

64e

S: And now we see that the power of the good has fled for refuge into the nature of the beautiful. For surely measure and symmetry always turn out to be beauty and excellence.

64e

PR: Yes, certainly.

64e

S: And, indeed, we said that truth is mixed with them in the blend.

64e

PR: Certainly.

γὰρ κῤῥασις ἀλλά τις ἄκρατος συμπεφορημένη ἀληθῶς ἡ τοιαύτη γίγνεται ἐκάστοτε ὄντως τοῖς κεκτημένοις συμφορά. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. νῦν δὴ καταπέφευγεν ἡμῖν ἡ τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ δύναμις εἰς τὴν τοῦ καλοῦ φύσιν· μετριότης γὰρ καὶ συμμετρία κάλλος δήπου καὶ ἀρετὴ πανταχοῦ συμβαίνει γίγνεσθαι. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ μὴν ἀλήθειάν γε ἔφαμεν αὐτοῖς ἐν τῇ κράσει μεμεῖχθαι. ΠΡΩ. πάνυ γε.

65a

S: Therefore, if we are unable to capture the good in a single form, we may comprehend it with these – beauty, symmetry and truth. Let us declare that the three may properly be regarded as a unity, responsible for the condition of the mixture. And because of this unity, which is good, such a mixture becomes good.

65a

PR: You are perfectly right.

65a

S: Then, at this point, Protarchus, anyone may be a satisfactory judge of whether it is pleasure or understanding that is more closely related to the supreme good, and is more valuable among men and gods.

ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν εἰ μὴ μιᾷ δυνάμεθα ιδέειν τὸ ἀγαθὸν θηρεῦσαι, σὺν τρισὶ λαβόντες, κάλλει καὶ συμμετρίας καὶ ἀληθείας, λέγωμεν ὡς τοῦτο οἷον ἐν ὀρθότατ' ἂν αἰτιασαίμεθ' ἂν τῶν ἐν τῇ συμμείξει, καὶ διὰ τοῦτο ὡς ἀγαθὸν ὃν τοιαύτην αὐτὴν γεγονέναι. ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα μὲν οὖν. ΣΩ. ἤδη τοίνυν, ὦ Πρώταρχε, ἱκανὸς ἡμῖν γένοιτ' ἂν ὅστισοῦν κριτῆς ἡδονῆς τε πέρι καὶ φρονήσεως, ὁπότερον

65b

PR: Yes, that is obvious. But it is best to complete the discussion nevertheless.

65b

S: In that case, we should judge each of the three individually in relation to pleasure and reason. For we need to decide which of the two should be assigned greater kinship with the three.

65b

PR: Are you referring to beauty, truth and measure?

αὐτοῖν τοῦ ἀρίστου συγγενέστερόν τε καὶ τιμιώτερον ἐν ἀνθρώποις τέ ἐστι καὶ θεοῖς. ΠΡΩ. δῆλον μὲν, ὅμως δ' οὖν τῷ λόγῳ ἐπεξελεῖν βέλτιον. ΣΩ. καθ' ἐν ἑκαστον τοίνυν τῶν τριῶν πρὸς τὴν ἡδονὴν καὶ τὸν νοῦν κρίνωμεν· δεῖ γὰρ ἰδεῖν ποτέρῳ ὡς μᾶλλον συγγενὲς ἑκαστον αὐτῶν ἀπονεμοῦμεν. ΠΡΩ. κάλλους καὶ ἀληθείας καὶ μετριότητος πέρι λέγεις; ΣΩ. ναί. πρῶτον δέ γε ἀληθείας λαβοῦ, ὦ Πρώταρχε·

65c

S: Yes. But take truth first, Protarchus, and once you have taken it and considered the three – reason, truth and pleasure – take your time, and answer for yourself whether pleasure or reason is more akin to truth.

65c

PR: What time do I need? Indeed, I believe that they differ enormously. For pleasure is the most deceptive thing of all. And by report, in the case of amorous pleasures which seem to be the most powerful, even the breaking of oaths is pardoned by the gods, as if the pleasures were just like children who have not attained even the smallest portion of reason. But reason, on the other hand, is either the very same as truth, or resembles it more closely than anything else, and is truer than all else.

καὶ λαβόμενος βλέψας εἰς τρία, νοῦν καὶ ἀλήθειαν καὶ ἡδονήν, πολὺν ἐπισχὼν χρόνον ἀπόκριναι σαυτῷ πότερον ἡδονὴ συγγενέστερον ἢ νοῦς ἀληθείᾳ. ΠΡΩ. τί δὲ χρόνου δεῖ; πολὺ γὰρ οἶμαι διαφέρετον. ἡδονὴ μὲν γὰρ ἀπάντων ἀλαζονίστατον, ὡς δὲ λόγος, καὶ ἐν ταῖς ἡδοναῖς ταῖς περὶ τὰ φροδίσια, αἱ δὴ μέγισται δοκοῦσιν εἶναι, καὶ τὸ ἐπιορκεῖν συγγνώμην εἵληφε παρὰ θεῶν, ὡς

65d

S: Now, consider measure next in the same way, and ask whether pleasure has more than understanding, or understanding has more than pleasure.

65d

PR: This question, too, is easy to deal with, for I do not believe that anyone would find anything at all which is more unmeasured than pleasure and excitement. And in contrast, nothing at all could ever be more measured than reason and knowledge.

καθάπερ παίδων τῶν ἡδονῶν νοῦν οὐδὲ τὸν ὀλίγιστον κεκτημένων· νοῦς δὲ ἦτοι ταῦτόν καὶ ἀλήθειά ἐστιν ἢ πάντων ὁμοιότατόν τε καὶ ἀληθέστατον. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν τὸ μετὰ τοῦτο τὴν μετριότητα ὡσαύτως σκέψαι, πότερον ἡδονὴ φρονήσεως ἢ φρόνησις ἡδονῆς πλείω κέκτηται; ΠΡΩ. εὐσκεπτόν γε καὶ ταύτην σκέψιν προβέβληκας· οἶμαι γὰρ ἡδονῆς μὲν καὶ περιχαρείας οὐδὲν τῶν ὄντων πεφυκὸς ἀμετρώτερον εὐρεῖν ἂν τινα, νοῦ δὲ καὶ ἐπιστήμης ἐμμετρώτερον οὐδ' ἂν ἔν ποτε.

65e

S: That is very well expressed. Nevertheless, you should still answer the third question. Do we say that reason partakes of beauty to a greater extent than the class of pleasure, so that reason is more beautiful than pleasure? Or is it the other way around?

65e

PR: Now, Socrates, no one either awake or in a dream has ever seen or conceived of understanding and reason as becoming ugly, or being ugly now or in the future in any way whatsoever.

65e

S: Correct.

65e

PR: But somehow when we see anyone enjoying pleasures, particularly if they are quite intense, and we behold the ridiculous or utterly base aspects associated with them, we ourselves are ashamed and remove them from view and hide them as best we can, consigning all such activities to the night because the light of day should not have sight of them.

ΣΩ. καλῶς εἶρηκας, ὅμως δ' ἔτι λέγε τὸ τρίτον. νοῦς ἡμῖν κάλλους μετείληφε πλεῖον ἢ τὸ τῆς ἡδονῆς γένος, ὥστε εἶναι καλλίω νοῦν ἡδονῆς, ἢ τοῦναντίον; ΠΡΩ. ἀλλ' οὖν φρόνησιν μὲν καὶ νοῦν, ὃ

Σώκρατες, οὐδείς πώποτε οὔθ' ὕπαρ οὔτ' ὄναρ αἰσχροὺς οὔτε εἶδεν οὔτε ἐπενόησεν οὐδαμῇ οὐδαμῶς οὔτε γινόμενον οὔτε ὄντα οὔτε ἐσόμενον. ΣΩ. ὀρθῶς. ΠΡΩ. ἡδονὰς δέ γέ που, καὶ ταῦτα σχεδὸν τὰς μεγίστας, ὅταν ἴδωμεν ἡδόμενον ὄντινούν, ἢ τὸ γελοῖον ἐπ' αὐταῖς ἢ τὸ

66a

S: Then you will proclaim to all, Protarchus, by sending forth messages and speaking to those who are present that pleasure is not the first of possessions, nor indeed the second. No, the first somehow involves measure, moderation and appropriateness, and all that must be regarded as similar to these.⁷

66a

PR: That's how it appears from what we are now saying, anyway.

πάντων αἰσχιστον ἐπόμενον ὀρῶντες αὐτοὶ τε αἰσχυνόμεθα καὶ ἀφανίζοντες κρύπτομεν ὅτι μάλιστα, νυκτὶ πάντα τὰ τοιαῦτα διδόντες, ὡς φῶς οὐ δέον ὀρᾶν αὐτά. ΣΩ. πάντῃ δὴ φήσεις, ὦ Πρωτάρχε, ὑπὸ τε ἀγγέλων πέμπων καὶ παροῦσι φράζων, ὡς ἡδονὴ κτῆμα οὐκ ἔστι πρῶτον οὐδ' αὖ δεύτερον, ἀλλὰ πρῶτον μὲν πῃ περὶ μέτρον καὶ τὸ μέτριον καὶ καίριον καὶ πάντα ὅποσα χρή τοιαῦτα νομίζειν, τὴν αἰδίον ἡρῆσθαι. ΠΡΩ. φαίνεται γοῦν ἐκ τῶν νῦν λεγομένων.

66b

S: And the second is associated with symmetry, beauty, completeness, sufficiency, and whatever, for its part, belongs to that family.

66b

PR: Quite likely.

66b

S: And based upon my prophecy, if you assign third place to reason and understanding you would not have strayed far from the truth.

66b

PR: Perhaps.

66b

S: Should fourth place go to knowledge, skill, and what are called right opinions, which we designated as belonging to the soul itself? Do these

come fourth after the other three, since they are more akin to the good than pleasure is?

ΣΩ. δεύτερον μὴν περὶ τὸ σύμμετρον καὶ καλὸν καὶ τὸ τέλος καὶ ἱκανὸν καὶ πάνθ' ὅποσα τῆς γενεᾶς αὐτῆς ἐστίν. ΠΡΩ. ἔοικε γοῦν. ΣΩ. τὸ τοίνυν τρίτον, ὡς ἡ ἐμὴ μαντεία, νοῦν καὶ φρόνησιν τιθεὶς οὐκ ἂν μέγα τι τῆς ἀληθείας παρεξέλθοις. ΠΡΩ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. ἄρ' οὖν οὐ τέταρτα, ἃ τῆς ψυχῆς αὐτῆς ἔθεμεν, ἐπιστήμας τε καὶ τέχνας καὶ δόξας ὀρθὰς λεχθείσας, ταῦτ'

66c

PR: Perhaps so.

66c

S: Then are the pleasures which we defined as devoid of pain in fifth place? We called these the pure pleasures of the soul itself, associated with knowledge in some cases and with sense perception in others.

66c

PR: Perhaps.

66c

S: “In the sixth generation, bring an end to the well-ordered song”, says Orpheus. Then, it is likely that our argument is coming to rest in the sixth decision, and there is nothing left for us after this except to provide a sort of summation of what has been said.

εἶναι τὰ πρὸς τοῖς τρισὶ τέταρτα, εἴπερ τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ γέ ἐστι μᾶλλον ἢ τῆς ἡδονῆς συγγενῆ; ΠΡΩ. τάχ' ἄν. ΣΩ. πέμπτας τοίνυν, ἃς ἡδονὰς ἔθεμεν ἀλύπους ὀρισάμενοι, καθαρὰς ἐπονομάσαντες τῆς ψυχῆς αὐτῆς, ἐπιστήμας, τὰς δὲ αἰσθήσεσιν ἐπομένας; ΠΡΩ. ἴσως. ΣΩ. ἔκτη δ' ἐν γενεᾷ, φησὶν Ὀρφεύς, καταπαύσατε κόσμον ἀοιδῆς· ἀτὰρ κινδυνεύει καὶ ὁ ἡμέτερος λόγος ἐν ἔκτη καταπεπαυμένος εἶναι κρίσει. τὸ δὴ μετὰ

66d

PR: Yes, we need to do that.

66d

S: Come on. With an offering to the saviour, let's call the same argument to give evidence for the third time.

66d

PR: What sort of argument? ----- 7 Omitting the last three words of this paragraph as corrupt, following D. Frede.

66d

S: Philebus proposed that, for us, the good is pleasure, complete and entire.

66d

PR: Socrates, apparently when you said “for the third time”, you meant that we must simply take up the argument again from the beginning.

ταῦθ’ ἡμῖν οὐδὲν λοιπὸν πλὴν ὥσπερ κεφαλὴν ἀποδοῦναι τοῖς εἰρημένοις. ΠΡΩ. οὐκοῦν χρή. ΣΩ. ἴθι δὴ, τὸ τρίτον τῷ σωτήρι τὸν αὐτὸν διαμαρτυράμενοι λόγον ἐπεξέλθωμεν. ΠΡΩ. ποῖον δὴ; ΣΩ. Φίληβος τάγαθὸν ἐτίθετο ἡμῖν ἡδονὴν εἶναι πᾶσαν καὶ παντελεῖ. ΠΡΩ. τὸ τρίτον, ὦ Σώκρατες, ὡς ἔοικας, ἔλεγες ἀρτίως τὸν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἐπαναλαβεῖν δεῖν λόγον.

66e

S: Yes, but let us hear what comes next. For once I had appreciated the accounts which have been given just now, and became disgusted by the principle which is stated not only by Philebus but also a countless number of others, I asserted that reason is far superior to pleasure, and also better for the life of humanity.

66e

PR: That is what was said.

66e

S: And yet, suspecting that there were many other candidates, I said that if anything turned out to be better than these two, I would side with reason against pleasure in the struggle for second place, and that pleasure would be deprived even of second place.

ΣΩ. ναί, τὸ δέ γε μετὰ τοῦτο ἀκούωμεν. ἐγὼ γὰρ δὴ κατιδὼν ἅπερ νυνδὴ διελέλυθα, καὶ δυσχεράνας τὸν Φιλήβου λόγον οὐ μόνον ἀλλὰ καὶ ἄλλων πολλάκις μυρίων, εἶπον ὡς ἡδονῆς γε νοῦς εἴη μακροῶ

βέλτιόν τε καὶ ἄμεινον τῷ τῶν ἀνθρώπων βίῳ. ΠΡΩ. ἦν ταῦτα. ΣΩ. ὑποπτεύων δέ γε καὶ ἄλλα εἶναι πολλὰ εἶπον ὥς εἰ φανείη τι τούτοις ἀμφοῖν βέλτιον, ὑπὲρ τῶν δευτερείων νῶ πρός ἡδονὴν συνδιαμαχοίμην, ἡδονὴ δὲ καὶ δευτερείων στερήσοιτο.

67a

PR: Yes, you did say that.

67a

S: And after that, it was shown very adequately that neither of these two is adequate.

67a

PR: Very true.

67a

S: Therefore, on the basis of this argument, pleasure and reason set aside their claim that either of them is the good itself, as they are devoid of self-sufficiency and the capacity for adequacy and completeness.

67a

PR: Absolutely correct.

67a

S: But when a third contestant turned out to be superior to either of these two, reason proved then to be infinitely more akin to and, by nature, closer than pleasure to the character of the victor.

67a

PR: It did, indeed.

67a

S: Therefore, on the basis of the judgment evinced by the current argument, the power of pleasure would get fifth place.

67a

PR: So it seems.

ΠΡΩ. εἶπες γὰρ οὖν. ΣΩ. καὶ μετὰ ταῦτά γε πάντων ἱκανώτατα τούτοις οὐδέτερον ἱκανὸν ἐφάνη. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν παντάπασιν ἐν τούτῳ τῷ λόγῳ καὶ νοῦς ἀπήλλακτο καὶ ἡδονὴ μὴ τοι τάγαθόν γε αὐτὸ

μηδ' ἕτερον αὐτοῖν εἶναι, στερομένοιιν αὐταρκειάς καὶ τῆς τοῦ ἱκανοῦ καὶ τελέου δυνάμεως; ΠΡΩ. ὀρθότατα. ΣΩ. φανέντος δέ γε ἄλλου τρίτου κρείττονος τούτοιιν ἑκατέρου, μυρίῳ γ' αὖ νοῦς ἡδονῆς οἰκειότερον καὶ προσφυέστερον πέφανται νῦν τῇ τοῦ νικῶντος ιδέᾳ. ΠΡΩ. πῶς γὰρ οὐ; ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν πέμπτον κατὰ τὴν κρίσιν, ἣν νῦν ὁ λόγος ἀπεφήνατο, γίγνοιτ' ἂν ἡ τῆς ἡδονῆς δύναμις. ΠΡΩ. ἔοικεν.

67b

S: But it would never get first place, not even if all the cattle and horses and all of the other wild beasts were to make this assertion through their pursuit of pleasure. Most people believe them, just as soothsayers believe birds and judge pleasures to be the best means to a good life for us, and they regard the animal passions as authoritative witnesses rather than the ardent pronouncements constantly uttered under the inspiration of the Muse, Philosophy.

67b

PR: Socrates, we all agree now that what you have said is perfectly true.

67b

S: Will you also let me go then?

67b

PR: There is a small matter still outstanding, Socrates. Indeed, I am sure you will not give up before we do, so I shall remind you of the remaining issues. -----

ΣΩ. πρῶτον δέ γε οὐδ' ἂν οἱ πάντες βόες τε καὶ ἵπποι καὶ τᾶλλα σύμπαντα θηρία φῶσι τῷ τὸ χαίρειν διώκειν· οἷς πιστεύοντες, ὥσπερ μάντις ὄρνισιν, οἱ πολλοὶ κρίνουσι τὰς ἡδονὰς εἰς τὸ ζῆν ἡμῖν εὖ κρατίστας εἶναι, καὶ τοὺς θηρίων ἔρωτας οἷονται κυρίους εἶναι μάρτυρας μᾶλλον ἢ τοὺς τῶν ἐν μούσῃ φιλοσόφῳ μεμαντευμένων ἐκάστοτε λόγων. ΠΡΩ. ἀληθέστατα, ὦ Σώκρατες, εἰρήσθαί σοι νῦν ἤδη φαμέν ἅπαντες. ΣΩ. οὐκοῦν καὶ ἀφίετέ με; ΠΡΩ. σμικρὸν ἔτι τὸ λοιπόν, ὦ Σώκρατες· οὐ γὰρ δήπου σύ γε ἀπερεῖς πρότερος ἡμῶν, ὑπομνήσω δέ σε τὰ λειπόμενα.

Notes

¹ See *Iliad* viii.539 for this epithet for the gods. Socrates' characterisation of the problem in this way underscores its seriousness.

² Theuth was the Egyptian god of the moon, knowledge, wisdom, writing, hieroglyphics, etc. He was often depicted with the head of an ibis.

³ *Iliad* xviii.108-109, Hackforth.

⁴ Following Bury's text here.

⁵ *Iliad* iv.452.

⁶ See 11b.

⁷ Omitting the last three words of this paragraph as corrupt, following D. Frede.